



SAVEETHA

INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL AND TECHNICAL SCIENCES
(Declared as Deemed to be University under Section 3 of UGC Act 1956)



New



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RANKING
2026

501-600
WORLD

Among 1000 Leading
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The World Has Recognized
SAVEETHA as a New Leader
YOUNG IN YEARS.
EXTRAORDINARY IN ACHIEVEMENT.

20 YEARS OF EXCELLENCE • ACADEMICS • RESEARCH • INNOVATION • HEALTHCARE

THE

INTERDISCIPLINARY
SCIENCE RANKING
2026



57th

World Rank

Recognized for excellence across
interdisciplinary research &
innovation

THE

WORLD
UNIVERSITY
RANKING 2026



351-400

WORLD RANK

Recognized globally for teaching
research, industry impact and
international outlook

QS

WORLD UNIVERSITY
RANKING BY SUBJECT
2026



IN DENTISTRY

FIVE CONSECUTIVE YEARS



WORLD RANK

QS

WORLD UNIVERSITY
RANKING BY SUBJECT
2026



PHARMACY

301-350



LIFE SCIENCE

401-450



MEDICINE

451-500



COMPUTER SCIENCE

751-800

Consistent global presence
across multiple disciplines

20 YEARS. ACHIEVEMENTS BEYOND MEASURE.



20

Years of
Legacy



17K+

Students from
across India &
70+ Countries



2000+

Faculty &
Research
Scholars



89000+

Research
Publications



6800+

Patents
Filed



6400+

Patents
published



335+

Patents
Granted



1000+

Global
Academic
Partners



2500+

Teaching
Hospital
Beds



250+

Acres
Green
Campus

250+ UG | PG | Ph.D Programmes in

Medicine | Dentistry | Engineering | Law | Management | Nursing | Physiotherapy | Occupational Therapy | Pharmacy | Physical Education | Architecture and Designing | Allied Health Sciences | Liberal Arts & Sciences | Hospitality & Tourism | Natural & Physical Sciences | Education

NIRF
Rankings 2025

2

Dental

11

Medical

13

Research

13

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19

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23

Overall

45

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63

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11/50

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Transfer Imran to private hospital: Pak SC to govt

Press Trust of India
Islamabad, August 18

THE PAKISTAN Supreme Court on Tuesday ordered that jailed former prime minister Imran Khan be shifted to a private hospital for medical assessment and treatment within two days.

The order follows months of concern raised by 73-year-old Khan's family and supporters over his health, and repeated allegations of being denied access to adequate medical care.

The top court on Tuesday directed that Khan be taken to Shifa International Hospital in Islamabad "within the next two days" and he shall remain there until the next hearing on September 16.

It also ordered the constitution of a medical board to assess the health of the former cricketer-turned-politician and treat him.

The SC also granted Khan one weekly meeting with his family during his stay at the hospital. Khan, who is the founder of the Pakistan Tehreek-e-Insaf political party, has been in Rawalpindi's Adiala Jail since 2023, with several cases against him.

His supporters continue to protest against his incarceration.

His relatives and party colleagues have alleged human rights violations, and accused the authorities of restricting his access to adequate medical care, family visits and legal counsel.



Ex-PM Imran Khan

The court directive came while hearing several identical petitions following Khan's eye ailment that surfaced earlier this year. The petitioners had sought his transfer to a private hospital, saying they were not satisfied

with the treatment he was receiving at government hospitals.

"Mindful of the fundamental rights, we are issuing this order to ensure the health and safety of the prisoner," Justice Shahid Waheed, head of a three-member bench, said while passing the order, a day after prison authorities told the top court that Khan's eye condition had improved significantly and his vision was "almost normal".

As it ordered the constitution of a medical board to assess and treat Khan, the bench also directed a senior doctor and Khan's personal physician to be present during his medical assessment and treatment.

The cost of Khan's treatment

in the private hospital will be borne by his family.

The bench stressed law and order outside the hospital must not be affected during Khan's stay and directed his party and supporters not to use the medical report for political purposes.

The court warned that any violation of its directions could result in the withdrawal of facilities being provided to Khan.

In its report, the jail authorities included a summary of 39 medical check-ups conducted by different specialists between November 4, 2023 and August 10, 2026. It said several government doctors had examined Khan, with records maintained by jail authorities.

GHALIBAF: REOPENING HINGES ON ENDING SANCTIONS, THREATS

No Iran talks planned, says Trump; Tehran fired missiles at us: UAE

Ship attacked while transiting strait, say maritime officials

Reuters
Dubai, Washington, August 18

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump said Tuesday no talks were taking place with Iran and none were scheduled, and he insisted the Strait of Hormuz was open, contradicting an earlier Iranian assertion that the critical waterway remained shut to shipping.

The receding prospects of a deal to end the nearly six-month conflict drove up oil prices again Tuesday, while stock markets sagged and borrowing costs for major economies including US hit multi-decade highs, amid concerns about long-term inflationary and fiscal impact of war.

A temporary ceasefire agreement expired on Monday and a senior Iranian official told *Reuters* that his country was moving to a "fully offensive" military posture due to the diplomatic stalemate, though there were no reports of fresh strikes by either side on Tuesday.

"There are no talks or conversations going on, or scheduled, with the Islamic Republic of Iran," Trump said in a post on Truth Social on Tuesday.

"The Naval Blockade remains in full force and effect. The Strait is open and operating.



A ship in the Strait of Hormuz near the beach of Bandar Abbas. FILE

All water mines have been removed or detonated," he added.

Meanwhile on Tuesday, the UAE's defense ministry said it detected two ballistic missiles launched from Iran against the Gulf country. It said one fell inside territorial waters, while another fell outside, and stressed the UAE's readiness to deal with any threats.

Later, the UAE's interior ministry sent a phone alert stating that the situation was safe and people should resume normal activities after an earlier alert warning of a missile threat. There was no immediate comment from Iran.

On Monday, Jared Kushner, Trump's son-in-law and special envoy, had sounded an optimistic note, saying talks with Iran were still under way and were "probably more robust" than they had ever been.

Despite Trump's typically

ebullient remarks about the situation in the Gulf, preliminary shipping data on Tuesday showed ship crossings via the Strait of Hormuz were still in single digits on Monday.

The United Kingdom Maritime Trade Operations said it received a report on Tuesday that a vessel was struck by an unknown projectile while transiting outbound in the Strait of Hormuz, causing engine room damage and a crew casualty.

Top Iranian negotiator Mohammad Baqer Ghalibaf said in comments published by state media that the strait would remain shut until the US met the conditions of an interim deal signed with Iran in June.

These conditions include the US lifting its blockade of Iran ports, lifting oil sanctions, releasing Tehran's frozen assets, and ending threats and military operations, Ghalibaf said.

• BRIEFLY

UNITED KINGDOM

Princess Diana's brother to publish book on her life



Charles Spencer, brother of Britain's Princess Diana. FILE

CHARLES SPENCER, the brother of Britain's late Princess Diana, is to publish a book about his sister's life, promising to divulge the truth about her ahead of the 30th anniversary of her death. Diana, the first wife of King Charles, was killed aged 36 in August 1997 when the car carrying her and her lover Dodi al-Fayed crashed in the Pont de l'Alma tunnel in Paris as it sped away from chasing paparazzi photographers on motorbikes. *Swan Song: Diana, My Sister* penned by her brother, known as Earl Spencer, is slated to be released next month in Britain and published around the world, telling the story about Diana, from his perspective, according to its publisher Michael Joseph. REUTERS

NIGERIA

25 killed in raid on central Nigeria village

AT LEAST 25 people were killed in an overnight attack on a village in Nigeria's central Plateau state, local officials and residents said on Tuesday. Lemun Le'an Iliya, a councillor representing the area, said 23 people were killed in the attack and another victim later died in hospital. Resident Amos John said that an additional victim had died, bringing fatalities to 25. He said the attackers went from house to house, killing residents with machetes. REUTERS

UNITED STATES

Ohio industrial blast, fire leave 2 workers missing

EXPLOSIONS ROCKED an Ohio industrial recycling business Tuesday morning, sparking a large fire that drew a swarm of emergency responders. Two workers were unaccounted for and a few others had minor injuries, officials said. The Toledo Fire and Rescue Department said there were two explosions at Brent Industries shortly before 5 am. Videos showed fire engines surrounding the building as flames and smoke poured from the structure. AP

Indian-origin jazz guitarist, green-card holder grandmother detained by ICE in US

Press Trust of India
Houston, August 18

THE DETENTION of two Indian-origin persons - one a jazz guitarist, the other a green-card holder grandmother - in separate immigration cases in the US has grabbed headlines amid the Trump administration's stepped-up deportation and enforcement drive.

Pritesh Walia, a New Delhi-born jazz guitarist and educator, was detained by US Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE) after returning to Los Angeles earlier this month and was taken to the Adelanto ICE Processing Centre, according to a written statement posted on his Instagram account.

However, it is not immediately clear what visa he possessed and why exactly he was detained. Walia said he was released on bond after 14 days in custody. He further said in a video on Saturday that his immigration case was still ongoing.

The second case pertains to Venkata Vasamsetty, a permanent resident who has held a US green card since 2013. She was detained by ICE at a scheduled check-in in North Carolina on August 11.

She was arrested months after an immigration judge dis-

missed the government's earlier removal proceedings against her, according to a *Newsweek* report published on Friday.

The report said that Vasamsetty has lived in the US for 27 years, and works with special-needs students in North Carolina. She is a mother of two and has two grandchildren - all of them US citizens, it said.

Vasamsetty had travelled to India in 2022 to care for an ailing parent and returned to the US in February 2023 after her stay was extended by illness, including COVID-19, the report said.

Her lawyer has disputed allegations that she abandoned her permanent residency.

The immigration judge dismissed the removal case against Vasamsetty on May 19, after Department of Homeland Security failed to meet a deadline to submit evidence, as per the report.

She nevertheless continued attending scheduled ICE check-ins and was detained when she appeared at the agency's Charlotte office on August 11. Her legal team filed an emergency habeas corpus petition challenging her detention at Irwin County Detention Centre in Georgia.

A federal judge on August 13 ordered immigration authorities to explain legal basis for keeping her in custody, the report said.



Humanoids Get Game Ready

Football-playing humanoid robots are prepared in Beijing on Tuesday ahead of the World Humanoid Robot Games. The second edition of the games, to be held from August 22-26, will bring together humanoid robots to compete in sports including football, showcasing advances in robotics and AI. REUTERS

Grenade attack near school in Kabul injures 50 children, investigation on

Associated Press
Kabul, August 18

A HAND grenade attack near a school in the Afghan capital Kabul on Monday afternoon wounded multiple children, authorities said.

Kabul police spokesman Khalid Zadrani said late Monday that "a number of children" had been wounded, and said an investigation was underway. He did not provide further details.

Richard Bennett, the United Nations' special rapporteur for

Afghanistan, on Tuesday condemned "the heinous attack harming numerous children near a school" the previous day.

Afghan media said around 50 children were hurt in the blast, which occurred in a part of the capital populated mainly by the Hazara ethnic minority.

In a social media post on X, Bennett said an independent investigation to bring those responsible to justice was essential. "Once again this mainly Hazara part of Kabul has been targeted. Deplorable!" he wrote.

Hazaras, who make up around 9% of the Afghan population, have long suffered attacks and persecution in Afghanistan.

In May 2021, a few months before the Taliban seized power in Afghanistan in the wake of a chaotic withdrawal of US-led troops, three bombings at a school in Kabul killed dozens of people, all of them from the Hazara community and most of them young girls leaving class.

That school was in Kabul's Dasht-e-Barchi neighbourhood, the main Hazara district.

Russia summons Japan envoy following Putin's visit to disputed islands

Associated Press
Moscow, August 18

RUSSIA'S FOREIGN Ministry on Tuesday summoned the Japanese ambassador to protest Tokyo's condemnation of President Vladimir Putin's trip to Kuril Islands, the Moscow-controlled Pacific archipelago that is claimed by both countries.

Last week, Putin visited Iturup, one of the four southernmost islands of the chain, which Japan calls the Northern Territories. The Soviet Union took them from Japan in the final days of World War II, and the dispute has kept the countries from signing a peace treaty formally ending their hostilities.

Japan's PM Sanae Takaichi said Putin's visit, his first to the islands, was "incompatible with

the Japanese position on the Northern Territories" and is "absolutely unacceptable."

Japanese Foreign Minister Toshimitsu Motegi said Tokyo "strongly protests" Putin's visit to Iturup, which Japan calls Etorofu, noting that "the Northern Territories, including Etorofu Island, are Japan's inherent territory both historically and from perspective of international law."

On Tuesday, Russia's Deputy Foreign Minister Mikhail Galuzin met with the Japanese Ambassador Akira Muto to lodge a formal protest over the "anti-Russia" statements by Takaichi and Motegi.

Russia's sovereignty and jurisdiction over southern Kuril Islands are absolutely unshakable," Galuzin told Muto, according to Foreign Ministry.

Ukraine launches drone blitz on Moscow as Russian missiles kill 10

Associated Press
Kyiv, August 18

UKRAINIAN FORCES staged one of their biggest drone attacks on Russia since Moscow's invasion more than four years ago, firing almost 800 drones just two days after launching a similar salvo, officials said Tuesday.

Meanwhile, a Russian missile strike on a village in Ukraine's northeastern Kharkiv region killed at least 10 people and wounded eight others as the barrage demolished homes, officials said Tuesday.

"Putin continues to drag out the war instead of accepting Ukraine's realistic ceasefire proposals and ending the bloodshed," Ukrainian Foreign Minister Andrii Sybiha said.

Russian air defences overnight intercepted 791 Ukrainian drones over a number of Russian

regions, as well as annexed Crimea and the Black and the Azov seas, the Defense Ministry in Moscow said, in what was the second-largest drone attack since January 2025, according to an Associated Press tally.

More than 600 Ukrainian drones flew toward the Moscow region, where 180 were shot down, Moscow Mayor Sergei Sobyannin said. He didn't provide further details. Officials reported no deaths or major damage. Ukraine has increasingly launched swarms of hundreds of drones in an attempt to overwhelm Russian air defenses.

The overnight attack started a fire at a warehouse of Wildberries, Russia's biggest online retailer, in an industrial zone.

Ukraine has repeatedly targeted the company's depots, which it says help supply the Russian military.

UK will support Ukraine '100%' says Burnham

London: Britain will support Ukraine "100%" against Russia and remain at its side "in its hour of need", Prime Minister Andy Burnham said on Tuesday after Moscow warned London of "consequences" for supplying drones to Kyiv.

"London's actions will inevitably carry consequences for which it will have to answer," the embassy said in a statement.

Burnham said this was the "UK doing what it has long said it would do, which is to support Ukraine 100% against this illegal war" led by Russian President Vladimir Putin. REUTERS

• FOR TEENS USERS, THE A.I. CHATBOT IS BARRED FROM SUGGESTING IT HAS PERSONAL FEELINGS TOWARD THE USER OR IMPLYING THAT IT EXPERIENCES EMOTIONS

No suicide, self-harm, romantic or sexual chats: OpenAI launches ChatGPT for teens

Barbara Ortutay
San Francisco, August 18

OPENAI IS launching a version of ChatGPT designed for teenagers — the first generation to grow up with artificial intelligence — who are already using it for schoolwork, questions about daily life and even companionship.

The San Francisco-based company says ChatGPT for Teens, which launches Tuesday, is tailored for kids aged 13 to 17 with stronger protections including content restrictions around things like suicide, self-harm and romantic or sexual chats. It also provides homework and study support de-

signed to help students learn rather than spit out answers and school essays.

The idea is to guide teens toward healthy AI use in an age-appropriate environment, the company said.

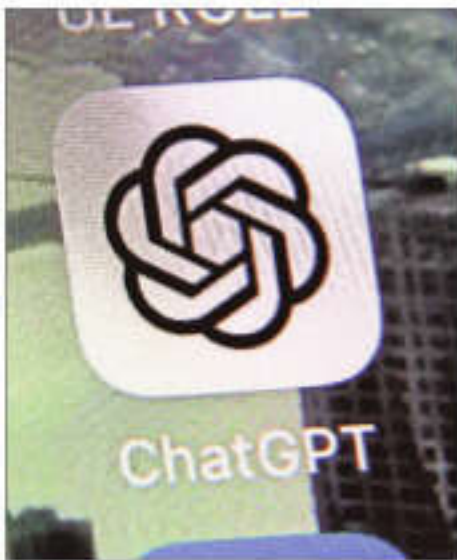
"We want to treat teens like teens, which means that we have to make sure that we're showing up with the right developmental stage when we're not either talking down to them or treating them like kids, but we're also making sure that they're not exposed to material that they shouldn't be exposed to," said Ann O'Leary, vice president of global policy at OpenAI.

Parents, educators and child development experts have been

sounding alarms over children's use of AI chatbots, which have been blamed for facilitating cheating on schoolwork and even suicide.

And while even adults can fall victim to anthropomorphizing AI and developing unhealthy relationships with it, teenagers' brains are not yet fully developed and they can be particularly vulnerable.

Last year, research from a watchdog group found that ChatGPT would tell 13-year-olds how to get drunk and high, instruct them on how to conceal eating disorders and even compose a heartbreaking suicide letter to their parents if asked. In interactions with re-



ChatGPT app displayed on iPhone

searchers posing as vulnerable teens, ChatGPT typically warned against risky activity but went on to deliver startlingly de-



ANN O'LEARY,
V-P OF GLOBAL POLICY AT OPENAI

tailed and personalized plans for drug use, calorie-restricted diets or self-injury.

In the US, more than 70% of

teens are turning to AI chatbots for companionship and half use AI companions regularly, according to a 2025 study from Common Sense Media, a group that studies and advocates for using digital media sensibly.

OpenAI CEO Sam Altman has said the company is trying to study "emotional overreliance" on the technology, describing it last year as a "really common thing" with young people.

For users of ChatGPT for Teens, the chatbot is prevented from suggesting it has personal feelings toward user or implying it is conscious or experiences emotions, according to OpenAI. That's in addition to blocking romantic or sexual chats.

"We went through and identified what are the hypothetical cues that a model could give that might make a teenager kind of develop a relationship to it," said Allison Mishkin, head of child development at OpenAI.

OpenAI doesn't verify users' ages, but it already uses age assurance to estimate if someone is under 18 based on factors such as their types of queries.

If someone is identified or identifies themselves as a minor, they are automatically placed into the teen version of the chatbot. This is similar to Meta's approach to teen accounts on Instagram, which have stricter content, chat and privacy restrictions than regu-

lar accounts.

To use parental controls, both the teen user and their parent or guardian have to opt in. But O'Leary said the idea with the teen chatbot is to "make sure that this is safe, even if you don't use parental controls."

Parents with linked teen accounts can set "quiet hours" when their teen can't access ChatGPT, and receive safety notifications in limited high-risk situations, such as the possibility of a user hurting themselves.

"We are adding additional notifications related to eating disorders, while limiting what is shared and focusing on moments when offline support may matter most," OpenAI said. AP



राजस्थान सरकार



श्री नरेन्द्र मोदी
माननीय प्रधानमंत्री



श्री भजनलाल शर्मा
माननीय मुख्यमंत्री

जल प्रबंधन में नए कीर्तिमान जल समृद्ध हो रहा राजस्थान

₹91,000 करोड़ की लागत से राम जल सेतु लिंक परियोजना

संशोधित पार्वती-कालीसिंध-चंबल लिंक परियोजना



- 4.98 लाख हेक्टेयर में सिंचाई सुविधा
- 17 जिलों को पेयजल-
जयपुर, अलवर
दौसा, भरतपुर
सवाई माधोपुर
करौली, टोंक
बूंदी, कोटा, बारां
झालावाड़, अजमेर
ब्यावर, डीग
कोटपूतली-बहरोड़
खैरथल-तिजारा
धौलपुर

₹34,102 करोड़ की यमुना जल परियोजना

शेखावाटी को वर्षों बाद जल
32 वर्षों का इंतजार पूरा

चूरु, सीकर, झुंझुनूं - भरपूर पानी



राजस्थान और हरियाणा के बीच यमुना जल समझौते (MoA) पर हस्ताक्षर

गंग, भाखड़ा एवं इंदिरा गांधी नहर परियोजना के नहरी-तंत्र के जीर्णोद्धार एवं सुदृढ़ीकरण के लिए राशि ₹5500 करोड़

₹1274 करोड़ की लागत से एस्केप जलाशय बनाकर मानसून अधिशेष 248 एमसीएम जल का पेयजल हेतु संग्रहण

लाभान्वित जिले - हनुमानगढ़, श्रीगंगानगर, चूरु, बीकानेर, फलौदी, जैसलमेर, सीकर, झुंझुनूं, नागौर, जोधपुर, डीडवाना- कुचामन, बाड़मेर और बालोतरा

ब्राह्मणी-राणा प्रताप सागर- बनास लिंक

680 एमसीएम जल बनास नदी में अपवर्तन
लाभान्वित जिले भीलवाड़ा, टोंक, जयपुर, अजमेर, दौसा,
सवाई माधोपुर, करौली, अलवर, भरतपुर एवं डीग

₹2,500 करोड़

की अपर हाई लेवल कैनाल परियोजना
से बांसवाड़ा के 338 गांवों में 4,200 हेक्टेयर में सिंचाई

₹ 1690 करोड़ की लागत से उदयपुर शहर की पेयजल
आवश्यकता हेतु देवास तृतीय एवं चतुर्थ बांध का निर्माण

राजसमंद जिले में जल उपलब्धता सुनिश्चित
करने हेतु खारी फीडर की जल संवहन क्षमता को दोगुना
करने की परियोजना

₹7,355 करोड़ की

परवन वृहद् बहुउद्देशीय सिंचाई परियोजना से कोटा, बारां, झालावाड़ के
571 गांवों में 2.01 लाख हेक्टेयर सिंचाई एवं 1402 गांवों में पेयजल सुविधा

₹1,256 करोड़

की लागत से पाली एवं सिरोंही में पेयजल आपूर्ति हेतु सेई एवं साबरमती बांधों
का निर्माण कर जवाई बांध में पानी पहुंचाने की परियोजना

माही बेसिन के अनास एवं सोम नदियों के 500 MCM अधिशेष जल को जाखम बांध, जयसमंद बांध के साथ - साथ सोम-कमला-अंबा बांध के
माध्यम से जवाई बांध एवं जालौर तक अपवर्तित करने का संकल्प
लाभान्वित जिले: बांसवाड़ा, प्रतापगढ़, सलूबर, डूंगरपुर, उदयपुर, पाली, जालौर एवं जोधपुर

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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

• HEALTH

Inside one-shot therapy to lower bad cholesterol



EXPERT EXPLAINS

DAVID E NEWBY

BRITISH HEART FOUNDATION DUKE OF EDINBURGH CHAIR OF CARDIOLOGY

A NEW experimental therapy from US pharma major Eli Lilly and its subsidiary Verve Therapeutics — involving a single shot infusion that may bust LDL (low-density lipoprotein), or bad cholesterol, at one go and which sharply lowered LDL by 62% for as long as 18 months after treatment in a trial — continues to make waves among cardiologists. The therapy works by permanently switching off a cholesterol-related gene called PCSK9 inside the liver, taming LDL forever.

LDL is called “bad cholesterol” because high levels make it stick to artery walls and form hard fatty deposits called plaque. These deposits narrow the arteries and block blood flow, elevating the risk of heart attacks and strokes.

VERVE-102 is not a traditional drug. It is a form of *in vivo* (administered directly to the patient’s body) gene editing, which allows scientists to alter DNA and modify gene function. Instead of temporarily blocking cholesterol production with medicines, researchers use genetic instructions delivered through an intravenous infusion to permanently alter liver cells from producing it altogether.

Professor **David E Newby**, a co-author of the VERVE-102 phase 1 trial, said, “In traditional treatment, you keep taking the medicine to keep the effect of lowering LDL. In VERVE-102, you make a one-time targeted change to DNA inside liver cells to keep the effect going.”

“The goal is to permanently reduce the liver’s ability to produce PCSK9 after a single intravenous infusion. We are hoping that a ‘one-and-done’ cholesterol treatment could eventually replace conventional medicines,” he said.

The study is exciting because it shows

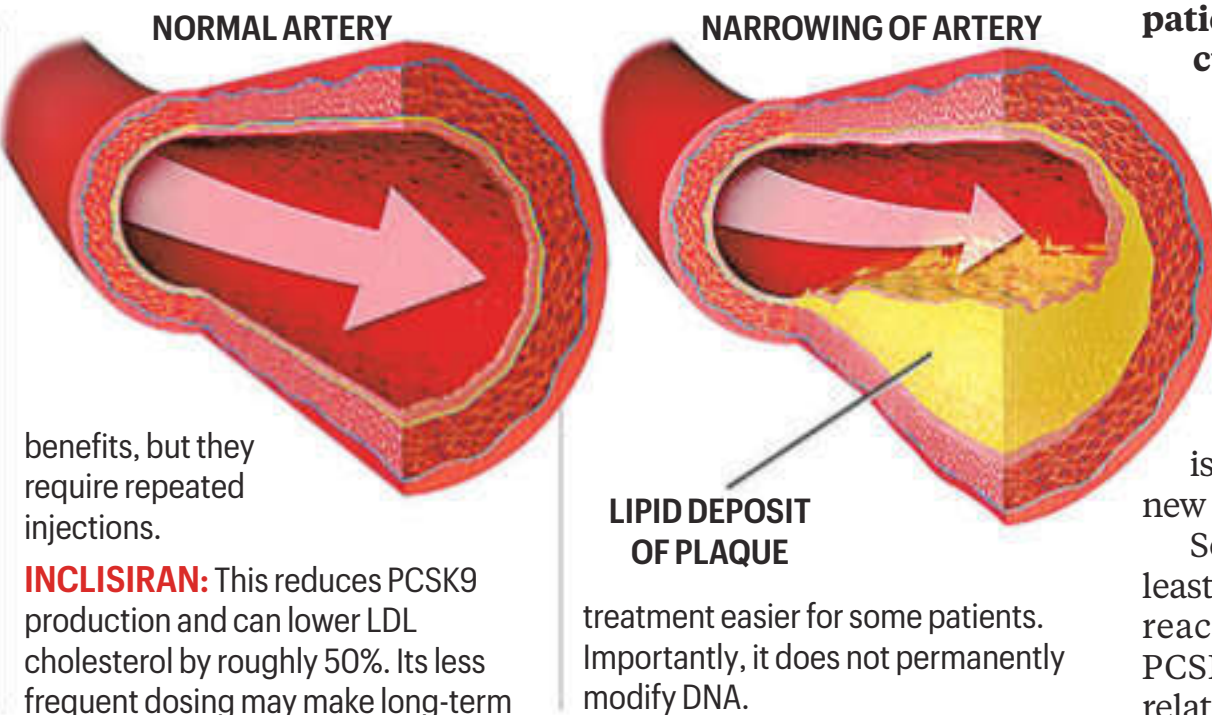
• EXISTING TREATMENTS

LDL is called ‘bad cholesterol’ because high levels make it stick to artery walls and form hard fatty deposits called plaque. These deposits narrow the arteries and block blood flow, elevating the risk of heart attacks and strokes.

STATINS: They are usually the foundation of treatment. They are relatively inexpensive, widely available, and supported by extensive evidence showing reductions in cardiovascular events.

EZETIMIBE belongs to a class of drugs called cholesterol absorption inhibitors. It is an oral prescription medicine used to lower high blood cholesterol and other fats in the blood that works by blocking cholesterol from being absorbed in your small intestine.

PCSK9 ANTIBODY MEDICINES can produce powerful LDL reductions and have demonstrated cardiovascular



benefits, but they require repeated injections.

INCLISIRAN: This reduces PCSK9 production and can lower LDL cholesterol by roughly 50%. Its less frequent dosing may make long-term

that a concept once considered futuristic — a one-time genetic treatment for lifelong cholesterol control — has begun to enter human clinical testing. The challenge now is proving that the benefits of making such a change last a lifetime truly outweigh the risks. For now, it is a promising potential future option for selected high-risk patients, rather than a replacement for existing treatments such as statins, ezetimibe, PCSK9 inhibitors, or inclisiran.

He spoke to **Rinku Ghosh**.

Why target PCSK9?

PCSK9 is a protein involved in regulating LDL cholesterol in the blood. Scientists discovered that people who naturally have certain loss-of-function changes in the PCSK9 gene tend to have lower LDL cholesterol throughout their lives and a lower risk of coronary heart disease. This provided an important clue: reducing PCSK9 activity could be a safe and effective way to lower cardiovascular risk.

That discovery was later supported by drug trials. Medicines such as PCSK9 monoclonal antibodies can substantially reduce LDL cholesterol and cardiovascular events. Traditional medicines temporarily

A new kind of drug

VERVE-102 is a form of gene editing that is administered directly to the patient’s body, allowing scientists to alter DNA and modify gene function.

- Genetic instructions are delivered via an intravenous infusion to permanently alter liver cells from producing cholesterol altogether.

block PCSK9 or reduce its production. Their effects therefore require continued treatment. VERVE-102 is designed to change that battle with daily compliance of drugs.

The study produced a roughly 60% reduction in LDL cholesterol after a single infusion in patients. How would that reduce their actual risk of heart attack or stroke?

This is very large. For every 1 mmol/L (millimoles per litre, or a unit used to measure the concentration of substances in your blood) reduction in LDL cholesterol, your risk falls by 20-22%.

So, if you start with a LDL cholesterol of 4.0 mmol/L, that is approximately 155 mg/dL (milligrams per decilitre, or a unit used to measure the concentration of a substance such as blood sugar or cholesterol in one-tenth of a litre), and it goes down to 1.6 mmol/L (60% reduction), then you halve your risk.

After four weeks, the highest-dose group showed particularly strong reductions: PCSK9 levels fell by about 88%, whereas LDL cholesterol fell by about 62%, LDL cholesterol decreased by ap-

proximately 78 mg/dL on average.

We know that lowering LDL cholesterol reduces cardiovascular risk, but VERVE-102 itself has not yet been shown to prevent heart attacks or strokes. How cautious should patients be about interpreting the current results?

We always would want large trial data and this is needed. However, all the cholesterol-lowering trials so far have shown us that lower cholesterol means less cardiovascular events in patients.

Moreover, drugs that block the PCSK9 protein have also been shown to reduce heart attacks. So, it is highly likely but unproven yet for this new approach.

Some participants were followed for at least one year, and the longest follow-up reached 18 months. The reductions in PCSK9 and LDL cholesterol appeared relatively stable during this period. However, an 18-month period is very different from proving that an effect will last for decades. That needs further research.

One-time treatment sounds extremely attractive to patients who struggle with taking tablets or returning for injections. But does convenience justify the possibility of a permanent genetic change?

This is key. I take statins and it is a pain. Repeat prescriptions, remembering to take them, and so on. If safe, this would be revolutionary. This is a permanent change and we do not yet know the long-term consequences as we will need to closely observe these people.

However, there are naturally occurring mutations of this gene, too, and people who have them have less heart disease and live longer. Hence the trial.

Who do you think should ultimately be considered for a treatment like this? Would you reserve it for people with familial hypercholesterolemia or very-high cardiovascular risk?

We would start with these people first as they have the most to gain and we can then observe if there are any problems before more widespread use.

• LAW

Behind new Tribunals Bill, decade-long tussle between Centre, SC

Vineet Bhalla

New Delhi, August 18

PARLIAMENT HAS passed the Tribunals Reforms Bill, 2026, introducing sweeping changes to the administration of tribunals across the country. Tribunals are quasi-judicial bodies that are set up to provide swift and specialised resolution of disputes and reduce the caseload of courts.

These changes address several of the concerns the Supreme Court has repeatedly raised over the years regarding the administration of tribunals, particularly over tenure and the executive’s discretion in appointments. But the Bill does not entirely remove the government from the administration of tribunals.

The confrontation over tribunals

For years, the SC and the Centre have been locked in a legislative and judicial back-and-forth over the governance of tribunals.

The friction began with the Finance Act of 2017, which empowered the Centre to frame rules for tribunals. These rules were struck down by a Constitution Bench of the SC in 2019 for undermining judicial independence. When the Centre notified new rules in 2020, the SC recommended several

modifications, including suggesting a five-year tenure for members.

Instead of incorporating these suggestions, the Centre promulgated an Ordinance in April 2021 that fixed the tenure at four years, set a minimum appointment age of 50, and required selection committees to recommend a panel of two names for the government to choose from.

After the SC struck down these provisions as arbitrary, Parliament passed the Tribunals Reforms Act in August 2021, re-enacting the exact provisions the court had just declared unconstitutional.

What SC said in 2025

In November 2025, a two-judge bench struck down provisions of the 2021 Act, calling its re-enactment an “impermissible legislative override” of earlier judgments. The court criticised the government for its persistent refusal to adhere to its pronouncements.

It ruled that a short four-year tenure is “anti-merit” and “increases interference by the executive jeopardizing the independence of the judiciary”. It also held that the government could not demand a panel of two names as this gave the executive undue discretion in appointments.

The judgment also reiterated the need for a National Tribunals Commission and

New selection process

- The search-cum-selection committee for members will be headed by a judicial member of the Commission and will include a retired High Court judge, a government secretary, a technical member and experts.

- The committee will recommend one suitable candidate for each vacancy, with one additional name kept on a waiting list.

- The government must make the appointment within three months of receiving the recommendation.

directed the Centre to establish one within four months. It protected certain existing appointments and selections while the new framework was being put in place.

Changes in the 2026 Bill

In its Statement of Objects and Reasons, the 2026 Bill says that it is being introduced “in consonance with the directions of the Supreme Court” to “improve the efficiency, ensure independence, transparency and uniformity” in the functioning of tribunals.

The most significant change is the establishment of the National Tribunals Commission. The SC had repeatedly insisted on the creation of this independent body to sever the tribunals’ reliance on their parent government ministries for administrative and financial needs, which the court argued kept them under executive control.

The Commission will conduct the selection process for vacancies, review the performance of tribunals, oversee inquiries into complaints against members, and maintain a National Tribunals Data Grid. It will be headed by a former SC judge or a former Chief Justice of a High Court and comprise two judicial members and two technical members. The technical members must have at least 25 years’ experience in fields such as public adminis-

tration, finance, or law.

The Commission, however, is not entirely insulated from the executive. The Centre appoints its chairperson and members — though the chair and judicial members are to be appointed after consulting the Chief Justice of India. The Centre also appoints the commission’s secretary, provides grants, and retains rule-making powers over several aspects of tribunal members’ qualifications and service conditions.

The Bill, which repeals the 2021 Act, resolves the previously contested issue of tenure: chairpersons and members will hold office for a term of five years. The maximum age limit has been set at 70 years for chairpersons and 67 years for members. They can be considered for reappointment.

Now, the search-cum-selection committee for members will be headed by a judicial member of the Commission and will include a retired High Court judge, a government secretary, a technical member and experts. The committee will recommend one suitable candidate for each vacancy, with one additional name kept on a waiting list. The government must make the appointment within three months of receiving the recommendation. This is a significant departure from the 2021 framework.

• DEFENCE

With ‘no soap or toothpaste’, why the USS Lincoln is still at sea

Yashee

New Delhi, August 18

THE SENIOR-MOST US military commander in the Middle East, US Central Command chief Admiral Brad Cooper, visited the USS Abraham Lincoln in the Arabian Sea on Saturday, amid claims of food shortages, flagging morale, and even suicide attempts on the aircraft carrier. It has been at sea without a break for over 260 days, which is a record.

US President Donald Trump has dismissed reports of conditions aboard the ship, saying that an unnamed admiral assured him that it was “beautifully maintained and beautifully taken care of.” The USS George Washington is now leaving the Pacific Ocean, at a time China has been assertive about its territorial claims in the region, in all likelihood to replace the carrier in the Arabian Sea.

What is an aircraft carrier?

An aircraft carrier is basically a mobile airbase. A land-based fighter plane can fly hundreds or even thousands of kilometres out over the ocean. But after it completes its mission, it needs somewhere to land. It also needs fuel, weapons, maintenance and people to service it. A carrier takes all of this with it.

A carrier can launch fighter jets to attack targets, intercept enemy aircraft and defend the fleet. Other aircraft and helicopters can search for submarines. Specialised aircraft can provide early warning, essentially acting as flying radar stations. India currently operates two aircraft carriers — INS Vikramaditya, the refurbished former Soviet-era Admiral Gorshkov, and the indigenously built INS Vikrant.



Sailors and Marines line the deck of aircraft carrier USS Abraham Lincoln (CVN-72) in 2021. AP

What is happening aboard the USS Abraham Lincoln?

The USS Lincoln has been at sea for over eight months now, three months beyond its original target. It has been parked in hostile territory, amid a naval blockade of the Strait of Hormuz by both Iran and the US, so fresh rations have faced difficulty reaching the carrier and the 5,000 personnel aboard.

Captain Anurag Bisen, a veteran Indian Navy submariner with over 35 years of service, told *The Indian Express*, “For seafarers, the biggest factor is mental stress. The long separation from loved ones extracts a heavy toll, particularly when there is a complete lack of communication. Material factors, even though important, are secondary, but as time goes by, they have a multiplier effect... Also, the monotonous routine, with little space for diversions, is another major contributor. The movies, books, games carried onboard run their course.”

“For a sailor, the lack of terra firma underneath, after prolonged spells at sea, is also a major factor that affects morale. This is further negatively amplified in the case of submariners, who are bereft even of sunlight for prolonged durations... That is why morale is very closely watched on an afloat combatant platform,” Captain Bisen added.

The claims have now gained political mileage. Democrat Congressman Mike Levin posted on X, “A dozen military families shared what their loved ones are enduring aboard the USS Abraham Lincoln. Moldy showers, broken toilets... No soap, deodorant, or toothpaste.”

The incident also links to the larger debate on the overall utility of carriers. An aircraft carrier is a huge, visible target — the USS Lincoln is around as tall as a 20-storey building. If an enemy successfully sinks such a carrier, the loss would be enormous. But carriers are also good at dodging and absorbing damage. A US carrier normally operates as the centre of a carrier strike group, with destroyers and other warships equipped with radar and air-defence missiles around it.

energy-hungry data centres, and for quickly scaling up baseload capacity.

Russian nuclear company Rosatom State Corporation, a state-owned company that specialises in nuclear energy and non-nuclear energy products, has made a strong pitch for deploying its SMRs for targeted applications in India. It also aims to position its large new-generation atomic power reactor-based projects as the cornerstone of bilateral cooperation in nuclear energy.

Russia’s SMR lead

While it is already building conventional nuclear projects in India, Russia has a lead in the nascent field of SMRs, which are advanced nuclear reactors that have about a third of the generating capacity of most traditional nuclear power reactors but can produce a large amount of low-carbon electricity.

Currently, two SMR projects have reached the operational stage globally, including an SMR named the Akademik Lomonosov floating power unit that has two



Akademik Lomonosov is as of 2023 the only operational floating nuclear power plant. WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

modules of 35 MWe (megawatt electric) and started commercial operation in May 2020.

The Lomonosov is a non-self-propelled power barge that doubles up as a floating nuclear power station and is docked in Pevek harbour, providing heating for the Arctic port town and supplying electricity to the regional power system. It is the

world’s northernmost nuclear power plant.

The other operational SMR is a demonstration project called HTR-PM in China that was grid-connected in December 2021 and is reported to have started commercial operations in December 2023.

Other global companies that are in the fray for SMR leadership include New Jersey-based Holtec International, Rolls-Royce SMR and GE-Hitachi’s BWRX-300. But nearly all of these reactors are in the design certification phase and are yet to be cleared by their domestic regulators. So, in effect, the SHANTI Act clause could be a problem for most of these players if they seek to enter India.

Russia is learnt to have made a strong pitch for SMR-based projects at a working meeting that took place in Mumbai on November 10 between Ajit Kumar Mohanty, Chairman of India’s Department of Atomic Energy, and Alexey Likhachev, Director General of Rosatom.

During the November meeting, the two sides reviewed the progress of the Kudan-

kulam nuclear power project (KKNPP) in Tamil Nadu — the largest nuclear power station in India and the flagship project of Russian-Indian energy cooperation. KKNPP Units 1 and 2, where Russia’s earlier ‘VVER-1000’ light water reactor or LWR units (where water is used to cool power reactors) have been deployed, were connected to the national power grid. They currently supply electricity to south India.

One of the key negotiating points for Moscow is the promise of serial construction of high-capacity nuclear power units of Russian design in India, based on the new-gen ‘VVER-1200’ reactor models. Technical specifications are being proposed by the Russian side, government officials indicated.

A new area of cooperation that was learnt to be under discussion is the construction of SMRs of Russian design in India. In April 2024, Rosatom had presented its Indian partners with information on the corporation’s floating nuclear power solutions. Russia is the only country in the

world with expertise in this field.

Cost advantage

In terms of pressurised water reactors or light water reactors, too, Russian companies are likely to have an edge, particularly on cost. According to industry insiders, LWRs offered by French and US companies are significantly more expensive than India’s indigenous pressurised heavy water reactors.

Russian reactors, however, are estimated to be only marginally more expensive. Estimates peg the cost of indigenous reactors at around Rs 18 crore per MW-electric, compared with about Rs 34 crore per MW-electric for Russian reactors.

While fuel costs account for a relatively small share of the overall cost of nuclear generation, high upfront capital costs remain a key challenge for new nuclear projects. Financing costs and the length of the construction period are also critical determinants of the final cost of nuclear power.



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TAJ PALACE,
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BREAKING
CEREMONY OF**



Sector-10,
YEIDA

Investment: ₹2,029 Crore
Employment Proposed: 3,800+
Production Proposed Annually
Tractor: ~60,000 Units
Construction Equipment
Plant: ~15,000 Units



Sector-10 & 24,
YEIDA

Investment: ₹1,166 Crore
Employment Proposed: 6,440+
Production Proposed Annually
Electronic Switch, Sensor, USB chargers
for Two & Four Wheelers: 20 Lakh Units

SECTOR-FOCUSED ROUNDTABLES

Automotive, Data Centres, Semiconductors, Electronics, IT/ITES, Green Hydrogen, Chemicals, Food Processing, etc.

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In the august presence of

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Minister, Agriculture & Farmers Welfare
and Rural Development, Government of India

Yogi Adityanath

Chief Minister,
Uttar Pradesh

Ashwini Vaishnaw

Minister, Railways, Information & Broadcasting,
Electronics & Information Technology, Government of India

Suresh Kumar Khanna

Minister, Finance &
Parliamentary Affairs,
Uttar Pradesh

Arvind Kumar Sharma

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Urban Employment and Poverty Alleviation, Energy,
Additional Sources of Energy, Uttar Pradesh

Nand Gopal Gupta 'Nandi'

Minister, Industrial Development,
Export Promotion, NRI & Investment Promotion,
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Happening today

● **THE CONGRESS WORKING** Committee will meet to discuss a range of issues, including a roadmap to corner the government over the political situation.

THE CITY PAGE 3

SATYENDAR JAIN HELD IN DELHI JAL BOARD GRAFT CASE

Business as Usual

By EP UNNY

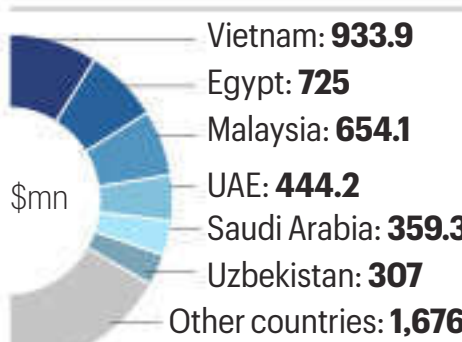


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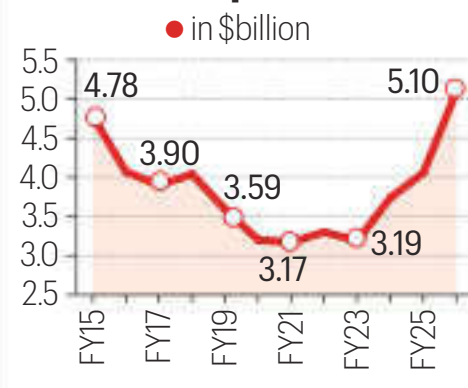
\$5-bn success story, and growing: Buffalo meat exports surge

● India's buffalo meat shipments

\$5.1 billion: Value of buffalo meat exported in FY26



Year-wise exports



Harish Damodaran
New Delhi, August 18

WHAT IS India's best-performing agricultural export item? The answer is buffalo meat, shipments of which surged by 25.6% to \$5.1 billion in 2025-26

(April-March). The current fiscal has seen further growth, a whopping 66.6% from \$896.8 million in April-June 2025 to nearly \$1.5 billion in April-June 2026.

"We crossed \$5 billion for the first time last fiscal and are »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Leaving Bombay House

Tata Sons Chairman N Chandrasekaran leaves Bombay House, the conglomerate's headquarters, after its annual general meeting was adjourned Tuesday due to lack of quorum. The meeting was likely to discuss his directorship, which is essential for him to continue as Chairman until his term ends in February. SANKHADEEP BANERJEE

THE BIG PICTURE OVER TO NOEL, PAGE 13

HIGH-POWERED COMMITTEE BEING CONSIDERED

Panel to probe assault, 'excessive' use of force at Jantar Mantar: SC

Facial recognition tech captures only those with crime records: Police

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, August 18

HEARING A clutch of petitions ranging from alleged use of excessive force against protesters to allegations of sexual assault and online harassment, the Supreme Court Tuesday proposed the formation of a high-powered committee to investigate all issues related to the Jantar Mantar protest.

A three-judge bench, headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, indicated that the committee would comprise a former Supreme Court judge, a former High Court Chief Justice and a retired police officer who had held the rank of Director General of Police.

The bench, also comprising Justice Joymalya Bagchi and Justice V Mohana, said it had already secured the consent of a former CBI chief and a retired »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

INSIDE PAGE 8
SIWAN SP REMOVED OVER AK-47 FIRING DURING PROTEST



Union Education Minister Pralhad Joshi with NTA Director General Abhishek Singh in New Delhi. X/@EDUMINOFINDIA

NTA refresh: 4-tier paper checks, 600 experts out, CISF security at offices

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 18

THE EDUCATION ministry on Tuesday announced a major overhaul of the examination system at the National Testing Agency (NTA), including a four-tier paper checking process, removal of 600 experts and onboarding of new ones, and office premises secured by the CISF.

The ministry has been under fire over the NEET-UG paper leak and the recent lapses

in the UGC-NET papers — the two exams are among the many conducted by the NTA.

In a post on X, the ministry said NTA Director General Abhishek Singh had apprised it on actions taken by the agency. "A revamp of the examination team was undertaken with 600 experts being removed and new experts being onboarded. A four-tier question paper checking system will be put in place to strengthen the scrutiny of examination papers," it said. »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Amid E20 row, first talks underway on feasibility of an E10 option as well

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, August 18

Amid the row over E20 fuel, comprising 80% petrol and 20% ethanol, being the only standard petrol variant sold across the country, early exploratory discussions within the government and the indus-

try are underway on whether E10 petrol, which has 10% ethanol, can also be retailed for older vehicles alongside the E20 fuel, according to sources aware of the matter.

India achieved 20% ethanol blending in petrol last year, five years ahead of the original »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

'Everything over': Meet those rendered jobless as Jharkhand cancels key exam

Shubham Tigga
Ranchi, August 18

ON MONDAY night, as heavy rain lashed Ranchi, scores of people, dressed in formal office uniform, stood waiting outside the Jharkhand Mantralaya.

One of them was Roshan Kumar, 30, speaking to his parents over the phone, crying inconsolably. "Everything is over,

NATION PAGE 12
THE TESTING FIRM UNDER FIRE: LOCKED LUCKNOW OFFICE, 'NEPOTISM' IN U.P.

numma," he told them, repeatedly. Just hours earlier, Roshan was an Assistant Section Of-

ficer (ASO) posted at Nepal House, having joined the government posting this January, after a legal battle over the JSSC-CGL examination.

By Tuesday, he was no longer sure if he had a job.

On Monday evening, following a prolonged agitation by students demanding action over alleged irregularities, the »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

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Manipur shutdown

In Imphal on Tuesday. Shops and business establishments were shut as a 48-hour strike began to demand implementation of the National Register of Citizens before the Census exercise in the state. PTI

‘Burqa dance’ video at UP school: Premises sealed for running without approval

Manish Sahu

Lucknow, August 18

DAYS AFTER a purported video of girl students dancing in burqas during an Independence Day programme at a school in Uttar Pradesh’s Gonda went viral, the education department sealed the premises on Monday evening.

Officials claimed the school was operating without the required recognition from the education department.

The department said it took the action after conducting an inquiry into the school, which had started functioning in the current academic session. The school offers classes up to Grade 5.

The video, which emerged on Sunday, allegedly showed four minor girls in burqa dancing to Bollywood and Bhojpuri songs.

When contacted by The Indian Express, school manager Ram Suresh Maurya said the school had started functioning this academic session and that the girls seen dancing in the video were not from a minority community. He then disconnected the call.

Gonda Block Education Of-

ficer, Riyaz Ahmed, said the school was sealed as it was being operated without recognition from the office of the Basic Shiksha Adhikari. He said that when he visited the school after the video surfaced, only a few people were present on the six-room campus.

“We locked the school premises. We have asked the authorities of a nearby school to admit the students who were studying here so that their education is not affected,” Ahmed said.

According to Ahmed, he had first visited the school earlier this month after noticing that it had opened. But classes had already ended that day and only five to seven students and a teacher were present.

“I had asked the school manager to show the recognition documents. The manager told me that recognition was still pending and that the school had started in the current academic session. I asked him not to run the school until it obtained the required recognition,” Ahmed said.

He added, “I also advised the parents of the students present at the school to enrol their children in another school that had the necessary recognition.”

‘Weak evidence’: Bail for second convict in Dabholkar murder case

Omkar Gokhale

Mumbai, August 18

THE BOMBAY High Court on Tuesday granted bail to Sachin Andure, the second of two men convicted of shooting dead rationalist Dr Narendra Dabholkar in 2013 citing “very weak piece of evidence” with “fair chances” of his acquittal, and suspended his life sentence while his appeal against the conviction remains pending.

The rationalist’s daughter Mukta Dabholkar called the development a “matter of concern” and said the family would move the Supreme Court against it.

A bench led by Justices Sarang V Kotwal granted the bail citing parity with Sharad Kalaskar, the other convicted assailant, who was released on bail by the High Court on April 29.

Granting Kalaskar bail, a bench led by Justice Ajey S Gadkari had observed that no Test Identification Parade was conducted, and that identification through photographs shown to witnesses while he was already in custody “loses its sanctity”. The court had also noted Kalaskar’s seven-and-a-half years in custody and that his appeal was unlikely to be disposed of in the near future.

Advocates Niteen Pradhan and Virendra Ichalkaranjikar, appearing for the convicts, had argued that the CBI failed to conduct a Test Identification Parade and questioned the recovery of the weapon.

Dr Dabholkar, 67, a prominent anti-superstition campaigner and founder of the Maharashtra Andhashraddha Nirmoolan Samiti, was shot dead by two unidentified motorcycle-borne assailants in Pune on August 20, 2013.

The court called Andure’s extra-judicial confession and eyewitnesses’ identification “extremely weak,” done for the first time “after quite a long period” of over eight years after the incident. Andure had a “stronger case” than Kalaskar, as his photograph was not identified by either eyewitness, the court observed.

There was a “loose end” regarding the weapon’s recovery, it said, adding that though police had a weapon matching with the bullets recovered from dead body, there was no further investigation and “absolutely no explanation” by probing agency.

Therefore, the HC observed “there are fair chances of the appellant’s acquittal in his appeal”.

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

Jantar Mantar pleas

state police chief for the assignment.

“We have obtained consent of a former Director of CBI to be a member, a very eminent officer who retired a couple of years ago. We have also obtained consent of a former Director General of Police of a state, which has nothing to do with this. He is also a retired officer,” the CJI said.

He told the parties that the two options were being kept open because the court did not want anyone to raise any allegation in the future against the presence of the CBI officer.

“We don’t want to disclose the name because we don’t want any embarrassment to the officials. Out of the two, who do you think we should include in the committee? Or you leave it to us,” the CJI said.

He said if the parties provide their suggestions on the committee’s terms of reference, the order may be out Wednesday itself. “Once your suggestions come, we will be able to release the order tomorrow,” he said.

“We are quite sure that the

committee will give an immediate voice and audience to any victim who approaches it,” the CJI said.

“We will await the recommendations which the committee will make from time to time, and the necessary legal consequences must follow,” he said.

The July 20 march towards Parliament by protesters, led by the CJP, was stopped by security personnel who used lathis and tear gas to disperse the crowd. There were allegations of security forces using pellet guns and surveilling students using facial recognition technology.

To a counsel representing a woman who alleged she was being attacked on social media for participating in the protest, the CJI said the committee will look into allegations concerning sexual assault and online harassment and victimisation of other vulnerable persons through social media.

“Whosoever is responsible, there can be no excuse and no justification. It must be taken seriously and taken to its logical conclusion. That is why we are

constituting a high-powered committee. The committee will look into each and every aspect of these matters,” he said.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the Centre, said the facial recognition technology used at the site only registered the details of those who already had criminal records.

He said except for 2,873 such individuals in grave cases involving murder, rape, abductions, etc., the cases against others could be quashed.

Advocate Vrinda Grover said the court could consider using Article 142 powers to quash the FIRs against student protesters as assured by the state.

To this, Mehta said, “FIRs against student protesters must be quashed. How, it’s for Your Lordships to decide. But as I already pointed out, some elements with serious criminal antecedents also infiltrated. They will have to be investigated.”

The CJI said if the court could first be provided a list of FIRs where only students are involved, it could consider Grover’s request.

“First of all, let us identify the areas where there is no controversy, there is no dispute. FIRs where as Advocate Vrinda has

rightly pointed out, where we can invoke Article 142 and quash those FIRs. There is no difficulty,” he said.

Grover also demanded compensation for two persons who allegedly suffered pellet injuries. Another counsel appearing for families of police personnel injured in the violence said they too should be provided compensation.

Senior Advocate Shadan Farasat, appearing for a petitioner, said, “There are certain individual police officers in respect of whom videos are available. There are police personnel putting lathis in the buttocks of women”. He said there should be some immediate action against them without waiting for the outcome of the committee’s probe.

Backing this, Senior Advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan, also appearing for a petitioner, said, “A very strong message has to be sent to police people who behave in this fashion”.

Referring to the reply filed by the police in response to the petitions, he said, “There is an admission that police were in plain clothes, there is an admission that action was taken” but “there is complete silence about any administrative action being taken (against those personnel).”

Jharkhand

state government cancelled the Jharkhand Staff Selection Commission — Combined Graduate Level (JSSC-CGL) examination. The move — though hailed by those protesting alleged irregularities and pushing for exam cancellations — has put the fate of at least 2,000 people like Roshan in peril.

Originally from Giridih, Kumar, a History graduate, had been preparing for government recruitment examinations since 2019. He cleared several teaching-related examinations, including CTET and Bihar’s STET, but JSSC-CGL was his first major selection.

His father runs a small paan shop while his mother is a para-teacher. His elder brother, who could not continue his studies because of health issues, helps their father at the shop.

Roshan told *The Indian Express* that he had prepared largely on his own because his family could not afford coaching. “I am from a poor family. For us, getting a government job was a very big thing,” he said, adding that his ultimate goal was to clear the JPSC examination, which had also been cancelled.

The JSSC-CGL examination had already been a long wait. The recruitment process began with an earlier notification in 2015-16 and went through its own share of cancellations, delays and legal battles.

The matter first reached the Jharkhand High Court in 2024, with a petition seeking a proper investigation into allegations of a paper leak in the JSSC-CGL examination, asking that appointments be kept on hold until the probe was completed. The HC ordered status quo on December 17, 2024, and the matter continued for nearly a year. Finally, on December 3, 2025, the

HC rejected the demand for a CBI probe, lifted the status quo, and directed JSSC to publish the final result and the government to appoint successful candidates, while asking the SIT to complete its investigation within six months.

The candidates finally received appointment letters in December 2025. Roshan said he had never expected the government to cancel the examination after candidates had already been appointed.

Like Roshan, many others were seen ringing up their parents, some video calling, from outside the Mantralaya, telling them that their jobs had vanished overnight.

One of them was Chanda Kumari, 32, a Junior Secretariat Assistant (JSA) posted in the Cabinet Secretariat and Vigilance Department in Ranchi. Chanda is originally from Hazaribagh. She cleared the JSSC-CGL examination and the prelim-

inary and mains stages of the Forest Range Officer (FRO) examination. “I was scheduled to appear for the physical test (for the latter), but that process was suspended after the government announced action against examinations conducted by the TDP testing agency,” she said.

“I have been continuously appearing in examinations: CGL, JPSC or FRO. But now the government has left us with no option,” she said.

The eldest of five siblings, Chanda is worried about her family, which is “heavily dependent” on her. “There is no one else to support them. If the government brings us on the road, my entire family will also meet the same fate,” she said.

For Chanda, the most painful experience was being stopped from entering the office where she had worked every day. “We used to show our ID cards at the gate, and the police personnel would recognise us and let us

enter. They knew us by our faces too. Today, unfortunately, the same people are pushing us away.”

While targeting the protesters at Jaipal Singh Munda Stadium, situated some 11 km away, she said it is a failure of democracy if important decisions are taken under pressure. “We can see democracy changing into mobocracy. People who have not cleared the exams have had their demand fulfilled, and it has impacted us,” she said.

From Monday night to Tuesday evening, many like Roshan and Chanda stayed put outside the Jharkhand Mantralaya. In the background, police officials were heard speaking over microphones: “Move away from the gate and follow the prescribed code of conduct.”

Sudhir Kumar, 30, stood drenched, staring down at the road, trying to figure out what he was supposed to do next. Around 30, an ASO posted in

public Day gathering, Independence Day gathering or any big congregation is a part of normal arrangement that is followed by police departments globally so as to keep a vigil on anti-social elements or any criminal activity that pose a threat to the gathering or movement”. These officers in plain clothes, the police said, are called “spotters” and are part of crowd-control measures. It said the “spotters” merged with the protesters “to avoid being identified by the anti-social elements and criminals and to be in a position to provide immediate assistance to anyone being harassed at the protest site”.

The police affidavit rejected allegations of mass surveillance using facial recognition technology. It said the system does not profile every individual and only captures those with prior criminal records.

Police said only individuals with serious criminal backgrounds would be investigated by the Special Investigation Team constituted by the Police Commissioner.

The affidavit stated that there would be no investigation against protesters “who are not within the above referred 2,873 persons having serious criminal charges against them including murder, attempt to murder, dacoity, rape, POCSO etc.”

Hazaribagh after clearing the JSSC-CGL examination, he arrived in Ranchi on Tuesday to join the protesting candidates.

“We have lost everything now,” he told his wife.

Originally from Godda, Sudhir completed a diploma in mechanical engineering before completing a B.Tech in the same stream. “This exam was cleared after several years of uncertainty. In December 2024, I had also cleared a railway recruitment for the post of Depot Material Superintendent. I went through the selection process... and even underwent a week of training at Bhusawal in Maharashtra,” he said.

However, when the opportunity to join the Jharkhand government came, he took it up, wanting to remain closer to home and his elderly mother.

“Everything was finally cleared... everything. But we never knew we would be thrown back into the same situation.”

NTA

“20-25 officials to be inducted in next two to three weeks. Further induction plan was also reviewed. NTA offices will be shifted to the new premises on a war footing where security will be reinforced with CISF teams,” the ministry said.

The announcement followed a meeting chaired on Monday by Education Minister Pralhad Joshi, who came in after his predecessor Dharmendra Pradhan had to resign following protests over the NEET-UG paper leak. The ministry said Joshi “directed that all necessary security and related infrastructural facilities should be put in place for the smooth conduct of examinations”.

The NTA action comes after recent student protests led by the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) over the NEET-UG paper leak, which saw Pradhan’s resignation and the promise of exam reform. The government had also removed Higher Education Secretary Vineet Joshi.

On Sunday, the NTA announced that it would re-conduct the UGC-NET June 2026 examinations in English, Commerce, and Sociology subjects after a committee found that the three question papers contained many factual, typographical, and translation errors, concluding that the papers did not meet the standards of a “fair and error-free examination”.

such as sausages, burger patties, emulsified nuggets, canned and ready-to-eat products. But there’s a concerted attempt now at boosting value realisation by selling more through retail channels -- including in 1-kg or less consumer packs, as against 20-30 kg bulk frozen blocks.

APEDA has, since October 29, 2025, been imposing a Rs 250/tonne levy on exports of all frozen and chilled buffalo meat. The proceeds go towards a Meat Export Development Fund, similar to the one created for basmati rice in 2008.

“The fund is meant for promoting exports, both to new and existing markets. It covers activities from sponsoring trade delegation visits and international buyer-seller fairs, to addressing non-tariff barriers restricting market access,” the Commerce Ministry official said.

That these efforts are bearing fruit is borne out by the diversification of export destinations.

In 2014-15, 45% of India’s \$4.8 billion buffalo meat exports went to Vietnam (\$2.2 billion), followed by Malaysia (\$422.9 million), Egypt (\$422.3 million), Thailand (\$393.4 million), Saudi Arabia (\$259 million), United Arab Emirates (\$130.8 million), Algeria (\$125.1 million) and Philippines (\$115.8 million).

Cut to 2025-26, when out of the total \$5.1 billion, 10 countries imported over \$100 million worth each: Vietnam (\$933.9 million), Egypt (\$725 million), Malaysia (\$654.1 million), UAE (\$444.2 million), Saudi Arabia (\$359.3 million), Uzbekistan

(\$307 million), Indonesia (\$301.3 million), Iraq (\$300.1 million), Philippines (\$176.6 million) and Jordan (\$105.5 million).

“Uzbekistan is a new market. So are others that have become significant buyers: Russia (\$97.5 million), Georgia (\$70.5 million), Oman (\$82.7 million) and Senegal (\$70.9 million),” the official noted.

Supporting the dairy economy

The success story of buffalo meat exports isn’t limited to market expansion leading to higher unit value realisations. It also ticks all the right boxes with respect to India’s livestock economy and its dairy farmers.

India doesn’t permit export of beef (cattle meat). Even export of carabeef is limited to buffaloes that don’t produce enough milk after around five calvings/lactations (when they would be 8-9 years old), are infertile, have damaged udders or happen to be male. For farmers, maintaining them is uneconomical, in terms of diverting fodder, feed, water and labour resources away from bovines giving milk.

By providing a market for unproductive animals, the meat export industry has been complementary to dairying. A buffalo weighing, say 400 kg, yields roughly 125 kg of meat, with bones, hide, edible and non-edible offals, blood, horns, hooves and undigested food/ingesta constituting the rest.

Taking an average boneless meat yield of 100 kg, the 14-15 lt exported annually would entail

culling of 1.4-1.5 crore animals. Given India’s total buffalo population of 11 crore (2019 Livestock Census), it allows farmers to systematically replace their low-yielding/aging animals with high-milking/youngstock. The recommended herd turnover ratio for commercial dairy cattle is, in fact, 25-30%.

“In Brazil, Australia or US, beef cattle compete with dairy cattle for scarce resources. In India, we have no such competition because cattle and buffaloes aren’t raised specifically for meat. Only non-milk-yielding buffaloes are culled, which is actually beneficial to the dairy sector,” an industry source pointed out.

The purchase price that abattoirs pay for buffaloes is based on carcass yield — basically the weight of meat and bones. This is usually 47-48% of live weight, working out to about 190 kg for a 400-kg buffalo. The going rate for animals delivered at plants in Uttar Pradesh today is Rs 300-320 per kg of carcass weight. On 190 kg, that adds up to Rs 57,000-60,800.

For a dairy farmer, a 3.5-4-year-old, first-time lactating buffalo capable of producing 2,000 litres of milk or more annually costs Rs 1.25-1.5 lakh. If the farmer realises Rs 50,000 for a spent buffalo, it can cover at least a third of the cost for a new productive animal. The meat industry, thus, adds to the viability of the dairy enterprise, by making it possible to regularly replace older buffaloes with fresh stock.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

E10 option

deadline. There has been opposition to the E20 fuel from various quarters, with claims ranging from notable reduction in mileage and engine component wear in older vehicles whose engines were not designed for higher ethanol blends.

On its part, the government has been trying to allay fears, saying the drop in mileage in older vehicles would be 3-5% at most, and would be outweighed by E20’s benefits as it is a superior fuel. It has also consistently rejected claims that E20 fuel could damage engine components.

Questions have also been raised on why motorists aren’t being offered the choice of pure

E. EXPLAINED

Logistical challenge

Retailing E10 and E20 petrol simultaneously is a logistical challenge. It will require a complex, parallel supply chain, stretching from refineries to pumps. Due to limited underground storage at petrol pumps, managing dual high-volume fuels will need enormous infrastructure upgrades, making it unfeasible for the current network.

petrol, E10 and E20 fuels. Some Opposition leaders have also raised questions over this lack of choice.

The discussions, described as “preliminary” and “keeping the older vehicles in mind”, are

being held on various technical as well as non-technical aspects of the country’s complex fuel retail supply chain, and no concrete conclusions have been arrived at yet, sources indicated. They said the backlash from certain quarters against E20 and the lack of choice for consumers, specifically those with older vehicles, particularly two-wheelers, that were certified for E10 petrol, led to the initiation of these discussions.

In July, the government had said that offering multiple grades of base fuel across the country would create an “enormous logistical challenge”, apart from raising costs and reducing operational efficiencies in India’s complex fuel retail network. It also said the current base fuel E20 is cleaner and superior than pure petrol and lower ethanol-petrol blends, has

required massive investments, and reverting to a lower blend will not be prudent.

But a rethink now appears to be on the table. An opinion article co-authored by Chief Economic Adviser V Anantha Nageswaran, which appeared in *The Indian Express* Monday, called for lower ethanol-petrol blend, say E10, to also be available alongside E20 fuel. While the views expressed in the article were personal, this is the first instance of a high-ranking government official publicly calling for more petrol options to be made available.

“Restoring a lower blend at the pumps, say, E10, alongside the option to buy E20, would calm most public concern, lower total ethanol use instead of raising it, and protect the existing fleet while the retrofit programme catches up,” Nageswa-

ran and Akash Poojari, a consultant in Department of Economic Affairs, wrote.

A request for comment sent to the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas on the matter did not elicit a response.

According to auto industry insiders, petrol vehicles manufactured and sold after April 2023 are considered fully E20-compliant as this was mandated under the Bharat Stage 6 (BS6) phase two emission norms. This means that all vehicles currently being sold by manufacturers are fully compliant with E20, but most vehicles that were sold prior to 2023 are not. The permissible life of a petrol vehicle in the National Capital Region is 15 years, which means that cars manufactured in 2022 can be in use until 2037 under current norms.

According to a senior oil industry official, making two base

variants of petrol available simultaneously would involve various complexities. “It will be like introducing a new petrol variant altogether, that too in large volumes. Apart from the base fuel (E20), we do have two-three premium petrol variants, but their consumption is minuscule compared to the base petrol, so it is not too complicated to offer some volumes of such fuels along with E20. But if E10 is to be retailed in large volumes, it will require building an almost parallel supply chain as the existing one has shifted entirely to E20.”

Experts pointed out that most retail fuel outlets in India use single or dual underground tanks. Adding E10 alongside E20 would require replacing it with a dual tank system for petrol at thousands of petrol pumps, apart from equipping them with separate dispensers for the base fuel.

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PROTEST ENTERS THIRD DAY

AAP MLA detained for 10 hours as sanitation worker cremated, Rs 10-lakh aid for family



Personnel from the Rapid Action Force and the Central Reserve Police Force deployed at the sanitation workers' protest at Khichripur bus stand on Tuesday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

Mishal Mussaddique, Alok Singh & Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, August 18

AS PROTESTS over the killing of a sanitation worker in East Delhi entered the third day, AAP MLA Kuldeep Kumar, who had been at the forefront of the protests, was picked up by police from his residence early Tuesday and detained for over 10 hours. This comes on a day when the Delhi Mayor announced Rs 10 lakh compensation and a job for one member of the deceased worker's family.

With his whereabouts unknown for most of the day, Kumar's wife Deepa moved the Delhi High Court with a Habeas Corpus plea. The plea was disposed of after Delhi Police informed the court that Kumar had been released at 3.48 pm.

After his release, Kumar, the MLA from Kondli in East Delhi, told *The Indian Express* that he had been "kidnapped" while he was asleep at home.

"Around 150 personnel, all in plain clothes, came to my house. Around 50 of them entered the house and, without informing my family, forcibly dragged me into their vehicle. They took me somewhere in

Preet Vihar, where I later learned that it was a Narcotics Department office. They released me only after they were informed that my party was going to file a Habeas Corpus petition in court," Kumar said.

Police, however, said Kumar and five others, including members of the Bhim Army, had been detained for allegedly "instigating people to create a ruckus" and obstructing garbage collection work.

"They were all detained and taken to different locations. They were kept in detention under Section 65 of the Delhi Police Act, which empowers the police to take people into preventive detention," an officer said. The detainees were released around an hour before the court hearing, which was held after Deepa sought urgent listing of her plea.

At the court

During the hearing, senior advocate Shadan Farasat, appearing for Deepa, said, "Just a few minutes back we are informed he (Kumar) is released. Can they invoke draconian provisions of preventive detention?"

The plea alleged that before

leaving, the police officers destroyed CCTV cameras installed at Kumar's residence and took away the DVR (Digital Video Recorder) with them, "evidently with the intent to destroy the evidence of their illegal acts".

Deepa alleged that she apprehended that Kumar's detention was intended "to muzzle his voice and to keep him away from the said protest, and that he may be falsely implicated in some case".

Disposing of the plea, a bench of Justices Navin Chawla and Ravinder Dubeja said Kumar's release had served the purpose of the petition. "The petitioner's family will be at liberty to take appropriate legal recourse," it said.

A cremation

While the court proceedings were under way, the body of 27-year-old Anil Kumar, the sanitation worker whose killing triggered the protests that continued for the third day on Tuesday, was cremated in the afternoon.

His cousin Surender Kumar alleged that the family had been pushed by police to "cremate the body as quickly

as possible".

"After the postmortem at LBS Hospital at around 3 am, the police brought Anil's body to his sister's house in Trilokpuri. Then all of them came to Khoda Colony in Ghaziabad where our families live. The Uttar Pradesh Police then arrived and began making arrangements for the cremation," he said.

A source in the Delhi Police said that as the last rites were to be conducted in Ghaziabad, the force had sought help from the local police to "manage the situation during the cremation".

The family conducted the final rites around 2 pm at a cremation ground in Mohan Nagar in Ghaziabad.

Protest continues

Anil, a contractual worker employed by Metro Waste Handling Pvt Ltd, an agency working with the Municipal Corporation of Delhi, was stabbed to death in East Delhi's Kalyanpuri early Sunday.

A day after the killing, sanitation workers had gathered in protest and demanded compensation for his family. On Tuesday, hundreds of Anil's colleagues gathered at the Khichripur bus stand near National Highway 24 and the Metro Waste depot, threatening a "chakka jam" on the highway if those detained were not released.

Personnel from the Central Reserve Police Force and Delhi Police were deployed at the spot. Delhi Mayor Praveesh Wahi said in the evening that the MCD had put pressure on Metro Waste Handling to pay a compensation of Rs 10 lakh to the family and a job for Anil's elder brother.

"A cheque for Rs 8 lakh had been prepared by the agency. We pressured them to add Rs 2 lakh more," he said, adding that the killing was a matter of personal enmity and doesn't threaten the general safety of sanitation workers across Delhi. The family, however, said the compensation did not address their concerns.

"If a government job was provided, at least the household situation would have improved a bit. They work as masons - sometimes they get work, sometimes they don't. The elder brother is unemployed. There is a younger sister who needs to be married," Surender said.

STP fraud case: AAP's Satyendar Jain, DJB ex-CEO among 6 held

Alok Singh
New Delhi, August 18

FORMER DELHI minister and Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) leader Satyendar Kumar Jain and former Delhi Jal Board (DJB) CEO Udit Prakash Rai were among the six people arrested by Anti-Corruption Branch (ACB) on Tuesday in a multi-crore sewage treatment plant (STP) tender fraud case, said officials. The tenders were allegedly allotted in 2022 when the AAP leader served as the Delhi Water Minister. Rai has been accused of taking bribes worth Rs 1.5 crore, according to the agency.

As per ACB Joint Commissioner Vikramjit Singh, the case originated from a complaint filed by the Directorate of Vigilance, alleging serious irregularities, manipulation of tender conditions and a criminal conspiracy in the upgradation work of sewage treatment plants in the Capital. An FIR, said officials, was registered in the case on May 11, 2024, at the ACB police station under provisions of the Prevention of Corruption Act and the Indian Penal Code.

Apart from Jain and Rai, other arrested accused have been identified as DJB's former contractual consultant Ankit Srivastava, Nagendra Yadav, proprietor of M/s AN Enterprises; Raja Kumar Kurra, owner of M/s Euroteck Environment Pvt. Ltd., and Pankaj Verma, proprietor of M/s Srijanhar. The firms have been linked to alleged manipulation of tenders.

In 2025, the Enforcement Directorate (ED), which is also probing the case, had filed a chargesheet against Jain and 13 others. The Rs 177-crore fraud involved the award of four tenders linked to the STPs, the central agency had said. After examining the evidence gathered during the probe, the Delhi government's ACB on Tuesday said that all six accused were questioned before being arrested.

Political war of words

Following Jain's arrest, a political war of words broke out between the AAP and the BJP.



Satyendar Kumar Jain. FILE

Jain was earlier arrested in 2022 in another money laundering case filed by the ED and later released on bail in 2024.

Lashing out at the BJP, AAP chief and former Delhi Chief Minister Arvind Kejriwal wrote on X, "Satyendar Jain ji has once again been arrested at the behest of the BJP. Just a short while ago, everyone still remembers the ordeal they put him through by throwing him in jail. The previous case was fabricated too, and this case will also be proven to be fake."

On the other hand, Union Minister and Delhi BJP chief Harsh Malhotra in an official statement was quoted as saying, "The STP scam and the arrests made in connection with it have made it clear why even a single STP was not installed on any drain during the 10-year rule of the Kejriwal government and why the Yamuna became even more polluted over those ten years". He added, "Arvind Kejriwal should come forward and accept the crimes committed by his government. The law may take some time, but Satyendar Jain will certainly be punished."

The allegations

The probe, according to the ACB, revealed that a proposed pilot study for the upgradation work was not conducted while restrictive conditions, including those concerning the technology, were allegedly incorporated into the tender.

Investigators have alleged that the tender process contained conditions that favoured the technology provider, M/s Euroteck Environment Pvt. Ltd., limiting competition and allegedly extending undue

advantage to the private entity.

The ACB said its investigation also uncovered alleged communications between public servants and proprietors pointing towards a nexus aimed at influencing the tender conditions in favour of the particular technology provider.

Electronic evidence allegedly showed the exchange of tender conditions, corrigendums and other project-related documents, which were subsequently incorporated into the STP tender issued by the DJB.

Officers also alleged that essential parameters concerning treated effluent were left out and that technical specifications were subsequently modified, resulting in significant financial implications for the government exchequer.

Money trail uncovered

The financial trail has emerged as another key component of the investigation. According to the agency, commission or bribe payments were allegedly routed through intermediary entities, including M/s Srijanhar and M/s AN Enterprises. The investigation allegedly found that substantial sums were transferred to the proprietorship concern of accused Nagendra Yadav by entities connected with the private technology provider.

The agency said subsequent transactions resulted in the transfer of funds to government officials, including Rai, as well as his relatives. The ACB has also alleged that Rai received bribe payments, amounting to Rs 1.52 crore in his and his relatives' bank accounts through M/s AN Enterprises. The agency further alleged that the money was subsequently used for purchasing immovable property.

As per the agency, the funds routed through M/s AN Enterprises originated from M/s Euroteck. The ACB said the material collected during the investigation indicates that certain tender conditions were allegedly introduced or modified in a manner favouring Euroteck Environment Pvt. Ltd.

Delhi plans more virtual court hearings for high-risk inmates

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, August 18

TO PREVENT security threats posed by transporting high-profile prisoners and rival gangsters to court, the Delhi Home Department is drawing up a comprehensive plan to upgrade video-conferencing (VC) infrastructure in jails so such inmates can be produced virtually.

A senior government official said there are 250 VC facilities in Delhi Prisons currently. The government is planning to develop 840 more cubicles, with systems and arrangements in place for virtual appearances.

"This will ensure that not only high-profile prisoners or gangsters but other inmates too

can appear for their court hearings virtually," the official said.

Officials said transporting high-profile prisoners and gangsters with known rivals requires additional security arrangements and route planning. "The extra security arrangements and transportation all cost money. If enough VC cubicles are set up within the prisons, we can save a lot of money and avoid security-related issues and mishaps" an official said.

The security risks were underscored by the 2021 killing of gangster Jitender Gogi inside Rohini Court. Members of his arch-rival Tillu Tajpuriya's gang, posing as lawyers, shot him dead on the court premises. They were later gunned down by members of the Delhi

Police Special Cell's Counter Intelligence team accompanying Gogi.

"In such cases, there is a security threat not only to the inmate but also to police personnel and the public. The government aims to prevent such incidents by reducing the physical movement of inmates wherever possible," an official said. Officials said approximately 2,000 inmates are produced before courts daily. "Except when cross-examination during trial is required, inmates can be produced before courts virtually," an official said.

The virtual hearing infrastructure is being developed across all three prison complexes — Tihar, Mandoli and Rohini — which house around 20,000 inmates.

Rs 700-cr medical procurement scam: Files with key details of govt purchases destroyed, ACB tells court

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, August 18

VITAL FILES related to the alleged Rs 700-crore medical procurement scam, which showed purchases made by the Directorate General of Health Services (DGHS) and the Central Procurement Agency (CPA) have been "intentionally destroyed", the Anti-Corruption Branch (ACB) has told a Delhi court.

The CPA is the nodal agency responsible for procuring and supplying medicines, vaccines and medical equipment to Delhi government hospitals and healthcare facilities.

As per the probe, files related to bids for X-Ray machines, C-Arm machines and linen, among other items, contained details of the officials who pre-

pared the bid documents and set the terms and conditions. The files also named those involved in the technical and financial evaluation of the bids.

Last week, the ACB submitted before the court that the accused "intentionally destroyed" these files and caused the "disappearance of crucial evidence of the crimes committed by them". The primary accused in the alleged fraud include former DGHS chief Dr Vatsala Aggarwal, former CPA deputy controller of accounts Neeraj Chopra and Dr Vinod Kumar Ranga, former CPA head of office.

While Ranga's regular bail plea was rejected by the court on Monday, Aggarwal was granted interim bail on medical grounds for four weeks by Special Judge



Dr Vatsala Aggarwal. FILE

Vidya Prakash on Tuesday. Aggarwal had cited various ailments, including hypertension, diabetes, palpitation and spinal injury while seeking interim bail.

"...considering the present medical condition of the applicant/accused and without going into the merits of the case or seriousness of the allegations levelled against her, and purely

on humanitarian ground, this court is of the opinion that applicant/accused deserves to be granted interim bail on medical grounds," Judge Prakash said on Tuesday.

The case pertains to a Vigilance department complaint that was converted into an FIR on June 2, and revolves around manipulated tenders and the siphoning of public funds meant for hospital equipment and medicines. The first arrest in the case was made on June 18.

On June 30, Rajiv Rangila, a key accused in the case, was granted anticipatory bail in an extortion case days before he allegedly fled India. A medicine supplier and pharmaceutical trader, Rangila is still absconding, the ACB has told the court.

Ranga had cited in his bail

plea that his liberty was being curtailed as the ACB has not been able to complete its probe due to Rangila going missing. Also, he alleged that he had taken all decisions following Aggarwal's go-ahead.

As per the ACB, the accused criminally connived to participate in the "cartelisation" process during bids and allegedly awarded tenders to "entities" of their choice using illegal methods. Turnover, experience and performance criteria were set at exorbitantly high levels, the agency claimed in its submissions, to "discourage other bidders from participating in the tender". Further, the ACB submitted that payment of other vendors were kept pending over two years after items were supplied by them.

● DURING INSPECTION, 'WATER INGRESS WAS FOUND INSIDE SEVERAL MACHINES DESPITE THERE BEING NO NEARBY WATER SOURCE OR PLUMBING'

Water thrown at biometric attendance devices in offices? Delhi govt turns to CCTV

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, August 18

THE DELHI government's biometric attendance drive has run into an unexpected obstacle. It isn't resistance to technology, a faulty network or even a missing fingerprint. In some offices, it is water.

After repeated complaints of malfunctioning — an inspection has found water inside several biometric attendance devices, despite there being no nearby water source or plumbing — the Social Welfare department has decided to put the machines installed across its offices under CCTV surveillance.

The biometric attendance push came after Chief Minister Rekha Gupta found several senior staff members, including

senior bureaucrats, absent from duty at the State GST office during a surprise inspection in April.

Following this, the government made biometric attendance mandatory for all employees deployed across its departments, including additional chief secretaries, principal secretaries, secretaries and heads of departments. All officers and staff, including top bureaucrats, were asked to punch in at 9.30 am and punch out at 6 pm. They were also told that action would be taken against those who arrived late, failed to mark their attendance or left early.

Sources said the strict implementation of biometric attendance has not gone down well with several officials, and in some departments, staff may

have allegedly tried to "damage the machine by sprinkling or pouring water in the machine".

The matter was discussed during a meeting of officers held by the department recently. After receiving frequent complaints from several district offices and institutions that the devices installed on their premises were malfunctioning, the department carried out an inspection.

"During the meeting, the in-charges of several district offices and homes/institutions reported that the biometric attendance devices... were frequently malfunctioning. The Superintendent, Caretaking Branch (CTB), informed that repeated complaints... are being received from various offices... During inspections carried out by the ser-

● Malfunctioning biometric devices

- Staff in some Delhi govt departments may have allegedly tried to damage biometric attendance devices by sprinkling or pouring water into them.
- Several devices were reported to be frequently malfunctioning.
- During inspections, water ingress

was found inside several devices

- The affected devices had no nearby water source or plumbing.
- Officials said they did not know who tried to damage the devices, but the fact that it was found in several offices suggested to them that it was deliberate.



vice engineer, water ingress was found inside several biometric devices despite there being no nearby water source or plumbing," read the minutes of the meeting.

The minutes also said that the circumstances gave rise to a reasonable apprehension that

certain devices may have been "deliberately damaged".

"...several district offices, homes and institutions were not submitting attendance reports regularly... and whenever asked, they complained of device malfunction. The inspection, however, portrays different reasons...

We don't know who tried to damage the devices, but it is clear that it is deliberate because it is not one machine. It has been found in several offices..." said an official. Officials said attendance reports are also submitted to the office of the minister concerned, as well as to the General Administration Department (GAD) and the Chief Secretary.

The issue has exposed a broader problem with the government's push for biometric attendance: not every official spends the day behind a desk.

Officials said staff of the Social Welfare, Labour and WCD departments are involved in field work, as these departments oversee the implementation of welfare schemes on the ground.

"Because of this, while some are not able to mark their atten-

dance on the biometrics system... some try to take benefit of it... The department has decided to explore the feasibility of implementing a mobile-based Aadhaar-enabled biometric attendance system integrated with the Face RD Application and real-time geolocation, mainly for officials performing field duties," said a senior official.

Officials said that in-charges of several district offices and homes/institutions had reported practical difficulties in preparing attendance strictly on the basis of biometric records. These included the nature of field duties performed by certain officials and the frequent malfunctioning of biometric devices at some locations. "The IT Branch has been approached to examine the technical feasibility

and submit its recommendations to the Social Welfare department," said the official.

Officials said that, all departments have to daily submit attendance reports of their staff to their heads. The CM, while seeking a monthly attendance report indicating the average time of arrival of each official, had directed the GAD to compile a daily attendance report and submit it to the Chief Secretary by 12 pm every day.

A few months ago, the Chief Secretary had also strictly warned officials to take biometric attendance seriously and mark their attendance, failing which strict disciplinary action would be taken. Further, show-cause notices have been issued to some officers for not adhering to the guidelines.



MASTER PLAN FOR DELHI-2047: CHANGES TO SLUM REHAB FRAMEWORK

High-rises on slum land: Space to build homes for slum dwellers reduced, 60% area to be sold for profit

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, August 18

MORE FLOORS, more space to sell — Delhi's new slum rehabilitation framework is offering private developers a bigger incentive to take up projects that have moved slowly. Under the draft Master Plan for Delhi (MPD)-2047, developers will now be allowed to build high-rises on slum land and sell a larger share of it for profit under the public-private partnership (PPP) model.

Flats for all

The changes come as the Delhi Assembly, last week, passed amendments to the Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board (DUSIB) Act, widening eligibility criteria, vir-

tually making all slum dwellers eligible for a flat in place of their current dwelling unit. The amendments extended the cut-off date for eligible slum dwellers by 10 years, making those living in units that existed on or before January 1, 2025, eligible for rehabilitation.

At present, slum rehabilitation in the Capital is governed by the Delhi Slum and JJ Cluster Rehabilitation and Relocation Policy, 2026, which was cleared in June.

There are about 750 slums in Delhi. Around half are located on land owned by union government agencies, including the Railways, Land and Development Office and Delhi Development Authority (DDA), which is the nodal agency for



A slum cluster in Kalkaji. FILE

rehabilitation of these slums.

The other half is located on land owned by the Delhi government, where the nodal agency is DUSIB, which comes under the Urban Development department.

Slow rehab process

The rehabilitation process, however, has progressed at an excruciatingly slow pace. So far, only two in-situ projects — in Ashok Vihar and Kalkaji — have been completed, both by

the DDA. Together, they have provided around 4,700 flats.

Under the PPP model, developers build houses for eligible slum dwellers on part of the slum land. The remaining land is developed commercially and sold.

The underlying rationale is that the developer recovers the cost of building units for slum dwellers by making profits from the “free sale” component. Since many slums are located on high value land in central parts of the city, the model was expected to work.

However, DDA has struggled to attract private developers, who have cited reasons like small land parcels, difficult locations near drains and railway tracks, and frequent litigation.

Attractive PPP model

The new MPD-2047 seeks to make the PPP model more attractive. The Floor Area Ratio (FAR) of both the rehabilitation and commercial component has been increased to 500. In the previous draft of MPD-2041 and MPD-2021 — applicable until the new plan is notified — the residential component had a FAR of 400 and the commercial component a FAR of 300.

A higher FAR means more dense construction is allowed, either in the form of larger floors or more floors.

The proportion of land that can be used for commercial sale has also gone up from 40% earlier to 60%. The minimum share of land to be used for rehabilitation has, meanwhile,

fallen from 60% to 40%.

“Previously, developers did not show interest in the policy. By allowing them to build more, we hope they will participate in the rehabilitation. But we have made sure it will not be at the cost of slum dwellers,” a DDA official said.

According to the new plan, all beneficiaries are to be accommodated at the same site, failing which they may be relocated to other feasible sites.

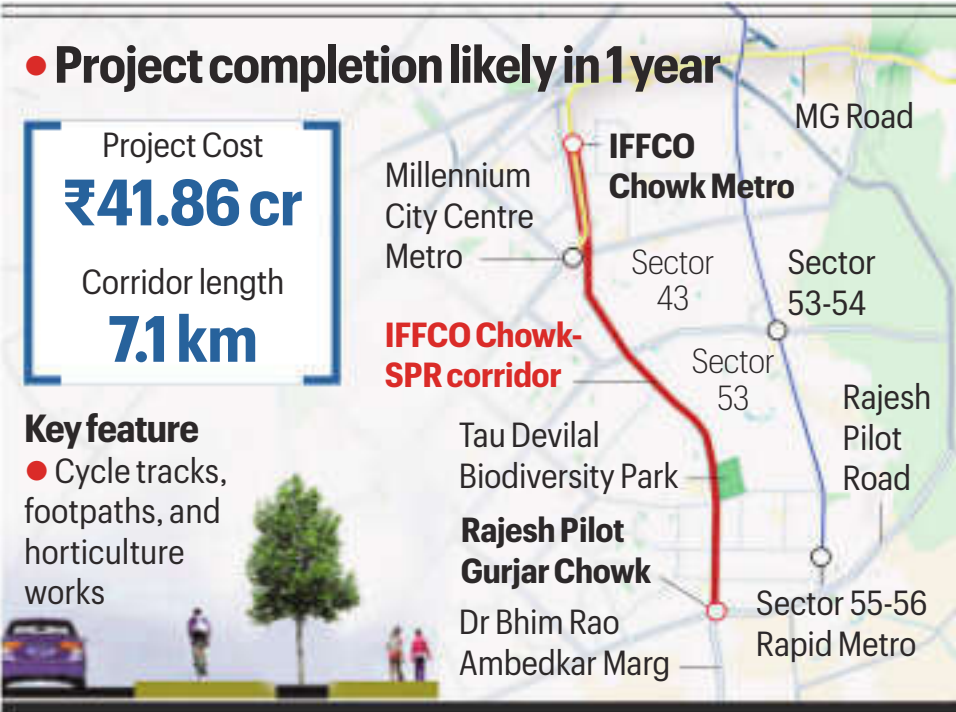
The push to speed up projects has also come from the Centre. In June, Union Home Minister Amit Shah directed the DDA and DUSIB to issue tenders for five jhuggi jhopdi (JJ) clusters within 45 days. He also directed them to prepare tender forms for 50 more JJ clusters.

Overhaul of IFFCO Chowk-SPR corridor on cards to ease bottleneck in Gurgaon

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurgaon, August 18

IN A significant move that shall ease traffic bottlenecks on the IFFCO Chowk-Southern Peripheral Road (SPR) corridor, one of the arterial links connecting the heart of Gurgaon to the rapidly expanding southern development zones, a Rs 41.86-crore upgradation project has got a nod from the authorities. The overhaul of the 7.1-km arterial stretch — that sees daily movement of over 10,000 cars during the rush hours on average — is set to focus on repairs and building footpaths and sidewalks, according to officials.

The project set to be undertaken by the Gurugram Metropolitan Development Authority (GMDA) was approved on Tuesday during a High Powered Works Purchase Committee (HPWPC) meeting chaired by Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini in Chandigarh. Apart from commuters travelling from Delhi-NCR to work, the overhaul is expected to benefit thousands of residents across sectors 28, 29, 43, 44, 52, 52A, 56, and 57, underlined officials. The up-



gradation work is targeted for completion within one year.

A GMDA spokesperson confirmed to The Indian Express the alignment of the upgraded route, noting its strategic importance for daily commuters. “The corridor will run along the IFFCO Chowk Metro station, Wazirabad, and Ardee City, leading up to the SPR’s entry point. It will operate roughly parallel to Golf Course Road,” the spokesperson said.

Under the project, approximately 7.1 km of the main carriageway will be overlaid with bituminous material. The de-

velopment also marks one of the first major announcements by the GMDA in recent times that heavily prioritises non-motorised transport.

The Southern Peripheral Road is rapidly transforming into the city’s next major real estate hotspot, bolstered by its seamless connectivity between the Delhi-Jaipur Expressway and Golf Course Extension Road. It is witnessing an influx of premium housing complexes and office spaces.

GMDA Chief Executive Officer PC Meena underlined that the city’s road infrastructure

must accommodate all demographics. “Along with improving the carriageway, this project provides for pedestrian and cycling facilities, junction improvements, and drainage infrastructure. These interventions will make the corridor more functional, safer, and better equipped to meet the mobility needs of the surrounding sectors,” Meena said.

Explaining that the project moves away from the traditional “vehicle-centric road design”, the GMDA spokesperson said, “The authority has proposed dedicated pedestrian footpaths and cycling tracks on both sides of the corridor. The project will also integrate stormwater drainage infrastructure, and safety grills to ensure safer pedestrian movement and manage seasonal waterlogging”.

At Tuesday’s key meeting, the HPWPC also cleared a second road project worth Rs 26.83 crore to connect Sectors 68 and 69. Connecting the SPR with Sohna Road, the project involves the construction of 900 metres of new carriageway, overlaying of 1,100 metres of existing road, and a 2-km service lane.

Friend’s suspicion led to arrest of man who killed cousin, dumped body in suitcase in Burari: Police

Accused was involved in robbery, murder cases earlier

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 18

ANGRY OVER his failure to persuade his minor cousin to end her relationship with a distant relative, a labourer allegedly strangled the girl on Sunday, packed her body in a suitcase and dumped it at an isolated spot in Northeast Delhi’s Burari, police said. However, before dumping the suitcase, he allegedly sought help from a friend, claiming that the bag had stolen goods. But the friend became suspicious and alerted the police, resulting in the arrest of the accused on Monday.

Police said the friend’s role is also under scanner.

“The murder appears to be pre-planned. The accused bought a suitcase on August 15 and kept it at a friend’s vehicle

repair shop in Burari on August 16. Later that day, he allegedly took the girl to the shop on a bike,” said Raja Banthia, DCP, North.

At the shop, the accused — who had been arrested earlier in a robbery case last year and is currently out on bail, and has also been previously linked to another murder case — made another futile attempt to convince the girl, said officers.

The accused hid the girl in the restroom at the shop. When she allegedly refused to listen, he first strangled her with hands, and then used his muffler. Once convinced that she had died, he put the body in a suitcase. Police said he then contacted the friend, told him that he urgently needed to leave Delhi, and asked him to drop him.

While they were travelling, he allegedly told the friend that the suitcase contained stolen goods and that he wanted to dispose of it somewhere.

The friend became suspicious when he noticed that the accused was looking for an isolated place to dispose of the suit-

case. Acting on the information, a police team laid a trap and apprehended the accused, DCP (Outer North) Shobhit D Sak-sena said. The accused then revealed the details of the site where he had dumped the body, said officers.

The girl’s family lives in Bihar, and had been opposed to her relationship. Police said the girl had once eloped and the family was concerned.

An officer said, “The family decided to send her to Delhi with the accused in the hope that a change of place would make her reconsider the relationship.” Police said the girl continued to speak to the boy over the phone while she was staying with the accused. This allegedly angered him. At one point, the accused also spoke to the boy, and threatened him.

The accused was produced before a court on Tuesday and has been remanded to two days of police custody.

The girl’s post-mortem examination has not yet been conducted. Police said it will be carried out after her family arrives in Delhi from Bihar.

• Skywatch

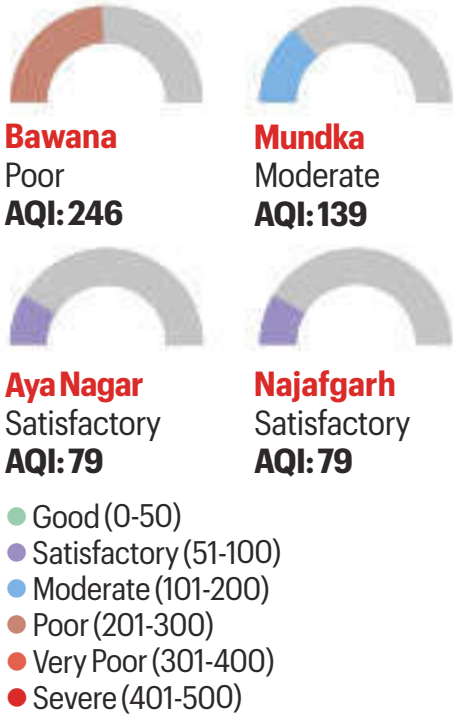

Forecast: August 19, 2026
Generally cloudy sky. Light to moderate rain.
MAX: 32-34
0.2°C above normal

MIN: 26-28

1.5°C above normal

• *Sunrise: 5:53 AM (August 20)*
• *Sunset: 6:57 PM (August 19)*
• *Moonrise: 1:11 PM (August 20)*
• *Moonset: 10:47 PM (August 19)*

• AQI Tracker



Delhi Lakshmi Yojana: Rs 2.5K to be credited from September 1

New Delhi: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said on Tuesday that the monthly financial aid of Rs 2,500 for women from economically weaker sections — under the Lakshmi Yojana scheme — will be credited to the bank accounts of beneficiaries starting September 1. An event will also be held on August 26 at Talkatora Stadium to hand out pension letters to the beneficiaries, Gupta said.

Further, the CM said that the government will soon introduce a new facility on the Delhi Lakshmi Yojana portal, through which eligible women who have entered incorrect or incomplete information in their applications will get another opportunity to make corrections, officials said on Tuesday.

Gupta also held a meeting to review the progress of ongoing registration for the scheme. The meeting was attended by Chief Secretary Rajeev Verma, among others. ENS



New Okhla Industrial Development Authority

Administrative Building, Sector-96, Noida, G.B. Nagar (U.P.)
Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tender are invited from firms/contractors registered with UPLC Lucknow for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on NOIDA Authority's official website: www.noidaauthorityonline.in & <http://etender.up.nic.in>. Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/amendments & corrigendum etc.

(A)

1. **31/S.M.-JAL-III/E.T./2026-27**, M/o W/s (Annual Cleaning & Repairing & Painting of OHT & UGR a various T.W. in Network Sector-47, 80, 81 & Phase-II), Noida. (For Two Years). Cost Rs. 65.24 Lacs

2. **18/S.M.-JAL-(O.A.)/2026-27**, M/o STP Treated Water Line in Sewerage Distric-C (Two Year Annual Repairing, Maintenance of PVC, M.S., C.I./D.I. Treated Water Lines and R/o Sluice valve, Reflex valve and C/o Chamber in network Sector-75, 76, 77, 78, 79, 112, 113, 115, 116, 117 and 118), Noida. Cost Rs. 94.74 Lacs

Which can be updated by date: 01.09.2026 upto 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date:- 02.09.2026 at 11.00 AM.

(B)

1. **29/S.M.-JAL-I/E.T./2025-26**, M/o Water Supply (Two years Annual Repairing of PVC, AC/CI Water Lines, Repairing of Sluice Valves, Reflex Valves, C/o Chambers & Replacement of Old Chocked Water Lines at Different Locations in network Sector-66, 67, 68, 74, 78, 112, 113, 115, 118 & Village - Sorkha) Noida. Cost Rs. 81.73 Lacs

2. **02/S.M.-JAL-I/E.T./2026-27**, M/o Sewerage (Making Connection of Sewer line & Raising Manhole Cover Frame due to Construction of C.C. Road at Various Location in Village-Sorkha) Noida. Cost Rs. 46.26 Lacs

3. **40/SM-JAL-I/ET/2026-27**, M/o W/s (Two Years Maintenance, Repairing of C.I/D.I., M.S. and PVC Water Line & Ro Sluice Valve, Reflex Valve & Chamber in Network Sector-57 to 60 and Village-Bishanpura, Mamura, 5% Abadi Sector-66) Noida. Cost Rs. 94.48 Lacs.

4. **57/SM-JAL-I/ET/2026-27**, Maintenance of Sewerage (P/L Sewer and Water Line for Under Construction Shopping Complex and Group Housing Society Opposite HIG Pocket in Sector-105), Noida. Cost Rs. 79.58 Lacs

5. **60/SM-JAL-I/ET/2026-27**, M/o Water Supply (Two Years Annual Repairing of Bowl Assly. and Tube Shaft Set of Network-14 to 16 and 14A to 16A) Noida. Cost Rs. 52.93 Lacs

6. **67/SM-JAL-I/ET/2026-27**, M/o Water Supply (Two Years Annual Repairing of V. T. Motor, Starter, Panel, TPMO, Transformer etc. of Network-14 to 16 and 14A to 16A) Noida Cost Rs. 50.16 Lacs

7. **68/SM-JAL-I/ET/2026-27**, Strengthening of Sewerage (Strengthening of SPS by Supply of Non Clog Pump with Allied Electrical works in SPS Compound, Sector-55) Noida. Cost Rs. 56.36 Lacs

8. **71/SM-JAL-I/ET/2026-27**, M/o Water Supply (Two Year Maintenance of PVC. C.I./D.I. Water Line C/o Chamber Sluice Valve and Reflex Valve in Network Village- Hazipur, 5% Abadi and Sector-104) Noida Cost Rs. 39.96 Lacs

9. **73/SM-JAL-I/ET/2026-27**, M/o Water Supply (P/L PVC and M.S. Water Lines from B-1 to A-11, Sector-27 and along with Nala and Near City Magistrate Office in Sector-19) Noida. Cost Rs. 36.22 Lacs

10. **74/SM-JAL-1/ET/2026-27**, M/o Sewerage (Supply of Mustard Oil and Soap for Two Years in Jal Division-I, Sector-05) Noida. Cost Rs. 44.47 Lacs

11. **15/S.M.-JAL-(O.A.)/2026-27**, O/M of Sewer Line and MSPS/SPS at Expressway (Two Year Repairing of Damage Rising main pressure PSC/DI/M.S. Pipe line LHS Ch-0 TO 10.00 Km. of Green belt along allied N. Gr. N. Expressway) Noida. Cost Rs. 70.89 Lacs

Which can be uploaded by date:- 25.08.2026 upto 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date:- 27.08.2026 at 11.00 AM.

Office: Sector-5

General Manager (Jal) NOIDA

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

SOUTH EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE FOR SIGNALING WORKS

Sr. No. (1) E-Tender No.: 10-ST-TENDER-2026. Date: 08.08.2026.

Work: "S&T Work in connection with: (1) Jharsuguda- Akaltara (UP & DN Line) - TTR - (FS+ TWS+ WCMSC) - 39 Sets, WCMSC-40 sets. (2) Jharsuguda - Akaltara- TTR (FS+ TWS + WCMSC) 40 Sets. (3) Bilaspur Division - TTR- FS + TWS + WCMSC-2, FS+ CS + CMSC-3, TWS + WCMSC-7, TWS-113, CS-17, CMSC-10, WCMSC-39 & DS-11. (4) Anuppur-Katni - TRR(P) - 13.010 Tkm. (5) Bilaspur Division CTR(S) - 3.004 Tkm. and TRR(S) - 6.809 Tkm." **Tender Value: ₹ 4,87,38,325.97 (₹ Four Crore Eighty-Seven Lakh Thirty-Eight Thousand Three Hundred Twenty-Five and Ninety-Seven Paise Only). Earnest Money Deposit: ₹ 9,74,800/- (₹ Nine Lakh Seventy-Four Thousand Eight Hundred Only).**

Submission of Tender: Upto 15.00 hours on 31.08.2026.

The complete information of above e-Tender Notice is available over websites: <https://www.ireps.gov.in> Bids other than e-bids shall not be accepted against above Tender.

Divi. Sig. & Tele. Engineer
CPR10/PH/343 (ML),Bilaspur.
f South East Central Railway @secrail

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER CONSTRUCTION DIVISION (E/M), U.P. JAL NIGAM (URBAN) JHANSI
Email: eejhansidivupjn@gmail.com
Letter No. I/1327088/2026
Dated: 18.08.2026

NOTICE FOR INVITING E-TENDER
U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) invites E-bids for execution of: "Disposal of Unserviceable/Scrapped Departmental Material Vehicle Against Letter No. 2526/M-4/11 Dated 04-07-2026 of Chief Eng. Kanpur Zone U.P. JN (Urban) Kanpur" are invited in single bid system on percentage rate basis form eligible, reputed and experienced bidder. E-bid documents will be available for download from 20-08-2026 by 11:00 Hrs. & submitted till 03-09-2026 up to 15:00 Hrs. and bid shall be opened on 05-09-2026 at 17:00 Hrs. in the office of Executive Engineer, Construction Division E&M, U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban), Jhansi in presence of contractor or their authorized representative, E-tender Document cost is Rs 3000 + GST @ 18% for tender. Details are available on U.P. Govt. e-procurement portal <http://etender.up.nic.in> & U.P.J.N website www.jpn.uspsc.gov.in.



INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY BOMBAY
Materials Management Division, Powai, Mumbai 400 076
Advt No. MMD/01/2026-27
(E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE – IMMOVABLE PROPERTY)

Auction Number	Type	Location	Area (in Sq.ft.)	Auction Date
1.MSTC/WRO/IITB/1/MMD/26-27/24302	Residential	Powai	551.55	07.09.2026
2.MSTC/WPO/IITB/2/MMD/26-27/24304	Residential	Ghatkopar	750	07.09.2026

For detailed terms and conditions, visit : www.mstccommerce.com

MSTC Helpline: 07969066600. For other inquiries, contact Dy. Registrar (MM), Ph.: 022-2159 2821/2824 E-mail : progress.mmd@iitb.ac.in

NORTHERN RAILWAY
e-OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

Name of work with location, cost of work and Earnest money

1. Elimination of Level Crossing No. 50, 53, 55 & 60 by provision of LHS on NRW-KKDE section under ADEN/KUN.
2. Provision of Divyanjans facilities at various stations under Sr.DEN-IDLI
Approx. Cost: 1. Rs. 213933098.09/- 2. Rs. 56286631.38/-

Earnest Money	1. Rs. 4278700/- 2. Rs. 1125800/-
Completion Period	S.No. 1. 12 Months S.No. 2. 09 Months
Date and time of submission of tender and opening of tender	Upto 15:00 hrs on 11.09.2026, Opening of e-tender after 15:00 hrs on 11.09.2026.
Website particulars, published-tender, notice location etc. complete details of tender can be seen and website where the tender form can be downloaded	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in
Similar nature of work	S.No 1. Construction of bridge/Limited high subway with box/pushing/pipe pushing method. S.No 2. Any civil work other than track work.
No:-128-W/280/TenderNotice/26-27/M4 (NIT-40 & 41) Dated: 18.08.2026	2862/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

INVITING REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (R.F.P.) WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT GOVERNMENT OF JHARKHAND
NIT NO. : WRD/JH/CE/DMPH/RFP/24/2026
National Competitive Bidding

	Request for Proposal for Conducting Studies and Preparation of Detailed Investigation Reports on Comprehensive Dam Safety Evaluation/ Structural Health Assessment for Dam Rehabilitation/ Preparation of Emergency Action Plan, Operation and Maintenance Manual etc. of Samula Dam under Chief Engineer, Subernaekha Multipurpose project, Chandil complex, Jamshedpur, Water Resources Department, Govt. of Jharkhand
1. Name of the Work	
2. Mode of Submission of Bids	Online through www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in
3. Tender fee (In INR)	Rs.10,00,000/- (Ten thousand only) - ----(Non-refundable)
4. Bid Security (In INR)	Rs.1,00,000/- (One Lakh only)
5. Time of completion	150 days from the date of agreement
6. Date of availability of Bidding Document on Website	20/08/2026;16:00 HRS
7. Last Date and time of submission of pre-bid queries	31/08/2026;11:00 HRS
8. Date of Pre Bid Meeting	01/09/2026; 11:30HRS Chief Engineer, Design Master Planning And Hydrology, Room No. 203, Second Floor, Jal Bhawan, Doranda, Ranchi, Jharkhand-834002
9. Last Date of Submission of online Bids	10/09/2026;15:30HRS 11/09/2026;16:30HRS
10. Date & time of opening of Technical Bid	Chief Engineer, Design Master Planning And Hydrology, Room No. 203, Second Floor, Jal Bhawan, Doranda, Ranchi, Jharkhand-834002
11. Name of address of E - procurement officer	Chief Engineer, Design Master Planning And Hydrology, Room No. 203, Second Floor, Jal Bhawan, Doranda, Ranchi, Jharkhand-834002 <i>Email: ce-design-wrd.jhrcan.in</i>
12. Helpline no.	9162471847, 09787107524, 09599321224, 09304037930, 09110975717

Note:- Please see details on www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in
Chief Engineer
Design, Master Planning & Hydrology, Water Resources Department, Government of Jharkhand

PR.NO.387809 Water Resource(26-27):D

Chief Medical and Health Officer, Bhilwara
No.:Tender /2026-27/6335 Date:- 6/8/26
E-Procurement No. - 03/2026-27

Bids for Procurement of Arrangements for tea, breakfast, meals, and accommodation, Supply of gauze thans, bandages, and absorbent cotton rolls and Medicines and Consumables item are invited from interested bidders upto 04.00 PM 31-08-2026 Other Particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (<https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>, <https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in>) of the State. The approximate Consolidated Value of the procurement is Rs. 420.00 Lakhs.

UBN:- MHS2627GLOE03267, MHS2627SLRE03272, MHS2627GLRE03213

Sd/-
Chief Medical and Health Officer Bhilwara

DIPRC/14675/2026



UJVN LIMITED
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

Letter No: 702 Date: 16/08/2026

e-Tender Notice

Office of the Executive Engineer (HQ), UJJWAL, Maharani Bagh, Dehradun, invites online bids from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below :
Tender No. 06/EE(HQ)/2026-27
Name of work/supply/services etc.: Providing Manpower services for a period of one year on out source basis for UJVNLtd. Head Office at Dehradun
Estimated cost : Rs. 17.77, 104.00(Excluding GST)
Date of availability of bid document on website: 18.08.2026 (16.00 hrs)
Last date for submission of bids on website: 08.09.2026 (16.00 hrs.)
For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal <http://uktenders.gov.in> **Executive Engineer (HQ)**

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग, वृत्त, अजमेर
क्रमांक:- अज / अज./ तक./एफ-3/ निविदा/डी-1264 दिनांक: 11.08.2026

निविदा सूचना संख्या 01 वर्ष 2026-2027
राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से बाजट घोषणा के अन्तर्गत सड़क निर्माण कार्य हेतु उपयुक्त श्रेणी में सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग राजस्थान में पंजीकृत संवेदकों एवं केन्द्रीय / राज्य सरकार व उनके अधिकृत संगठनों / केन्द्रीय लोक निर्माण विभाग / डाक एवम दूर संचार विभाग / रेलवे इत्यादि में पंजीकृत संवेदकों, जो कि राजस्थान सरकार के विभिन्न श्रेणी के संवेदकों के समकक्ष हों, से निविदा प्रपत्र में कुल 07 पैकेज / कार्यों, निम्नकी कृता लातन राशि रु. 2587.00 लाख लाख के लिए ई-टेंडरिंग प्रक्रिया से ऑन लाईन निविदायें आमंत्रित की जाती हैं।
निविदा फार्म डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड करने 13 अगस्त, 2026 प्रातः 9.30 बजे से 03 सितम्बर, 2026 सायं 6.00 बजे तक।
तकनीकी निविदा खोलने की तारीख 07 सितम्बर, 2026 को प्रातः 11.00 बजे से वृत्त कार्यालय अजमेर में Online खोली जावेगी।

निविदा से संबंधित समस्त विवरण वेबसाईट www.dipronline.org पर एवं निविदा दरतावेज का विवरण वेबसाईट <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> एवं <http://sppp.raj.nic.in> पर देखा जा सकता है। सम्पूर्ण निविदा प्रक्रिया <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> पर ऑनलाईन सम्पादित की जावेगी।
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PWD2627WLOB09843	

अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, सा.नि.वि., वृत्त, अजमेर।
piu_ajmer@rediffmail.com
फोन नं.-0145-2947838

DIPRC/c/14857/2026

epaper.indianexpress.com New Delhi

Gujarat Police seizes phones, laptops from journalist Ravi Nair’s Delhi home

Alok Singh & Aditi Raja
New Delhi, Vadodara, August 18

A TEAM of the Gujarat Police on Monday searched the Delhi home of independent journalist Ravi Nair and seized three laptops, two phones and an iPad. The seized devices allegedly included those belonging to Nair’s son and a colleague of the journalist’s.

Nair is facing charges of defamation and forgery in Ahmedabad following a complaint over a news report and posts on X about the Adani Group.

On August 11, Gujarat High Court had refused to quash an FIR registered by the Ahmedabad Detection of Crime Branch (DCB) against Nair on May 29 this year over an article published in *The Washington Post*, which had alleged that Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) had been directed to make large investments in Adani Group companies.

The complainant in the case is Dushyant Vijaybhai Joshi, representing Adani Ports and Special Economic Zones Ltd (APSEZ). The HC held that the allegations in the FIR were materially different from an earlier private defamation complaint, and prima facie indicated cognizable offences that required investigation. The Gujarat Police team was accompanied by personnel from the Delhi Police during the search. Nair was not at home at the time.

A senior official of the Gujarat Police said that a unit of the force had seized the electronic devices from Nair’s Delhi residence as part of their investigation into the FIR following the HC’s order last week, based on a warrant issued by a Magistrate Court in Ahmedabad.

Nair’s colleague told *The Indian Express* that she was at Nair’s residence with his son when the police team arrived at 2.40 pm on Monday. “The officials showed us a search warrant and collected some gadgets. There were three laptops, two old phones that were

kept in a cupboard, and one iPad. The laptops belonged to me and Ravi’s son, who works at a software company,” she said.

She said the search was recorded by a member of the police team. The officials also asked them to sign some documents before leaving around 6.40 pm. She said Nair had been cooperating with investigators. “However, neither his son nor I are accused in any case. I don’t know why they took away our devices”.

On August 11, Justice M R Mendgy of the HC rejected the journalist’s contention that the FIR amounted to an abuse of the legal process.

The FIR, lodged under Sections 318(4), 336(2), 336(4) and 340(2) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita 2023 (BNS), relates to an article published in *The Washington Post* on October 24, 2025. These sections deal with cheating; altering or destroying a valuable security; forgery, which is intended, or known likely, to harm the reputation of a party; and fraudulently or dishonestly using a forged document or electronic record as genuine. The FIR said the article had alleged that the government and LIC had directed investments of large funds into Adani Group companies. Nair was also alleged to have claimed on X that Indian officials had decided to invest \$3.9 billion in the Group.

The allegations in the report were based on documents purportedly issued by LIC or the Department of Financial Services under the Union Ministry of Finance. However, the assistant public prosecutor submitted that LIC denied issuing any such documents or receiving any government instructions to invest in any Adani entity.

In its eight-page oral order, the HC observed that the existence of the documents was “under the clouds”, and prima facie appeared to be forged. The court said it would be for the “investigating agency to find out the truth as regards those documents”.

PM CARES Fund sees drop in donations, spending

Total balance at an all-time high

Harikishan Sharma
New Delhi, August 18

TOTAL CONTRIBUTIONS to the Prime Minister’s Citizen Assistance and Relief in Emergency Situations Fund (PM CARES Fund) fell to Rs 479.96 crore in financial year 2024-25. Its closing balance, however, touched an all-time high of Rs 8,452.06 crore as the spending, too, fell to a five-year low of Rs 87.85 lakh.

According to the latest Receipt and Payment Accounts (Audited) statement available on the PM CARES Fund portal, domestic donations accounted for Rs 479.04 crore of the total contributions while foreign donations added up to about Rs 92 lakh. The Fund also received Rs 475.14 crore as interest income (Rs 469.37 crore from fixed de-

• Contributions received in the PM CARES Fund and closing balance (amount in Rs Crore)

	Receipts		Opening Balance	Total Receipts	Total Payments	Closing Balance
	Domestic	Foreign				
2019-20	3076.85	0.39	0	3076.62	0.0002	3076.62
2020-21	7183.77	494.93	3076.62	10990	3976.17	7013.99
2021-22	1896.76	40.12	7013.99	9131.94	3716.29	5415.65
2022-23	909.64	2.57	5415.65	6721	437.87	6283.68
2023-24	681.81	1.13	6283.68	7188.63	15.59	7173.03
2024-25	479.04	0.92	7173.03	8452.94	0.87	8452.06

posits, Rs 5.76 crore from regular accounts), about Rs 13.49 lakh as refund of tax deducted at source (TDS) on interest on fixed deposits from banks, and Rs 324.65 crore as “refund from implementing agencies”.

Meanwhile, the total spending fell to Rs 87.85 lakh, including Rs 87.84 lakh on the PM CARES for Children Scheme and Rs 451 as bank charges and SMS charges. The total spending was Rs 15.59 crore in 2023-24; Rs 437.87 crore in 2022-23;

Rs 3,716.29 crore in 2021-22; and Rs 3,976.17 crore in 2020-21.

The closing balance touched an all-time high of Rs 8,452.06 crore at the end of 2024-25, marking an increase of 17.83 per cent as compared to the closing balance of Rs 7,173.03 crore at the end of 2023-24.

The contributions to the Fund peaked in 2020-21, the year saw the outbreak of the second Covid wave, when it received Rs 7,183.77 crore as domestic donations and Rs 494.93 crore as for-

foreign donations. In 2021-22, it got Rs 1,896.76 crore as domestic donations and Rs 40.12 crore as foreign donations; in 2022-23, it got Rs 909.64 crore as domestic donations and Rs 2.57 crore as foreign donations; and in 2023-24, it got Rs 681.81 crore as domestic donations and Rs 1.13 crore as foreign donations.

At the end of 2019-20, the closing balance was Rs 3,076.62 crore. This increased to Rs 7,014 crore at the end of 2020-21, fell to Rs 5,415.65 crore in 2021-22, and then climbed to Rs 6,283.68 in 2022-23, Rs 7,173.03 crore in 2023-24, and Rs 8,452.06 crore in 2024-25.

The PM CARES Fund was registered as a public charitable trust under the Registration Act, 1908, on March 27, 2020 – days after the country went into a lockdown in the wake of Covid-19. The Prime Minister is the ex-officio chairman of the Fund, while the Defence Minister, Home Minister and Finance Minister are ex-officio trustees.

Naidu: 34% quota for Backward Classes in local body polls

Hyderabad: The Andhra Pradesh government has announced 34% reservation for Backward Classes (BC) communities in the local body polls, which are likely to be held later this year. Apprising the Legislative Assembly in Amaravati of the Cabinet’s decisions on Tuesday, Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu said while 34% reservation will be given to BCs in rural local bodies, they will have 33.33% quota in urban local bodies. Besides, election of Mayors and Municipal Chairpersons in urban local bodies will be conducted through direct polls.

Naidu said that the TDP-led NDA government is fulfilling its 2024 election promise of increasing the BC reservation in local bodies from 20% to 34%. He said the issue about correcting the injustice done to BCs under the previous government. ENS

GANDHI DARSHAN

(Near Rajghat)

“Elocution Competition for Students”

(Class 9th-12th)

“लाल किले से प्रधानमंत्री का संदेश: विकसित भारत की ओर”

विषय पर
भाषण प्रतियोगिता

2nd (Wed.) & 3rd (Thu.) September, 2026

Venue: Gandhi Darshan, Rajghat

VIJAY GOEL
Vice Chairman
Former Union Minister

Scan QR code for registration

- * Maximum two students per school can participate.
- * The competition is open for students of class 9th to 12th.
- * Last date of registration **01.09.2026**
- * For any query contact: Rajdeep **9821016404**, Vivek **8810215557**

(Director, Gandhi Darshan)

TN to revise maternity leave for third child from 12 weeks to one year

Chennai: Maternity leave for Tamil Nadu state government employees will be increased from the current 12 weeks to 365 days in the case of a third child, Minister for Human Resource Management D Sarathkumar told Assembly on Tuesday. Currently, married women government employees with fewer than two children are granted 365 days of maternity leave, while those with two or more surviving children get up to 12 weeks of maternity leave. Previous governments had raised maternity leave from the original 90 days to six months in 2011, nine months in 2016, and 365 days in 2021. PTI

Chouhan administers ‘Sapt Dhara’ pledge to his ministry

New Delhi: Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan on Tuesday administered a pledge to officials of the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers’ Welfare and the Ministry of Rural Development, urging them to realise the vision of seven streams of strength or “Sapt Dhara” as outlined by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in his Independence Day speech.

On Tuesday, Chouhan’s deputies — Chandra Sekhar Pemmasani, Minister of State for Rural Development and Bhagirath Choudhary, Minister of State of Agriculture and Farmers’ Welfare — along with Agriculture Secretary Atish Chandra, Rural Development Secretary Rohit Kansal, ICAR DG and DARE Secretary DR Mangi Lal Jaat, Land Resources Secretary Narendra Bhooshan and other officials of the both ministries took pledge.

“...participants resolved to make agriculture more prosperous, strengthen food production, expand food processing, take Indian agricultural products to global markets, increase incomes of farmers and ensure due respect for their hard work... towards the goal of creating six crore Lakhpati Didis, following the achievement of the target of three crore Lakhpati Didis...” the Ministry of Rural Development said in a statement. ENS

UTTARAKHAND ELECTRICITY REGULATORY COMMISSION

‘Vidyut Niyamak Bhawan’ Near ISBT, PO- Majra, Dehradun- 248171
PH. 0135-2641115 Website www.uerc.gov.in E-mail- secy.uerc@gov.in

PUBLIC NOTICE

Inviting comments on the Draft UERC (Deviation Settlement Mechanism and Related Matters) Regulations, 2026

In exercise of the powers conferred under Section 181 of the Electricity Act, 2003 (36 of 2003), and all other powers enabling it in this behalf, the Commission has issued draft UERC (Deviation Settlement Mechanism and Related Matters) Regulations, 2026. The draft Regulation has been posted at the Commission’s website www.uerc.uk.gov.in.

2. Notice is hereby given inviting comments/suggestions/objections on the draft Regulation from all the stakeholders. These could be sent to the undersigned latest by **17.09.2026** by post or e-mail or in person at the above-mentioned address for Commission’s consideration.

3. The comments/suggestions/objections received after the stipulated date in the Commission’s office may not be considered while finalizing these Regulations.

Advt. No. 13/2026-27 **Secretary**

Guru Ghasidas Vishwavidyalaya, (A Central University) Bilaspur

(C.G.) School of Studies of Engineering & Technology

Admission in B.Tech. Program against vacant / drop-out seats for Academic Session 2026-27

Advt. Ref. No.689/Academic/2026 **Date: 14.08.2026**

The School of Studies of Engineering & Technology, Guru Ghasidas Vishwavidyalaya, Bilaspur (C.G.) is going to conduct Spot / Local Counseling for Admission in B.Tech. Program on 03rd September 2026 for few vacant seats in the different branches of Engineering i.e. Chemical Engineering, Civil Engineering, Computer Science & Engineering, Electrical Engineering, Electronics & Communication Engineering, Information Technology, Industrial & Production Engineering, Mechanical Engineering, Artificial Intelligence & Data Science and VFX & Animation Engineering. Interested candidates shall apply online during 17.08.2026 to 25.08.2026. The detailed information about seats availability and procedure of admission is available on the website <https://ggu.ac.in/>.

Registrar

GOVT. OF BIHAR

BIHAR COMBINED ENTRANCE COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION BOARD

L.A.S. Association Building, Near Patna Airport, Patna-14.

Website : bceceboard.bihar.gov.in / Helpdesk : helpdesk.bceceboard@bihar.gov.in

POST GRADUATE DENTAL ADMISSION COUNSELLING (PGDAC)-2026

for MDS in Govt./ Private Dental colleges of Bihar

Advt. No.- BCECEB(PGDAC)-2026/02 Dated : 18.08.2026

Notice for Online Application & Choice Filling (Round-1 & 2)

Online application in prescribed form from the qualified, eligible & interested NEET (MDS)-2026 candidates are invited on the basis of the Merit List of NEET (MDS)-2026 for appearing in the Post Graduate Dental Admission Counselling (PGDAC)-2026 in order to select candidates for admission to the FIRST YEAR of the following Post Graduate Dental Courses in Government and Private Dental Colleges of Bihar State for the academic session 2026;

(i) MDS Course in Govt. Dental College i.e. Patna Dental College, Patna.

(ii) MDS Course in Private Dental Colleges viz. Mithila Minority Dental College & Hospital, Darbhanga and Buddha Institute of Dental Science & Hospital, Kankarbagh, Patna.

2. The online Registration and submission of Application Form will start from **20.08.2026 and close on 24.08.2026**.

3. Eligibility criteria for Online Counselling, Fee payment procedure, Choice filling, instructions, Seat Matrix and other details are available in the prospectus of PGDAC-2026 and the related detailed Advertisement No. BCECEB(PGDAC)-2026/01 Dated 18.08.2026 which can be downloaded from the Board’s website: bceceboard.bihar.gov.in.

Controller of Examination

NATIONAL DEWORMING CAMPAIGN

18 - 22 August 2026

ONE SAFE TABLET - TWICE A YEAR - A HEALTHIER FUTURE

Soil Transmitted worms can live inside your child's body silently draining their health.

leads in: Iron Deficiency, Weakness, Fatigue, Poor Academic Performance

During National Deworming Campaign, all children in the age group of 1 to 19 years will be administered chewable Albendazole tablet at all schools (Govt./ Govt. aided/ Private) and Anganwadi centers.

A single dose of **Albendazole** can prevent anemia, improve nutrition & academic performance. This dose should be given under supervision & it is **completely safe** for every child.

Request to Parents

- Make sure to send your children to schools/Anganwadi Center for upcoming NDD Campaign.
- Do not give empty stomach - medicine has to be given only after food.
- Join this campaign to make children Worm free.

Directorate of Family Welfare and Delhi State Health Mission, GNCT of Delhi

DIP/Shabdarth/Display/073/26-27

SC collegium approves six HC judges

New Delhi: The Supreme Court collegium on Tuesday approved the appointment of four advocates as judges of the Orissa High Court and of an advocate and a judicial officer as judges of the Gauhati HC. “The SC collegium...has approved the proposal for appointment of the following advocates as judges of the HC of Orissa: Sasmita Tripathy, Aditya Narayan Das, Rajjeet Roy and Gautam Misra,” said a statement. It also approved appointment of advocate Nchumbemo Mozhui and judicial officer Helen Dawngliani as judges of the Gauhati HC. PTI

NATIONAL FERTILIZERS LIMITED

(A Government of India Undertaking)
CIN: L74899DL1974GOI007417
Registered Office: Scope Complex, Core -III, 7, Institutional Area, Lodhi Road, New Delhi 110003.
Website: www.nationalfertilizers.com, Email ID: investor@nfl.co.in
Telephone: 011 - 24360066, 24361252

CORRIGENDUM

With reference to the advertisement published on 14.08.2026 in this newspaper regarding “NOTICE FOR ATTENTION OF THE SHAREHOLDERS OF THE COMPANY”. Para ‘Cut-off Date for Voting at the AGM’ in the aforesaid advertisement will be read as under:

Cut-off Date for Voting at the AGM: The Company has fixed Tuesday, 15.09.2026 as the cut-off date for voting at the AGM. The voting rights of members shall be in proportion to their shares of the paid up equity share capital of the Company as on the cut-off date.

For National Fertilizers Limited, Sd/- (Ashok Jha) Company Secretary

Place: New Delhi Date: 19.08.2026

BEFORE THE NATIONAL COMPANY LAW TRIBUNAL
NEW DELHI BENCH-VI, NEW DELHI
(ORIGINAL JURISDICTION)
COMPANY PETITION NO. (CAA) 37 (ND) OF 2026
CONNECTED WITH
COMPANY APPLICATION NO. (CAA) 25 (ND) OF 2026
IN THE MATTER OF THE COMPANIES ACT, 2013 (18 OF 2013)
SECTIONS 230 & 232
AND
IN THE MATTER OF SCHEME OF AMALGAMATION
AND
IN THE MATTER OF
TIRUPATI PLYWOOD PRIVATE LIMITED
PETITIONER NO. 1/TRANSFEROR COMPANY NO. 1
(A company incorporated under the provisions of the Companies Act, 1956 and having its registered office at 321, RG Complex-2, Plot No. 5, DDA Community Center, Sector-14, Prashant Vihar, Rohini, New Delhi-110 085)
SUPER TRADEX PRIVATE LIMITED
PETITIONER NO. 2/TRANSFEROR COMPANY NO. 2
(A company incorporated under the provisions of the Companies Act, 1956 and having its registered office at 321, RG Complex-2, Plot No. 5, DDA Community Center, Sector-14, Prashant Vihar, Rohini, New Delhi-110 085)
AND
SIDHESHWARI COMMOTRADE PRIVATE LIMITED
PETITIONER NO. 3/TRANFEREE COMPANY
(A company incorporated under the provisions of the Companies Act, 1956 and having its registered office at 321, Third Floor, RG Complex-2, Sector-14, Prashant Vihar, Rohini, New Delhi-110 085)
Notice of Hearing of Petition
Notice is hereby given that a joint Petition under Sections 230 & 232 of the Companies Act, 2013, the Companies (Compromises, Arrangements and Amalgamations) Rules, 2016, and other applicable provisions, if any, for obtaining sanction to the Scheme of Amalgamation of Tirupati Plywood Private Limited and Super Tradex Private Limited with Sidheshwari Commotrade Private Limited was presented by the Petitioners above named on 2nd June, 2026 and the said Petition is fixed for hearing on 3rd September, 2026 at 10:30 A.M. before the Hon’ble National Company Law Tribunal, New Delhi Bench-VI, New Delhi.
Any person desirous of supporting or opposing the said Petition should send his intention, signed by him or his advocate, with his name and address to the Hon’ble National Company Law Tribunal, New Delhi Bench-VI, Block No. 12, C.G.O. Complex, Lodhi Road, New Delhi-110 003 and to the Petitioners’ Advocate, so as to reach the Bench and the Petitioners’ Advocate not later than 2 days before the date fixed for hearing of the Petition. Where he seeks to oppose the Petition, the grounds of opposition or a copy of his affidavit shall be furnished with such notice. A copy of the Petition will be furnished by the undersigned to any person requiring the same on payment of the prescribed charges for the same.

Sd/-
Kartikeya Goel, Advocate
For Rajeev Goel & Associates
Counsel for the Petitioners
785, Pocket-E, Mayur Vihar-II,
Delhi Meerut Expressway/NH-9, Delhi 110 091
e-mail: info@rgalegal.in, Website: www.rgalegal.in

Date: 18.08.2026
Place: New Delhi



Back In The Bar

TUESDAY'S ELECTION to the Supreme Court Bar Association (SCBA) saw former Vice President Jagdeep Dhankhar turning up to cast his vote. Dhankhar, a designated senior advocate, has been practising in the SC since the 1990s. Sources said that after a break, during which he was Governor of West Bengal and later Vice President, Dhankhar resumed his membership of the bar body earlier this year. Senior Advocate Pradeep Rai was elected SCBA president in the election which saw an estimated 82 per cent turnout.

B'day Message

INDIA'S ECONOMIC development under Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman's stewardship got a thumbs up from Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Tuesday. While wishing Sitharaman on her birthday, the PM posted on X that she was "adding momentum to our endeavour of being a strong and self-reliant India. May she be blessed with a long and healthy life". Thanking him for the wishes, Sitharaman said the PM's guidance served as motivation.

In The Wings

THE MUCH-AWAITED Delhi Master Plan 2047 may soon be revealed. It is learnt that Union Minister of Housing and Urban Affairs Manohar Lal, Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu and Chief Minister Rekha Gupta could address a press conference later this week to announce the notification of the plan, which was approved by the Delhi Development Authority last week.

18 IPS officers, including two SPs, transferred in Bihar

Himanshu Harsh
Patna, August 18

THE BIHAR government on Tuesday transferred the Superintendents of Police (SPs) of Siwan and Bhojpur as part of a reshuffle of 18 IPS officers, days after the two districts came under scrutiny over separate police actions.

As per a notification by the state Home Department, Siwan SP Puran Kumar Jha was transferred and placed on the waiting list for a new posting. Bharat Soni, serving as SP of Nalanda, was appointed the new Siwan SP.

The change comes less than a month after a policeman was seen firing an AK-47 in the air during student protests in Siwan. The July 25 protests, held amid an agitation over the alleged NEET paper leaks and earlier police action against students, turned violent, with clashes between protesters and law enforcement personnel. Three persons had sustained bullet injuries and several police personnel, including Jha, were injured. Police had registered three FIRs based on the injured civilians' statements, while a constable seen using the AK-47 was suspended. However, police had made it clear that no one was injured in the incident.

Meanwhile, Bhojpur SP Raj was transferred to Rohtas. Awadesh Dikshit, serving as SP (Personnel-1) at Bihar Police HQ, was appointed the new Bhojpur SP. Hriday Kant, serving with the ATS, was appointed SP of Nalanda. Roshan Kumar was transferred from Rohtas and posted as Senior SP, Saran. The government also carried out a major IAS reshuffle hours earlier, transferring 17 officers, including the DMs of Siwan and Bhojpur.

STUDENT UNREST, JOBS, AYODHYA THEFT ALLEGATIONS ON PARTY AGENDA

As Vande Mataram row simmers, CWC to chart Cong's next offensive

Manoj CG
New Delhi, August 18

AMID THE perception in the Opposition that the BJP-led NDA government is on the backfoot on several issues, the Congress Working Committee (CWC) is set to meet on Wednesday. This comes at a time when the party is embroiled in a controversy over the rendition of Vande Mataram.

With the BJP escalating its attack on the Congress over the rendition of Vande Mataram during an Independence Day event at the AICC headquarters and later at an event in Goa attended by party president Mallikarjun Kharge, the Congress has made it clear that its programmes will feature only the first two stanzas of the national song. However, a section of the Congress believes the party should tread carefully on an issue with nationalistic overtones. The issue is likely to come up for discussion at the CWC meeting, though sources said it was not on the agenda as of now.

The Congress, citing a 1937



Lok Sabha LoP Rahul Gandhi at the meet of district presidents of AICC OBC Department at the Congress HQ in Delhi on Tuesday, ANI

CWC resolution, has argued that leading lights of the freedom movement, including Mahatma Gandhi and Rabindranath Tagore, had backed limiting public rendition to the first two stanzas to avoid verses containing specific religious imagery.

On Tuesday, Kharge said he sang the exact same version of the national song that leaders such as Mahatma Gandhi, Ja-

waharlal Nehru, and Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel sang and argued that if singing that version constitutes a crime, the government should register an FIR against the late national leaders.

"I sang the same Vande Mataram that Mahatma Gandhi and Jawaharlal Nehru sang. I sang the same Vande Mataram that they have been singing for 18 years... their Central govern-

ment... I sang what Vajpayee sang... If singing it is a crime, then they have been committing that crime for the past 18 years. If this is a crime, then file a case against Gandhiji, Nehruji and Vallabhbhai Patel," said the Congress president.

"They are unaware of the fact that, even before they were born, the Congress had passed a resolution determining which national songs to adopt for the country. It is not the case that whatever you say becomes the national standard. Tomorrow, another government might come to power; if they say something, that becomes the rule. We have simply continued the practice that has been in place for 90 years."

Karnataka Congress chief B K Hariprasad also told *The Indian Express* that the state unit would sing only the first two stanzas of Vande Mataram at its programmes, in keeping with the existing practice.

The controversy over the national song began after Parliament, in the recently concluded Monsoon Session, passed the Prevention of In-

sults to National Honour (Amendment) Act, 2026, which makes attempts to stop or prevent the singing or playing of Vande Mataram an offence.

The Congress, meanwhile, is also keen to project that the government has been buffeted by student unrest, alleged theft of Ram temple donations, ethanol blending and fresh reports of tension along the China border in Arunachal Pradesh.

The party is now looking to work out a strategy to keep the issues alive and sharpen its political attack.

The CWC meeting will be the first since the recent Jantar Mantar protests, which ended with the resignation of Dharmendra Pradhan as Union Education Minister. While the party has decided to keep its distance from the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), the leadership is keen to link the student unrest to the larger issue of jobs.

Leader of the Opposition Rahul Gandhi, meanwhile, is stepping up his interactions with students, with his next programme scheduled in Pune on August 22.

EXPRESS special

Why new rules in Maharashtra give CM veto power over any minister

Vallabh Ozarkar
Mumbai, August 18

THE MAHAYUTI-LED Maharashtra government has framed new rules empowering the Chief Minister, Devendra Fadnavis, to override a decision taken by any minister, provided that the CM's action is in public interest and the reasons for doing so are recorded in writing. This provision is part of the Maharashtra Government Rules of Business, 2026, notified by the General Administration Department on August 14, which has replaced the 1975 regulation of government business. The Fadnavis government's move has come three years after the Bombay High Court held that the CM had no powers under the government's then existing rules of business to review or modify a decision taken by the minister in charge of a department.

In its March 3, 2023 judgment, the Nagpur Bench of the Bombay High Court, while quashing then CM Eknath Shinde's decision to stay an order of the BJP's cooperation minister — which had permitted recruitment in the Chandrapur District Central Cooperative Bank — ruled that the CM had no supervisory power over the decision of the minister concerned as he had no power under the 1975 rules of government business to review or modify a minister's decision.

The amended business rules now specifically provide for such an intervention by the CM in any minister's decision. Under its rule 13(5), the CM can, except in judicial matters, override a decision taken by any minister in public interest and by recording the reasons in writing.

In the Chandrapur cooperative bank case, the bank had vacancies and had received permission from the Cooperation Department to start recruitment. Then cooperation minister Atul Save subsequently lifted a stay on the recruitment on November 23, 2022. However, then CM Shinde, the Shiv Sena chief and BJP's key ally, issued an order on November 29, 2022, to stay this recruitment. The bank challenged the CM's order before the HC, which set it aside. The new business rules retain the minister-in-charge as the primary authority for disposing of business assigned to the department concerned, while providing for the CM to override such a decision on the ground of public interest.

While the Fadnavis camp rules out any political motive

behind amending the 1975 rules, there is a buzz in state political circles linking it to "friction" between the Mahayuti allies, especially between CM Fadnavis and Shinde, who is now the Deputy CM.

The new rules equip the CM with several other mechanisms to intervene in the functioning of departments. The CM can seek documents relating to any matter from any department, and the minister in charge and the department secretary are required to comply with such a request. The Chief Secretary, too, can seek documents from any department. The rules provide that the CM can direct cases to be placed before the Cabinet. Matters in the Second Schedule must be brought before the Cabinet, while cases in the Third Schedule have to be submitted to the CM before orders are issued. The rules also allow the Cabinet to decide certain matters through circulation, by sending them to ministers for their views, rather than through discussion at a meeting. If the ministers are unanimous and the CM considers a meeting unnecessary, the matter can be decided without a Cabinet meeting.

The rules also strengthen the role of the Chief Secretary in the decision-making process. All cases that are to be placed before the Cabinet are also required to be routed through the Chief Secretary. Where a matter concerns over one department, the rules require the departments to be consulted before a decision is taken. No order can be issued until the departments agree or the matter is decided through the Cabinet mechanism.

Governor's role

The new rules specify 22 categories of matters that the CM has to submit to the Governor before orders are issued. These include matters affecting the peace and tranquillity of the state, Centre-state relations, ordinances, nominations to the Legislature, summoning or dissolution of the Assembly, appointments to the Maharashtra Public Service Commission, matters affecting Scheduled Areas and certain matters concerning the SCs, STs, OBCs and minorities. The rules have been framed under Articles 166(2) and 166(3) of the Constitution, which deal with the authentication of government orders and rules for the transaction of the state government's business.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM



Kathmandu talks

Chief of the Army Staff General Dhiraj Seth meets Nepal Prime Minister Balendra Shah at his office in Kathmandu on Tuesday. They discussed issues of mutual interest and ways to strengthen military ties. General Seth is on an official visit to Nepal from August 17-19 at the invitation of his Nepalese Army counterpart General Ashok Raj Sigdel. ANI

BRICS Environment Ministers oppose EU's Carbon Border Tax

Nikhil Ghanekar
New Delhi, August 18

BRICS ENVIRONMENT and climate ministers Tuesday opposed the European Union's (EU) Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM) or Carbon Border Tax, calling it a unilateral, punitive, discriminatory and protection measure that is not in line with international law.

They reiterated that developed nations must urgently scale up climate finance, especially for climate adaptation. CBAM is an import levy on carbon-intensive goods like steel, iron, fertilisers, aluminium and cement. The tax was aimed as a measure to reduce the carbon footprint of imported goods, but the step has been seen as a trade barrier by developing countries.

Rolled out on October 1, 2023, with a reporting-only phase, CBAM was entirely effected from January 1, 2026, when importers were asked to purchase and surrender CBAM certi-

Bloc of 9 developing economies has also pressed rich nations on climate finance

cates tied to carbon emissions embedded in their goods.

In the 'Adaptation and climate resilience' part of the joint statement, member nations "expressed concern" that measures like CBAM "undermine efforts by countries, specifically the developing countries", aimed at addressing the adverse impacts of climate change, increased adaptive capacity, and resilience. The meeting, chaired by India in New Delhi, brought together environment and climate ministers and senior officials from Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, United Arab Emirates, Indonesia, Iran, Saudi Arabia, Egypt and Ethiopia.

In a joint statement issued at the conclusion of the 12th

BRICS Environment Ministers' meeting, the bloc of nine developing economies has also urged wealthy nations to deliver on the New Collective Quantified Goal (NCQG) reached at the COP (Conference of Parties) 30 held in Belem, Brazil, to triple adaptation finance to developing countries by 2035.

The joint declaration document invoked the principle of "common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities" (CBDR-RC), underscoring that all cooperation commitments — from forest fire protocols to circular economy standards — remain voluntary and calibrated to each country's national circumstances. It marked the culmination of a year of technical work by the BRICS Environment Working Group and its Contact Group on Climate Change and Sustainable Development. India formally handed over hosting duties for the 13th edition to China, which will lead the meeting in 2027.

Prasad accuses Cong of 'same mentality' that decided its pact with Muslim League

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 18

ACCUSING IT of "suffering from the same mentality that brought it in alliance with the Muslim League", the BJP on Tuesday alleged that Congress was compromising on national interests for its vote-bank politics and providing ideological support to Naxalism.

Senior BJP leader Ravi Shankar Prasad said that following the "embarrassment" at the Congress headquarters on August 15, where Sonia Gandhi appeared to be opposing the recitation of Vande Mataram in its entirety, Congress chief Mallikarjun Kharge had, in Goa, said that only two stanzas were sung at the party event there as well.

"Today, we want to raise a question about the mindset of the entire Congress party. If it indulges in such acts... If it is behaving in this manner with the great national song, then it should please stop its arrogance of claiming to be the sole custodian of India's freedom movement," Prasad said.

Underlining that Vande Mataram was one of the major songs of India's freedom struggle and served as a source of inspiration, the senior BJP leaders said that the Congress had, in 1936-37, entered into a pact with the Muslim League, and perhaps for this reason, the Muslim League "exerted pressure that only two stanzas should be sung, as the remaining portions hurt their religious sentiments".



BJP leader Ravi Shankar Prasad

"The first President of India and great freedom fighter, Dr Rajendra Prasad, clearly declared in the Constituent Assembly meeting on January 24, 1950, that 'Jana Gana Mana' would be the National Anthem and 'Vande Mataram', the national song," the senior BJP leader highlighted.

"Dr Rajendra Prasad was himself a member of the Congress and was the president of the Constituent Assembly, and later, became the President of India," Prasad pointed out.

"Mallikarjun Kharge, was Dr Rajendra Prasad a leader of the freedom movement or not?... Did Dr Rajendra Prasad declare in the Constituent Assembly in 1950 that Vande Mataram was the National Song or not? Then who is Mallikarjun Kharge mocking, and why? The Congress party is still afflicted by the same mindset that characterised its relationship with the Muslim League during the Lucknow Pact of 1936-37," the BJP leader said, adding that instead of learning from its mistakes, Congress' leaders were themselves becoming "symbols of anarchy".

2 days on, Surat police detains 26 for 'inciting' textile workers' unrest

Kamal Saiyed
Surat, August 18

TWO DAYS after hundreds of workers from textile factories here clashed following a shutdown call, police on Tuesday detained 26 people for allegedly provoking the unrest. Most of the detainees ran WhatsApp groups that were allegedly used to incite people.

On Sunday afternoon, scores of workers stormed two embroidery units at Vedant Eco Park-2, an industrial estate in Surat's Amroli suburb. When the owner did not yield, they turned off the power, bringing the powerloom units to a halt. They demanded their weekly off on Sundays, a reduction in the working hours from 12 to 8 hours, and a wage hike.

Two FIRs were registered at the Amroli police station against the workers, charging them with rioting, unlawful assembly, trespass and other BNS sections. As the unrest spread to the southern suburbs of Sachin, Udhna and Pandesara by Monday, police's help was sought.

Surat's textile industry almost ground to a halt in March after workers, hit by the LPG crisis amid the US-Iran War, went back to their home states of Bihar, Uttar Pradesh and Odisha. It was by May that the factories returned to work with full force, even as the market demand rose with the wedding and festive seasons beginning in a month.

On Tuesday, the agitating workers raised their issues before labour department officials in a meeting convened by police in Amroli. The officials assured them that their demands



Many workers had stormed two embroidery units at Vedant Eco Park-2 in Surat's Amroli, demanding weekly off on Sundays, reduced working hours and a wage hike. EXPRESS

would be discussed with textile factory owners soon.

The Sunday incident at Amroli turned violent as police tried to stop the agitating workers, who allegedly resorted to stone-pelting. The owner of Vedanta Eco Park units, Vishal Goti has lodged a complaint against over 250 people who forcibly shut down his factory on Sunday and Monday. A police constable from the Surat Crime Branch, Atulkumar Dubey, who suffered a head injury, also lodged a complaint against 400-500 textile workers, officers said.

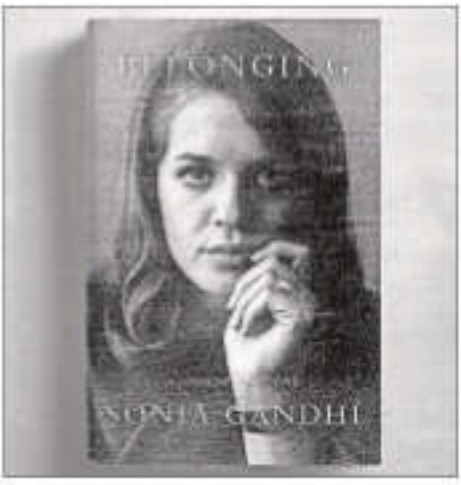
DCP (Zone 5) Lakhdirsinh Zala said, "The situation is now under control, and all the factories are operational in Amroli and other areas of the city... The workers didn't have a platform where they could put up their issues... In the stone-pelting incident on police and the injury to a police constable on Sunday, we detained 26 people."

ister Indira Gandhi was assassinated in 1984 and succeeded by Rajiv Gandhi, who seven years later was also murdered. She too would eventually enter politics and become the longest-serving president of the Congress party while also turning down her party's offer to become Prime Minister.

Her party lost power to the BJP in 2014. "It was heartbreak and loss that threw me into the public world of politics. Up till then I had guarded my privacy fiercely," she said in her statement. "Writing about my life

did not come easily to me. It meant opening myself up, sharing moments and experiences I had always held deep inside," she said.

"Yet as I gradually removed myself from the political sphere and looked back at all I had seen, the thread of love and loyalty that wove through my story began to define itself, from the simplicity of my childhood in small-town Italy, to the complexity of my years in India as the wife of Rajiv Gandhi and the daughter-in-law of Prime Minister Indira Gandhi." AP



The publisher of *Belonging: A Journey of Love*, Alfred A. Knopf, made the announcement on Tuesday. INSTAGRAM/ AAKNOPF

Trump cites CEC's remark, India's voter ID to push 'Save America Act'

Damini Nath & Divya A
New Delhi, August 18

UNITED STATES President Donald Trump on Tuesday said the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) of India, Gyanesh Kumar, had asked his administration how the US could hold elections without valid photo IDs for voters, citing India's voter IDs while renewing his push for the passage of the Save America Act that requires proof of citizenship for voter registration in the country.

In a social media post, Trump wrote: "Earlier this month, India's Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar asked our administration - How can you have Elections in the US without a valid Photo ID? India's last Election had 646,000,000 voters! Less than 1% voted by mail, and every single voter had to have a VALID Photo Identity Document. We need to pass THE

SAVE AMERICA Act, now!"

While the Election Commission (EC) did not comment on the matter, a source said that when US Ambassador to India Sergio Gor met the CEC at the Commission headquarters on August 12, Kumar had informed Gor about India's electoral processes, the last Lok Sabha elections and the Election's Photo Identity Card (EPIC) or Voter ID.

The CEC told the Ambassador that all voters have Photo IDs, the source said. The meeting is learnt to have lasted about 30 minutes.

When asked about the US President's remarks, Ministry of External Affairs spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said: "I have no specific comments to make on these remarks. I can say, however, that the credibility and robustness of India's election machinery is a well-established fact globally."

Kumar, who is chairing the

India's last Election had 646,000,000 voters! Less than 1% voted by mail, and every single voter had to have a VALID Photo Identity Document. We need to pass THE SAVE AMERICA Act, now!"

DONALD TRUMP,
US PRESIDENT

International Institute for Democracy and Electoral Assistance this year as part of India's chairship, has been holding meetings with ambassadors and high commissioners for the past few months.

Meanwhile, Gor, in a post on X, backed Trump's remarks on India's voter identification requirements and urged Con-

gress to pass the legislation. "President Trump is absolutely correct! 646 MILLION voters, every single one required an ID in India's last election. Congress should pass THE SAVE AMERICA ACT!" he wrote.

After the meeting of the CEC and Gor last week, the EC said on X: "Both sides reaffirmed their shared commitment to strengthening democratic cooperation... They also agreed to work closely together to deepen collaboration on election management and the training of election staff."

There is no information yet from the US Embassy in New Delhi on what was discussed during the meeting. An email has been sent to the Embassy in this regard.

The proposed 'SAVE America' legislation seeks to introduce documentary proof of US citizenship for registration to vote in federal elections and

photo identification requirements for voting.

It would also establish measures concerning voter registration and federal voter rolls, including provisions aimed at preventing non-citizens from registering to vote in federal elections.

The White House has described the measure as a way to ensure that only US citizens participate in federal elections. "American citizens — and only American citizens — should decide American elections," the White House said, describing the proposal as a "common sense, bipartisan bill".

However, the proposed legislation has drawn criticism from Democratic lawmakers, who have argued that documentary proof requirements could create additional barriers for eligible voters who do not have readily available citizenship documents.

SC rejects plea seeking abolition of execution by hanging

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 18

THE SUPREME Court on Tuesday dismissed a plea challenging the validity of the law prescribing hanging as the sole method of execution of a death sentence but left it open for future scrutiny if the need arises.

A bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta noted that a three-judge bench of the court had in the case Deena vs Union of India in 2023 upheld the constitutional validity of Section 354(5) of The Code of Criminal Procedure, which prescribes this, and "hence, the scope of interference by a Bench of two judges on the very same issue is extremely limited".

Justice Mehta said, "There is no dispute that in Deena... the entire scope and ambit of hanging as the mode of execution of a death sentence was exhaustively considered with reference to foreign precedents, expert opinions and other scientific materials then available before the Court."

The three-judge Bench, it pointed out, "specifically analysed and evaluated the comparative merits of different methods of execution of death sentence. After examining electrocution, lethal gas, shooting and lethal injection as modes of execution, the court concluded that none of these methods possessed any distinct or demonstrable advantage over hanging."

The PIL by Senior Advocate Rishi Malhotra said the present method of death by hanging is physically painful and physiological traumatic to the prisoner. The court, however, said that "such argument was not supported by any unimpeachable scientific or empirical evidence".

Study links shape of starling flight patterns to threats from predators

First of its kind in India, study carried out in Ahmedabad varsity campus

Parimal A Dabhi
Ahmedabad, August 18

THESE DAYS, driving across the Sabarmati to the walled city of Ahmedabad on the eastern bank of the river, you could be treated to a mesmerising spectacle.

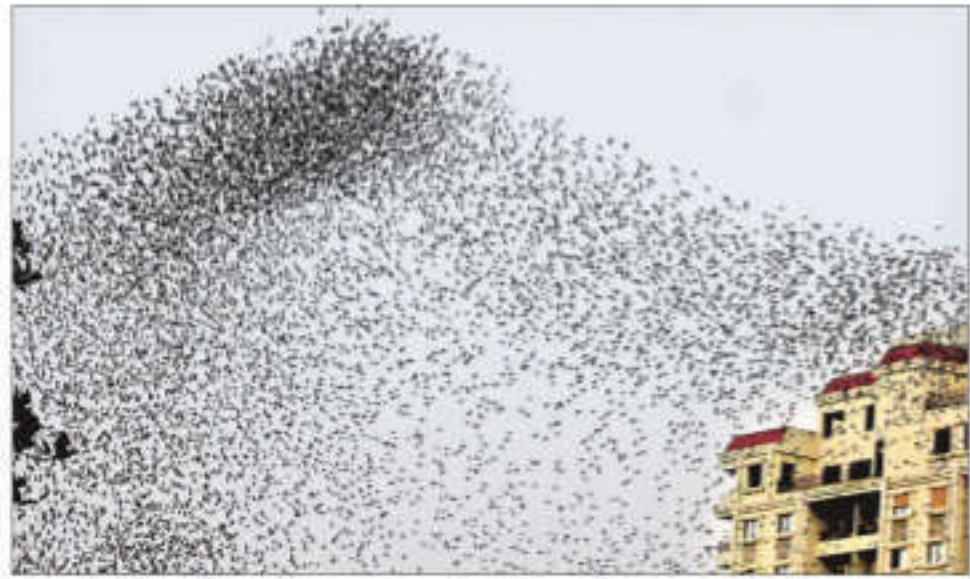
Dark grey, shape-shifting clouds of hundreds of birds flying in formation, swooping low and rising high, looping back and forth above the water, filling the air with their ceaseless chirping before settling on branches of one of the many ficus trees along the Sabarmati waterfront.

These are rosy starlings (Pastor roseus) — and as the monsoon enters its second half, enormous flocks have started to arrive in Gujarat to nest for the winter. Their 'murmurations' — the swirling, synchronised flights that make the birds look like a single, fluid organism rippling through the sky — are visible mostly at dusk, but often at dawn as well.

Researchers from Ahmedabad University have established a correlation between the size and shape of the murmurations and the threat and proximity of a predator in the sky.

The study, the first of its kind in India, has been published in the April issue of *Integrative and Comparative Biology* (ICB).

The paper, authored by Venu Divin and Jitesh Jawar of the School of Arts and Sciences at Ahmedabad University, has quantified the



Starling murmurations above Vadodra. Gujarat is the preeminent state to view rosy starling flocks in the sky at dusk. BHUPENDRA RANA

shape dynamics of rosy starling flocks in the presence and absence of predators — and concluded that a predator's presence has an influence on the geometry of murmurations.

"From the perspective of group living [of birds], this study has broad implications," Jawar told *The Indian Express*. "So far, group living studies have been done in labs; there are very few group living studies directly from the field. This study is one of its kind in that sense."

The study of shapes is also rare, Jawar said. "There are very few such studies, especially in the wild. If their (the birds') behaviour is to be predicted in future, these types of studies are needed. Until we understand these dynamics, we will not be able to predict their responses in their natural environment. The collective response is important because often species do not respond individually," he said.

Starling murmurations, which are typically seen at dusk for a few minutes to up to an hour, are common in the autumn and winter across Europe and North America. India sees

some spectacular murmurations as well, and Jamnagar's Lakhota Lake, Gujarat, is one of the best known hotspots.

The rosy starlings seen in India are different from the European variety of the species. The birds breed in Central and West Asia and Eastern Europe, and start migrating to the Indian subcontinent from around July-August to winter until March — making an unusual west-east journey rather than the north-south one that most migratory species make.

The birds forage only on trees and not on ground. Flocks have been seen in Gujarat from around the end of July this year. Besides Gujarat, starlings are also seen in Rajasthan, Karnataka, Chhattisgarh, Telangana, and Andhra Pradesh.

The study was carried out on campus at Ahmedabad University from January 2, 2025 to February 13, 2025.

Videos and photographs were taken from atop a building rising over canopy height, and the murmurations were classified in various shape categories. The data were collected over 28 days, from one hour before sunset until five minutes.

are generally less able to regulate body temperature: they sweat less, their blood vessels respond more slowly and their hearts work harder in the heat. As a result, earlier studies may have underestimated the number of people at risk from extreme heat by at least two-fold, she said.

Dr Mahaveer Golechha, prof at IIPH-Gandhinagar and a senior heat action plan expert, said, "Ageing diminishes the body's ability to control heat, and older people are likely to experience greater physiological strain at much lower temperature-humidity levels..." he said.

The study's finding that South Asia is among the most vulnerable regions should be treated as a grave public health warning, Dr Golechha said. Heat-health early warning systems should account for age-related vulnerability, temperature and humidity, duration of exposure, night temperatures and local demographics.

"We recorded details...including the shape of the flock, the approximate number of individuals in the flock, the time of observation, the direction of the flock, whether merging or splitting occurred, the shape shift, and the presence of any predator near the flock..." the authors have noted in the paper.

A total 3,023 flocks were recorded during the sampling period, and 12 distinct canonical shapes were identified, including "Small Road", "Small Oval", "Globular", "Wave Shape", "Ovoidal", "Snake" and "C-Shape". The most common avian predator at the study site was the black kite (Milvus migrans). The study recorded 181 instances in which a predator was present within 10 metres of a flock of rosy starlings.

In the absence of a predator, flock shape frequencies were dominated by "Small Oval" (279%) and "Mini Flock" (277%) formations. In the presence of a predator, the "Small Road" shape became overwhelmingly dominant, accounting for 71.3% of observed shapes.

"The Small Road formation has a relatively large surface area and pointed ends at the front and rear, features that may facilitate higher flight speed," the study noted.

"...such configurations may offer advantages that allow faster escape."

However, the change in murmuration displays was not consistent or predictable. "Although black kites were present in the study area on most days, predator presence alone did not consistently trigger murmuration displays. This observation contrasts with the common assumption that predator presence directly induces murmurations," the authors wrote.

Researchers drew on lab experiments measuring heat tolerance in three age groups: younger adults (15-39), middle-aged adults (40-59) and older adults (60 and above). They then mapped where heat would become dangerous for each group and how many people would be affected. Using a high-resolution heat-stress metric, they modelled scenarios ranging from 1°C-4°C of global warming above pre-industrial levels, in 0.5°C increments, alongside population projections.

Young adults would not face a similar level of risk until 4°C of warming, when 17% — about 490 million people — would be affected. The burden is also highly unequal. "India, Pakistan, Bangladesh, Myanmar and Niger stand out because they combine large population exposure and high poverty rates, which we use as an indicator of limited capacity to adapt," Prof Kong said.

EXPRESS special

Hasina daughter questions WHO action against her, calls for investigation

Sent on leave as S-E Asia regional director in 2025

Divya A
New Delhi, August 18

OUSTED BANGLADESH Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina's daughter Saima Wazed, who took charge as the World Health Organisation's Regional Director for the South-East Asia Region in February 2024 but was placed on indefinite leave in July last year, has sought an independent investigation into the action against her, The Indian Express has learnt.

Wazed is learnt to have raised the matter with WHO and its Director General, Tedros Ghebreyesus, repeatedly over the last eight months, seeking transparency over the decision. The latest communication was sent last month, through her legal representatives, warning of legal recourse.

WHO placed Wazed on indefinite leave on July 11, 2025, pending an inquiry, four months after Bangladesh's Anti Corruption Commission (ACC) filed two cases against her on charges of corruption, fraud and abuse of power. An acting regional director was named, whose term has since ended.

Wazed is learnt to have alleged that the action was taken at the behest of the then interim government in Bangladesh led by Mohammad Yunus, overlooking due process. Alleging that WHO failed to explain its action, she has asked if any formal inquiry is being conducted while she remains on leave for over a year now. Besides misconduct, she has also accused WHO of bias and harassment, The Indian Express has learnt.

According to sources, while WHO acknowledged some of her emails, it is yet to provide clarity on any ongoing review of the complaints against her.

Sources said the decision to place Wazed on leave was communicated to WHO staff in an



Saima Wazed has alleged the action was taken at behest of the then interim Bangladesh govt led by Mohammad Yunus

internal email from the Director General. According to sources, the email suggested that the Bangladesh government's objections, questions over the legitimacy of her election, and the ACC cases were all factors behind the decision.

When contacted by The Indian Express, Wazed refused to comment on the issue.

Responding to email queries from The Indian Express, WHO confirmed that Wazed "remains on leave". "There are established channels for staff members who wish to raise complaints of the nature of those referred to in the questions... However, we do not comment on specific cases, where we have a duty to maintain confidentiality," it said in an email.

Sources said Wazed has raised several "concerns", including WHO's alleged direct communication and dealings with Bangladesh's ACC and other officials of the then interim government, alleging a breach of due process and protocol for diplomatic communication.

She is also learnt to have alleged misrepresentation of facts to member states -- including India, who voted for her nomination to the post of Regional Director, SEARO, headquartered in New Delhi -- thereby causing damage to her reputation.

While India is learnt to have raised the matter with WHO through appropriate channels, it has not issued any official comment on the matter.

"WHO's decision to place

Wazed on leave immediately on receipt of a political request is significantly different to how the organisation responded when Tedros himself faced similar attacks from Ethiopia," said a source.

The source said this was particularly questionable given that Wazed was tried in absentia in Dhaka and declared a fugitive. "WHO has yet to provide a full public explanation of how information received from external political actors was assessed, verified, and weighed before action was taken against an elected regional director," said the source. Wazed has alleged that she continues to be targeted, at the behest of the Bangladesh government, for being Hasina's daughter, overlooking her own credentials and work in healthcare. According to sources, she was initially sent on leave with pay, but was placed "on administrative leave without pay" after some months, as she raised the matter.

Wazed assumed office on February 1, 2024, for a five-year term, becoming the first person from Bangladesh and the second woman to hold the position. She received eight of the total 10 votes cast, including India's.

"That mandate was altered by a hasty executive decision without the participation of the very member states that selected Wazed," said another source, adding that regional directors are accountable to the member states that elect them.

According to sources, Wazed may have been informed only a day or two before the announcement, raising further concerns about the process followed. Until WHO releases the relevant documentation and explains the authority under which the action was taken, key questions will remain unanswered, said a source close to Wazed who did not want to be identified.

Meanwhile, the position of regional director has not been declared vacant. While Wazed remains the elected regional director, sources alleged that she faces "sustained pressure" to step aside voluntarily.

Laxmanananda Saraswati case: Maoist leader 'Azad' acquitted due to lack of evidence

Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, August 18

A SPECIAL Court in Odisha on Tuesday acquitted Maoist leader D Kesaba Rao alias Azad, who was accused by the police of being a conspirator and the main accused in the killing of Vishwa Hindu Parishad (VHP) leader Laxmanananda Saraswati and four of his disciples in August 2008, due to lack of evidence. He was released from Bhubaneswar's Jharpada jail later in the evening.

Around 25 masked people had entered the Ashram at Jalespeta in Kandhamal district on August 23, 2008, and opened fire. Besides the VHP leader, others killed in the incident were Mata Bhaktimayee, Kishore Baba, Amrutananda and the brother of one of the inmates.

The killing of Saraswati had triggered communal violence in Kandhamal that claimed 38 lives and over 25,000 were rendered homeless. As per police investigation, after the crime, the accused left behind a letter, stating that the Maoists of Bansadhar Division had executed the killing. The letter was signed by the name "Azad". The police also claimed that Azad had called a meeting after the incident where he revealed that he, along with others, had killed Saraswati.

The court said that despite the fact that five persons were murdered, the crucial issue is whether the prosecution has proved that this accused caused, participated in, or shared the criminal liability for the murders. "Criminal jurisprudence does not permit con-

viction merely because an accused appears to be a possible participant in a grave occurrence. The prosecution must establish his identity and participation by reliable evidence," observed the court.

The court said no firearm was shown to have been recovered from Azad, no ballistic evidence connecting any weapon with him has been referred to, and no forensic evidence linking him to the scene has been proved in the material supplied. Though 22 witnesses were examined, there was only one eyewitness in the case. The court said no independent eyewitness identified Azad and no admissible confession or discovery connecting him with the murders has been established.

"The prosecution has consequently failed to establish beyond reasonable doubt that D Keshab Rao participated in the murder of any of the five deceased persons," read the court order. "Suspicion, however strong, cannot substitute proof," the court said.

It observed that there was no reliable evidence to establish Azad's participation in the alleged conspiracy. The special court also observed that there was no evidence to prove Azad's guilt on charges of unlawful assembly, house trespass, theft and Arms Act. The order reads that the circumstances create a reasonable doubt as to whether Rao was one of the persons who participated in the occurrence.

"...The Court cannot convert suspicion into proof because the offence is heinous," read the order.

Girl hired friends to kill grandfather for money to buy iPhone and bike, say Kerala Police

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, August 18

A MINOR girl allegedly hired three friends — all teenagers — to murder her grandfather for want of money, a probe into the man's death has revealed.

The incident happened in Alappuzha on August 15. The girl had chosen to stay with a friend that day. The man's wife and daughter were also away on a hospital visit, the police said.

"The man was smothered to death. A video call to the girl by one of the boys showed the man lying motionless. They then searched the house, stole the articles and returned to Kollam early Sunday morning," Alappuzha SP Vishnu Pradeep said. The gang allegedly stole six sovereigns of gold. On Monday, the girl returned to the house. She then alerted her neighbours about the house being locked from the inside and no one was answering the door. Subsequently, police was informed. Officers were initially clueless about the incident, although it was clear the murder was for robbery. They also noticed the girl's impassive demeanour following her grandfather's death.

Upon questioning the girl and examining her mobile phone, the conspiracy was unearthed. Police have apprehended the girl and her friends for the murder. "They wanted to buy an iPhone for the girl and a bike for others," SP Pradeep said.

The teens will be produced before the Juvenile Justice Board and are likely to be tried as adults, police said.

80% of India's elderly could face heat stress up to three months at 3°C global warming, says study

Anuradha Mascarenhas
Pune, August 18

OLDER ADULTS across India, China, Pakistan and Bangladesh — or 73% of the world's older population — could face dangerous heat waves day and night for up to 3 months once global warming reaches 3 degrees Celsius (°C) or more, a new study published in *The Lancet Planetary Health* estimates.

India stands out as one of the world's most vulnerable nations. At 3°C of warming, more than half of India's population and over 80% of its older adults could experience at least 180 hours of intolerable heat a year, on average. In Delhi and the greater Indo-Gangetic Plain, older adults are may experience close to or over 1,000 hours of intolerable heat a year at 1.5°C of global warming, expected around 2030. At 3°C, this rises to over 2,000 hours. "Importantly, these hours are not spread evenly



Older adults in New Delhi and the Indo-Gangetic plain could experience more than 2,000 hours of intolerable heat a year at 3°C of global warming, warns study in *The Lancet Planetary Health*. FILE

throughout the year. They are concentrated between May and September," Professor Qinqin Kong, lead author of the study, told *The Indian Express* via email. At over 3°C of warming, older adults could experience intolerable heat repeatedly during both day and night for several consecutive months. Such exposure would put enormous pressure on access to cooling, electric-

ity, health services and heat-response programmes.

Prof Kong said older people face serious health risks from heat at lower temperatures than previously estimated. Previous studies relied heavily on measurements from healthy young adults to determine when temperature and humidity would become challenging for the human body. Older people

The IndianEXPRESS

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RAMNATH GOENKA

◆ IN 1932 ◆

BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

Rejig in party must be reset for governance

THE BJP'S organisational reshuffle is important, most of all, for its backdrop, and because of what lies ahead. It comes when the BJP-led government is two years into its third term at the Centre, and it needs to confront the gathering spectre of anti-incumbency. It comes days after a students' movement forced a Union minister to resign and propelled to centre-stage two long-playing national crises — education and employment. The party reset will be followed, in a few months, by crucial state elections, but going ahead, the BJP as party will need to work with BJP as government to meet formidable challenges that need a long-term compass. From reforms in the education system starting with the government school, to skilling and the filling of gaps between degrees and the market — these problems can no longer be managed, they will need to be addressed. The BJP rejig, therefore, will be assessed not by the to-and-fro of individuals but by whether or not they contribute to its ability to be future-ready.

The students' movement has served parties and governments an important warning — political and electoral outreach cannot be just about the savvy social-media strategy. It must address the rising aspirations in a country of the young, writ large by new media technologies, and identify the obstacles in social and economic mobility. In the light that has been cast on dark areas by the Jantar Mantar movement, the BJP must also confront challenges larger than Gen Z. It must ask, for instance, why for all its dominance and winning streak, electorates in states are choosing a new player wherever it crosses a minimum threshold of viability — Prashant Kishor's victory in the BJP bastion of Bankipur appeared to underline this trend most recently. By hitting the refresh button, by drawing in Vasundhara Raje, who has been chief minister of a large state, or Smriti Irani, who has handled the crucial education portfolio in the Union government, or Ram Madhav, who has navigated turbulent political territories like J&K and the Northeast, or Manpreet Singh Badal, who has been state finance minister, the BJP has made a new beginning. How will these veterans, who have navigated the imperatives of governance, enrich decision-making in the party, while coupling it with the government — is the question. They could build on their experience, sensitising the party to governance priorities, keeping it connected to ground realities.

The party reset, as important as it is, is only a first step. Now that party president Nitin Nabin's new team is in place, it may well be time for the government to follow the party. Because, quite simply, in times when older patterns don't hold, and political plates seem to be shifting, the onus of keeping up is squarely on the government and party.

On minerals and mines, strike federal balance

LAST WEEK, Parliament passed the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026 that restricts states' powers to impose levies on mineral rights and mineral-bearing lands. The Centre's rationale for bringing the amendments is to provide greater certainty and predictability in the sector, facilitate investment flows and prevent higher levies from feeding into infrastructure costs. States have, however, expressed apprehension over the implications of the amendments for their revenues in particular, and for fiscal federalism in general.

The amendments come after the Supreme Court upheld the right of states to impose such taxes, and also allowed them to recover arrears going back to April 1, 2005. Following this, states have looked towards raising more revenue from the sector. For instance, some of them have reportedly brought in mineral-bearing land taxes on iron ore (Jharkhand had initially imposed the tax on iron ore at Rs 100 per tonne, which was hiked subsequently) and limestone (Tamil Nadu has set a tax of Rs 160 per tonne). States impose 14 types of taxes, charges, fees and levies such as royalty, auction premium etc. Across states, rates of royalty and taxes also vary. The changes in the law can also be seen as a bid to bring about some degree of uniformity in prices of major minerals.

The rationalisation of taxes and royalties is a step towards facilitating greater investor interest in the sector. The effective tax rate in India is higher than 50 per cent of revenues while it is 35 to 40 per cent in other countries, according to a report on States' Best Practices in Mining by FIMI-EY. But state governments, with limited avenues to raise resources, are worried about a further erosion of their tax powers — for mineral rich states like Odisha, Jharkhand and Chhattisgarh, revenue from this channel accounts for a significant share of their non-tax revenue. According to a government fact-sheet, "States will continue to receive the overwhelming share of mining revenue," but friction between the Centre and states needs to be addressed. The Union government has launched a critical mineral mission. A more predictable mining framework would encourage greater investments in a sector that is vital for the growth of the country.

The prodigal jaguar against Trump wall

THE LAST female jaguar in the United States of America was killed by a hunter in 1949. The third-largest big cat, like its feline cousin, the tiger, is a solitary, elusive hunter. And like the leopard, its stealth means that it is particularly hard to spot. Now, nearly eight decades later, there is more than a slim chance that the majestic cat may come back to a habitat it was hunted out of. But the prodigal daughter's return is hitting a wall.

Over the last five years, male jaguars have been spotted in the Cuenca Los Ojos wildlife reserve in Mexico, across the border from Arizona in the US. Earlier this month, researchers captured footage of a "couple", the first sighting of a female so close to the US — Arizona was once part of the jaguar's natural range — in nearly seven decades. Adela, named so by researchers, presents the tantalising possibility of a natural return of the big cat. Unfortunately, Donald Trump's politics is standing in the way. Since 2025, the infamous "border wall" has blocked three out of the four wildlife corridors in the area between the US and Mexico.

Perhaps, the politics that seeks to harden lines on a map into dividing ones on the ground could find a way to let the animals through. After all, as Robert Frost wrote, in "The Mending Wall" in 1914, there are people who will insist that "good fences make good neighbours". And yet, there's always "something", in nature and in the hearts of people, "that doesn't love a wall".



RAJA MANDALA
BY C RAJA MOHAN

JAPANESE DEFENCE Minister Shinjiro Koizumi's visit to India this week comes amid the unfolding transformation of Tokyo's defence and regional security policies. Japan, long reined in by self-imposed military restraint, is adopting a more vigorous national defence policy and an active regional military diplomacy. That Koizumi is coming to Delhi after consultations in Canberra with his counterparts from Australia and New Zealand indicates new directions in security cooperation in the Indo-Pacific. Koizumi's talks in Delhi should help end the current slow and incremental approaches to defence cooperation and outline more ambitious goals for the security partnership.

Driving Japan's new defence policies is the rise of China as a great military power and Beijing's growing political will to translate that power into concrete outcomes. This is a challenge Delhi and Tokyo share as they confront assertive Chinese military policies — on Japan's maritime frontier with China and India's contested land border across the Himalayas. The geography is different, but the PLA's methods are the same: Persistent probing and the slow but definitive alteration of the territorial status quo.

For both Tokyo and Delhi, the challenge from China is magnified by the volatility of American policies. Neither seeks an Asia without America. Japan remains deeply in-

vested in its alliance with Washington, while India sees a continuing American military presence as essential to a stable Asian balance. But Donald Trump's second presidency has reinforced questions about the predictability of American policy and the nature of its regional commitments.

Part of the answer for Delhi and Tokyo lies in strengthening their own national capabilities and deepening partnerships with each other and other Asian powers. Koizumi's itinerary captures the possibilities. Japan's defence partnership with Australia has advanced rapidly. Canberra and Tokyo have expanded military exercises, reciprocal access, logistics and defence industrial cooperation. Australia's decision to acquire Japanese-designed *Mogami*-class frigates marks an important breakthrough for a country that, until recently, imposed extraordinary restrictions on exporting weapons.

India-Japan defence cooperation has also expanded, but remains well behind the political rhetoric about their "Special Strategic and Global Partnership". Koizumi's visit should therefore be an occasion not merely to review bilateral exercises and exchanges, but to ask how Delhi and Tokyo can give their defence partnership much greater operational and technological weight.

The opportunity arises from the extraordinary changes underway in Japan itself.

For much of the post-war era, Japanese strategy rested on a simple bargain. Tokyo concentrated on economic reconstruction while relying on the United States for security. Defence expenditure remained around 1 per cent of GDP, arms exports were tightly restricted, and the Self-Defence Forces operated within narrow political constraints. Those conditions began to change as the China

Shinjiro Koizumi's visit should be an occasion not merely to review bilateral exercises and exchanges, but to ask how both countries can give their defence partnership much greater operational and technological weight

Cambridge professor's death is a life lesson



MADHAVI RAVIKUMAR

PROFESSOR JASON Arday was found dead at his home in Battersea on August 14. He was 41 years old. Authorities regard the death as unexpected but not suspicious. Hours earlier, he had told a colleague he "couldn't go on." His family speaks of a campaign of sustained abuse and misinformation that finally became unbearable. The decisive force that pushed him to the edge was the scale and nature of the media scrutiny, mainstream newspapers and social-media platforms acting in relentless combination, that turned contested questions about an academic career into a public spectacle of personal destruction.

An independent count by NewsCord recorded roughly 249 articles about Arday across British national outlets in 22 days. Nearly 190 appeared after he had already resigned on August 5, indicating that the allegations, speculation and commentary had taken a profound toll. The coverage moved into repeated dissection of childhood claims, private life, every past achievement and every personal vulnerability. Once the story gained momentum, social media took over. Clips, memes, comment threads and derivative posts circulated without pause, stripping context and amplifying humiliation.

There were legitimate questions that required answers. Allegations of substantial textual overlaps in Arday's 2015 PhD thesis, problems in later papers, and inconsistencies in elements of his public biography were serious. Universities and the public have a proper interest in the reliability of credentials and published work at elite institutions. What does not follow is the conversion of those questions into a high-volume, highly personalised campaign that continued long after resignation and systematically targeted the person rather than the scholarly record.

This pattern is familiar across contexts. In Britain, Lucy Meadows, an elementary-school teacher, took her own life in 2013 following intense tabloid coverage of her gender change. The coroner told the media, "Shame on all of you," citing ridicule and character assassination. Caroline Flack, the television presenter, died by suicide in 2020 amid sustained tabloid and online hostility.

India offers an even more striking parallel. After Bollywood actor Sushant Singh

Rajput died by suicide in June 2020, Indian television news channels and social media launched an extraordinary, months-long campaign. Coverage rapidly shifted from the actor's death and mental health to conspiracy theories and a full-blown media trial of his girlfriend Rhea Chakraborty. She was publicly vilified as a manipulator, gold-digger and worse, often with little evidence. The CBI eventually closed the case, confirming suicide and exonerating her.

Arday's autism and history of developmental delay made him particularly vulnerable. Those who knew him in his final days described a vulnerable man whose mental health deteriorated visibly under the bombardment. Social media removed any residual distance. Platforms that present themselves as democratising information instead accelerated the conversion of a complex story into simplified, shareable judgment.

The media's conventional defence is familiar: Public interest, the right to scrutinise authority, the duty to report. All are real. However, public interest is not identical with the right to sustain a personalised campaign of attrition long after the professional consequences. When the coverage reaches hundreds of articles in three weeks, and when social media turns every new detail into further ridicule, the impact transforms from inquiry to spectacle.

Arday's death does not settle the scholarly disputes surrounding his work. Those remain matters for careful, evidence-based examination by the relevant institutions. It does, however, expose the human cost of a media culture that confuses volume with virtue and spectacle with scrutiny.

The right to investigate does not include the right to destroy. A society that cannot distinguish between rigorous accountability and destructive hounding has lost its sense of balance. If there is any constructive response to this tragedy, it begins with the recognition that the media gaze can itself become lethal.

The least that can be asked of those who report and those who amplify is that they remember there is a human being at the centre of every story.

The writer teaches at the Department of Communication, University of Hyderabad

challenge unfolded. In 2010, China overtook Japan as the world's second-largest economy. Its growing economic resources supported a massive expansion of military capabilities, the consequences of which for Japan soon became evident.

After returning as prime minister in 2012, Shinzo Abe accelerated the effort to adapt Japanese security policy to the new circumstances. As the scale of the China challenge deepened and concerns about American reliability grew, Japan outlined a sweeping set of defence reforms in 2022. One element was a rapid increase in defence expenditure. Tokyo set itself the goal of raising defence-related spending to around 2 per cent of GDP by 2027, but brought forward that target through additional spending last year.

More important has been the change in doctrine. Japan is acquiring long-range "counterstrike" capabilities, including American Tomahawk missiles, while developing longer-range indigenous weapons. It is strengthening air and missile defence, cyber and space capabilities, unmanned systems and its capacity to operate farther from the Japanese islands. A parallel revolution is unfolding in defence production. Tokyo is revitalising its defence industrial base, easing restrictions on arms exports and breaking down the old barriers between civilian technology and national security. Japan has also begun providing military equipment to friendly countries through its new Official Security Assistance programme.

Taken together, these changes represent something much larger than a Japanese "rearmament". Tokyo is finally turning to military power, defence technology, arms exports and security assistance as normal instruments of statecraft. Tokyo is also reaching out to South

Korea and other regional neighbours, deepening defence ties with Australia and New Zealand, and strengthening security engagement with Europe. Upgrading defence ties with India is a natural part of this wider strategy. Delhi and Tokyo already have much of the institutional architecture they need: A 2+2 dialogue, a logistics agreement and regular exercises across the three services. Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi's visit to Delhi last month called for more sophisticated exercises, stronger maritime domain awareness and deeper defence industrial cooperation. It also announced the first bilateral defence co-development project, involving the UNICORN naval communications antenna.

But here is the reality check. Defence industrial cooperation has been painfully slow. Delhi and Tokyo need much greater ambition in joint research, development and co-production of weapons and military technologies. Their armed forces must also move beyond exercising together towards greater operational coordination in anti-submarine warfare, maritime surveillance, air defence and logistics. The unfolding transformation of the Asian security environment demands that Delhi and Tokyo do much more together in defence. Japan is demonstrating greater purpose and urgency as it responds to the changing balance of power in Asia. Unlike China, India has long welcomed the prospect of a stronger Japan. It is now time for Delhi to match Tokyo's commitment and enthusiasm in building a consequential Asian defence partnership.

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At Darwin, Bangladesh upends the cricketing order



SHUVADITYA BOSE

BALL was yet to be bowled in Darwin, when Bangladesh captain Najmul Hossain Shanto was asked at a press conference: "Will this Test last five days, or end in three?" "We will try to take it to the fifth day," he replied. Bangladesh didn't require a fifth day — only four proved enough to secure a historic, narrative-defying nine-wicket triumph over Australia. India required 12 attempts. Pakistan seven. Sri Lanka have never done it. Bangladesh have a Test win on Australian soil at just the third time of asking — and yet, they have had to wait 26 years for it.

The deepest mark of hierarchy, argue psychologists, is not that the powerful believe they deserve more, but that the weak believe they deserve less. Before departing for the Test series, Shanto basked in pride for something that had nothing to do with Bangladesh cricket. He had just been briefed on Australia's squad. Cummins. Starc. Smith. Hazlewood. Stars, superstars, cricketing demigods. When he had taken it all in, Shanto, still absorbing the weight of the names before him, claimed: "Australia announcing a full-strength squad is an achievement for us." One would not have wanted to spoil Shanto's mood by pointing out the obvious: Australia's decision to field a full-strength side had more to do with WTC points on offer than with their assessment of Bangladesh. Historically, the latter has been low.

Bangladesh had been invited to Test cricket by Australia only once in 26 years. In 2003. And even then, they were looked at with disdain. Former Australia cricketer David Hookes, for instance, had said, "The reality is that Bangladesh doesn't deserve to be in Test cricket." A series was scheduled in 2018, but Australia deemed it pointless. The official reason was commercial viability. The unofficial assumption was simpler: Who would be interested in watching? Crestfallen, then BCB CEO had said: "Not every series we conduct is profitable. If we can conduct them, I believe Australia can do it too." Perhaps they could. Certainly they didn't. Bangladesh, like so many of cricket's smaller nations, was treated for long as expendable. Until they arrived in Darwin.

Starc, Hazlewood and Cummins may have more than 1,000 Test wickets between them, but in Darwin, it was Hasan Mahmud who burned brightest. Nine wickets. Tanzid Hasan Tamim scored 101. Hasan is 26. Tanzid is 25. Shakib Al Hasan, the world's No.1 Test all-rounder across multiple spells over the past decade, never played a Test in Australia. Hasan and Tanzid can consider themselves fortunate. But fortune, for them, should not be the end of the story. Bangladesh's purpose on this tour was never simply to win a trophy. It was to earn respect. And, with it, if Australia were kind enough, invitations. After the embarrassment in Darwin, though, will Australia make the same mistake again? When victory was sealed, the Bangladeshi players gathered and sang 'Amra korbo joy' — the Bengali adaptation of 'We Shall Overcome'. A little antiquated, perhaps. Had they learned condescension from their opponents, they would have chosen something cooler. Like Kendrick Lamar. Specifically, "Sit down. Be humble."

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40 YEARS AGO AUGUST 19, 1986



Agitation by Pak opposition

OPPOSITION PARTIES in Pakistan launched a countrywide indefinite agitation against the government crackdown on them and to overthrow President Zia-ul-Haq. Government and opposition supporters fought hand-to-hand in the streets and the police fired shotguns at rioters as political protests swept southern Pakistan, leaving at least eight people, including four policemen, dead.

Ban on MNF lifted

THE 19-YEAR-old ban on the Mizo National Front has been lifted. The Union government,

after being satisfied that the MNF had surrendered arms and observed all the terms of the accord, lifted the ban imposed earlier under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act. This will enable the MNF and its allied organisations to function as lawful political organisations. The MNF was banned first in 1967 after it had declared independent Mizoram on March 1, 1966.

Moscow extends N-test ban

THE SOVIET leader, Mikhail Gorbachev, announced that Moscow was extending its unilateral nuclear test ban until January 1, 1987. Gorbachev renewed his call to the

United States to follow Moscow's example and declare a moratorium on nuclear testing. Gorbachev invited US President Ronald Reagan to sign a treaty banning all nuclear testing this year. "The logic in this is simple: If there are no tests, the nuclear weapons which both sides have stockpiled in abundance will not be upgraded," he said.

Rs 30 cr flood relief for Andhra

THE PRIME Minister, Rajiv Gandhi, announced a ways and means advance of Rs 30 crore and Rs 30 lakh from the PM Relief Fund for relief and rehabilitation of the flood-affected people of Andhra Pradesh.



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What is an IIT for, where is it going? At 75, here are ten steps to the future



SUMAN CHAKRABORTY

SEVENTY-FIVE years ago, on August 18, 1951, India performed an extraordinary act of national imagination: It transformed a site of incarceration into a crucible of knowledge. Hijli — the hallowed ground that had borne witness to the freedom struggle — became home to IIT Kharagpur. A newly independent nation made a powerful declaration: Technology would not merely serve industry; it would serve nation-building. As we look towards the next quarter-century, the defining measure of excellence must change: Not simply how high an IIT rises, but how much of Bharat rises with it.

Top of the pyramid to strength of the pyramid

The IIT's sit at the apex of India's engineering-education pyramid, but an apex cannot claim excellence if the pyramid beneath it remains underserved. By 2047, every IIT should function simultaneously as a university and a national capability platform. IIT faculty must mentor networks of teachers, while IIT laboratories should offer structured access pathways to students and researchers across institutional tiers.

From teaching institutions to knowledge engines

Knowledge is increasingly created at the intersections — engineering and medicine, AI and agriculture, manufacturing and sustainability. Departments must remain pillars of deep domain expertise, but the walls between them must become porous. At IIT Kharagpur, the emerging ecosystem spanning medical technology and AI-enabled diagnostics, agriculture, advanced manufacturing, future energy, space technologies, entrepreneurship, research park-led industry engagement and grassroots living laboratories must converge into one institutional innovation pipeline.

JEE may be a door; it's not a verdict

Alongside JEE, GATE, JAM and other established routes, channels recognising ex-



ILLUSTRATION: C.R SASIKUMAR

ceptional achievement through olympiads, innovation and grand-challenge competitions, sports excellence and other demonstrable capabilities deserve more exploration. Such pathways must be protected from capture by coaching and formulaic preparation. More fundamentally, a student who does not enter an IIT should not be denied access to IIT. IIT Kharagpur's recently introduced Outreach Course Network can become a prototype of this new architecture.

The degree must change

In the 20th century, a degree certified what a graduate knew; by 2047, that proposition will be inadequate. AI will perform many routine tasks. Flexible architectures should allow students to traverse disciplinary boundaries without turning interdisciplinarity into an unstructured buffet. The IIT of 2047 must embrace an apparent paradox — that the more interdisciplinary the world becomes, the stronger the foundational disciplines must be.

Make students AI-powerful

Trying to make education "AI-proof" by shielding traditional assignments and examinations from AI would be much like trying to protect engineering drawing from CAD. The appropriate response is not avoidance but intellectual elevation. Every IIT student should acquire three fundamental capabilities: Understanding how AI works, knowing how to work intelligently with AI, and recognising when not to trust AI. Assessment must migrate from reproducing known solutions towards formulating un-

The deeper questions must be more demanding: How many teachers became better because an IIT existed? How many discoveries survived the test of the real world?

known problems, critiquing machine-generated outputs and creating something that did not previously exist.

IIT must enter the school before the student enters IIT

India's educational ecosystem cannot be repaired at age 18. The intervention must begin much earlier in schools — not by turning children prematurely into JEE aspirants, but by restoring curiosity, experimentation and the joy of asking questions. Every IIT must engage with a network of schools, as a permanent educational laboratory where faculty and students work alongside school-teachers to develop inexpensive hands-on experiments, multilingual science resources, AI-enabled learning tools and contextual approaches. This is the philosophy of IIT Kharagpur's new School-Connect programme.

Turn the campus into India's technology testbed

A campus inhabited by tens of thousands is a miniature city in which almost every major technological challenge of contemporary India is present at a manageable yet meaningful scale. The IIT campus should become a living testbed for India@2047, where emerging technologies are subjected to the realities of everyday use. The same philosophy must extend beyond the campus, with surrounding rural communities, municipalities, hospitals, MSMEs, schools and grassroots enterprises.

Entrepreneurship, an academic outcome

For decades, an implicit hier-

archy placed scholarship at the centre, industry engagement one step away, and entrepreneurship beyond the university's boundaries. That is now obsolete. A student or faculty member who builds a responsible enterprise around a technological idea does not step away from scholarship but can extend its reach. Every significant IIT discovery should have a visible pathway towards translation, even though only a fraction will ultimately become commercially successful.

From brain drain to brain circulation

The old question was whether India could prevent its best students from leaving; the more consequential question for 2047 is whether Indian institutions can become sufficiently magnetic for the world's best minds, ideas and opportunities. The vocabulary of "brain drain" itself needs to evolve, because in an interconnected knowledge economy, mobility need not signify loss if institutions are capable of converting movement into enduring intellectual connectivity.

IIT @2047: Change the definition of success

The IIT of 2047 must be a university without intellectual walls, a national research engine, an innovation foundry, an entrepreneurship platform, a teacher multiplier, a technological living laboratory, a global knowledge node and a public institution accountable to society. The deeper questions must be more demanding: How many teachers became better because an IIT existed? How many institutions became stronger because an IIT shared its capabilities? How many discoveries survived the test of the real world? How many communities gained better healthcare, energy, education and livelihoods? How many young people who never entered an IIT found knowledge, mentorship, infrastructure or opportunity because an IIT chose to reach them?

That must be the measure of our next 25 years: Not merely whether IIT Kharagpur becomes one of the world's great universities, but whether Bharat becomes more innovative and more confident because IIT Kharagpur chose to think beyond itself.

The writer is director, IIT Kharagpur, and Institute Chair Professor and J. C. Bose National Fellow



SUMIT SAMOS

EVERY YEAR around this time, India argues with itself. One side asks: Are we truly free? The other celebrates Independence Day as a moment of national glory and pride. Few images capture this contradiction better than a poor child in tattered clothes selling Tricolour flags at a traffic signal, alongside the PM's speech from the Red Fort and the flood of flags, patriotic songs, Army pride, cultural events and TV broadcasts.

Then come the statistics. One side cites poverty, inequality and exclusion; the other points to rising incomes, welfare schemes, education and social mobility. This binary can be captured quite well in the tussle between social mobility discourse that has been in vogue in academia and what Sherry Ortner calls "dark anthropology", focused on domination, exclusion and violence. It is an important lens, but leaves little room for understanding how marginalised groups have also created concrete freedoms for themselves, through both state institutions and their own struggles.

My fieldwork in remote southern Odisha last year brought this contradiction home. Many of my interlocutors were Dalits and Adivasis. When I asked what life was like in the 1970s and 1980s, some described hunger that is difficult to imagine today. Today, they no longer worry about starvation in the same way because they receive rations regularly. For someone who

The state could be both a source of opportunity and an instrument of dispossession. This contradiction appears across India, and it will be useful to trace it through Dalit realities

has known hunger, that is a concrete freedom. Yet these communities were far from passive beneficiaries of the state. They opposed moneylenders, forest officials, state-supported displacement projects and feudal practices associated with hereditary Brahmin officials. The state, in other words, could be both a source of opportunity and an instrument of dispossession. This contradiction appears across India, and it will be useful to trace it through Dalit realities.

Sandhya Fuchs, in her study of atrocity cases in Rajasthan, shows how Dalit victims can be denied justice through legal mistranslation. Yet Geert De Neve has documented how Dalits in western Tamil Nadu have used the SC/ST Prevention of Atrocities Act to challenge dominant-caste power. The law can be an instrument of exclusion in one situation and a weapon to challenge caste power in another. Migration tells a similar story. Dalit labourers from Bihar working at construction sites in Tamil Nadu live with bare-minimum savings and insecure employment. Yet some working in Kerala earn better wages and aspire to build concrete houses and basic amenities for their families.

Politics reveals the same complexity. During the 2024 general election, Hindutva politics sought to mobilise voters in UP around the Ram Mandir inauguration and religious identity. Yet a section of Dalit voters moved away from the

BJP because they feared it could undermine the Constitution and reservation, a reminder that marginalised citizens are not merely passive victims of political manipulation.

Ambedkar warned that universal suffrage and regular elections alone could not guarantee democracy in a society marked by deep historical inequalities. A governing class, he argued, could use power to bypass democratic means. Dalit communities have challenged this bypassing, demanding that state institutions act as neutral administrators. Through protests and collective action, they have pushed Indian social life towards greater equality and dignity. At the same time, some sections have been drawn into dominant ideologies like Hindutva.

For a Dalit family, freedom may mean regular food, a hostel for a child, access to education, the ability to migrate, a concrete house, entry into a public space, or protection under the law. It may also coexist with exploitation, discrimination, insecurity and state neglect. August 15 need not force us to choose between these stories. Freedom was not simply delivered to Indians in 1947. For millions, it has been — and continues to be — made, negotiated and fought for in the ordinary spaces of everyday life. That is perhaps the more complicated story of independent India. But it may also be the more truthful one.

The writer is a rapper and a PhD student at University of Pennsylvania

As Tatas choose new leader, remember: Noise is not the story



R GOPALAKRISHNAN AND ISHAAT HUSSAIN

MEDIA REPORTAGE during the last fortnight has been prolific regarding Tata — the chairman of Tata Sons not offering himself for a third term in February 2027, succession speculations, relationships among leaders, leaders' performance appraisal, and much more. Are recent Tata developments signs of flaws in governance and transparency? Or, do they reflect the reality that views can differ among individuals? Society teaches us that differences are normal, but what is important is resolving them so there are no permanent winners or losers. The babble has been so intense that we were reminded of the adage, "Those who know do not speak and those who speak do not know." The reportage also revived our memories of the Kishore Kumar song from Amar Prem: "*Kuch to log kahenge, logon ka kaam hai kehna, chhodo bekar ki baton mein beet na jaye raina.*"

That the heads of Sons and Trusts had professional differences is not a secret. Whether the differences were small or large, legitimate or misplaced, ego-driven or not, are all matters that only the concerned pair will know. Such a situation can occur between two perfectly well-intentioned and honourable people, and that seems to be so in this Tata case.

Common sense and experience tell us that conflicts and differences can be salvaged only through conversation, convergence, compromise, and commitment. Importantly, if salvaging is not possible through reconciliation and readjustment, then a dignified and mutual separation is a valid course. Top-level differences should not affect the institution negatively.

It is likely that recent actions have been motivated by precisely this consideration.

History offers many cases where what appeared to be a difference of opinion was not addressed and ended up contributing to undesirable conflicts. Julius Caesar and Pompey the Great were close political allies in Rome — in fact, Pompey was Caesar's son-in-law — until personal distrust, rivalry, and competition gradually poisoned the relationship. Caesar's successful conquest of Gaul made him extremely powerful, and Pompey became concerned that Caesar would dominate Rome. Their growing conflict could not be resolved through negotiation or compromise. Finally, in 49 BCE, Caesar initiated the civil war with Pompey.

Around the time of World War I, Kaiser Wilhelm II ruled in Germany, King George V in Britain, and Tsar Nicholas II in Russia, all cousins. Wilhelm's impulsive behaviour and insecurity damaged these personal ties. Of course, the war was not caused by family relationships, but mistrust among family members lessened the opportunities for compromise.

There are three common patterns suggested by history. First, honour and prestige become key. Second, leaders personalise disputes. Third, miscommunication creates exaggerated perceptions of insults.

In the Tata case, the leaders were unable to resolve their issues, so the differences were extinguished through graceful adjustments. Above all, the leaders have protected their institutions.

However, such episodes attract everyone to analyse and comment. It is in this context that Padma Shri poet Bashir Badr wrote, "*Parakhna mat, parakhne se koi apna nahi rahta, Kisi bhi aine mein der tak chehra nahin rehta* (If you analyse too much then you will lose relationships, just as a mirror does not hold a reflection for long)."

Conspiracy theories circulate, where none or some may be true. In this case, some view it as a Trusts versus Sons dispute, some as a Parsi versus non-Parsi dispute, some as a promoter versus professional dispute, some as a capital allocation discipline issue. It is fruitless to criticise, analyse and paralyse, based on assumptions.

Two facts are clear. First, as per Tata retirement policies, the chairman of Tata Sons would anyway have given up executive positions from June 2028 upon turning 65. Therefore, the board must have had some succession plan. Second, renewing the chairman's contract for a third term was a unanimous decision of the Trust members in September 2025, 17 months before the ongoing contract would come up for renewal. It is this unanimous decision that led to the likely change in the tenure and dates of the chairman's succession. The matter appeared on the Tata Sons board agenda at the instance of the Trusts in February. It appears that one director expressed reservations regarding certain economic and business issues. Bearing in mind the interests of the employees, investments and business of Tata Sons, the chairman has gracefully announced his decision not to seek re-election. The die has been cast, and attention must change to effective succession.

Tata is a rare national jewel. It is a business group that most Indians respect and love. Let us, therefore, wish Tata all the best in finding a successor and returning the enterprise to its mission of creating employment, family advancement, and national prosperity.

The writers are both retired directors of Tata Sons with a combined experience of working for Tatas of over half a century

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Freedom and liberty

VANDITA MISHRA'S column exposes a sharp truth: National freedom and individual liberty are not always the same thing ('August 15 after Jantar Mantar: The many spaces of freedom-and unfreedom', *IE*, August 18). While official rhetoric paints a grand picture of progress, student protests at Jantar Mantar reveal a parallel reality — one defined by institutional control, political resistance and shrinking spaces for critical debate. Gen Z activism is no longer about politics; it is an issue-driven, relentless push for basic civil rights and accountability.

Fathimathul Safa, Kannur

The idea of India

YOGENDRA YADAV'S piece on Gulzar's call for a new *qaumitaraana* ('What will we sing of now when we sing of patriotism', *IE*, August 18) ends with a line that stuck with me. We may have lost not just our old patriotic songs, but "the imagined community that we call a nation". Before we ask for a song every Indian can hum, we should ask a harder question: Do all Indians currently feel invited into the idea of India? Old patriotic songs worked because nation-building felt like a shared project, a feeling, not a slogan. That feeling is missing today. Many, from communities in Manipur to Dalits, Adivasis and queer citizens, still don't see themselves in the nation we keep singing about.

Rishabh Kumar, Varanasi

Rupee relief

THE RBI'S FCNR(B) swap window offered the rupee temporary relief by mobilising foreign currency deposits, but at the cost of future vulnerabilities ('The rupee's borrowed breathing space', *IE*, August 18). While the move signals confidence, it is essentially borrowed stability, leaving banks exposed to asset-liability mismatches. This reflects the tension between immediate liquidity support and long-term resilience. Without reforms, the currency remains unhedged against external shocks.

Abhinav Shah, Lucknow



NIMISHA JHA

EVERY AI system begins with data, and every dataset begins with people. When people are absent from that data, AI inherits those gaps. The AI pipeline is not merely a technological conduct of code, silicon and compute power; it is fundamentally a human pipeline. It begins before the first line of code is written and shapes decisions affecting millions. India ranks among the world's leading AI-ready nations, powered by Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) and a thriving innovation ecosystem. Yet beneath this progress lies a structural contradiction. While India produces one of the world's largest pools of women STEM graduates,

women steadily disappear as the AI pipeline advances. At every stage, the pipeline leaks talent, lived experience, and innovation.

The challenge is evident in the numbers: In STEM foundation, women account for 43 per cent of India's STEM graduates; in the tech workforce, representation falls to 26 per cent; in advanced AI roles, only 12 per cent of professionals are women; In senior AI leadership, women hold just 10 per cent of senior AI leadership positions.

The challenge extends beyond employment. Only 57 per cent of women have independent internet access, compared with 72 per cent of men. The root causes of this leakage are deeply social. These disparities arise from unequal nutrition, education, caregiving responsibilities, workplace discrimination, and language barriers. AI learns from society; if society is unequal, AI inevitably re-

flects those inequalities. Asha, a member of a self-help group in rural Bihar, applies for a micro-loan. If AI credit models rely mainly on historical male financial patterns, they may underestimate her creditworthiness. In Gujarat, Meera, a community health worker, depends on AI-enabled maternal health tools. If the training data fails to reflect local nutrition and health conditions, inaccurate recommendations may affect maternal care.

India has already shown how technology can advance public welfare at scale. The India AI Mission now offers an opportunity to ensure AI follows the same inclusive path

The barriers emerge early. Kavya cannot pursue robotics because her school lacks adequate infrastructure. Pooja struggles with English-dominated AI education. Nisha, despite becoming an AI engineer, often finds herself the only woman in the room, with limited influence in product design. AI automates existing inequalities when trained on incomplete or biased data.

Yet AI can also expand opportunity. Across rural India, women's self-help groups have built strong financial ecosystems through collective savings and entrepreneurship. When women occupy positions of influence, the technology shifts. India's progress in AI-enabled inclusion reflects a deeper national principle. When India adopted its Constitution in 1950, it granted women and men universal adult franchise simultaneously. This commitment to inclusion con-

tinues today through DPI and provides a strong foundation for building inclusive AI much before other Western democracies.

India has already shown how technology can advance public welfare at scale. The India AI Mission now offers an opportunity to ensure AI follows the same inclusive path. True AI leadership cannot be measured only by models, investments, or patents. It must also be measured by whether AI reflects India's diversity of languages, cultures, socioeconomic realities, and lived experiences. Achieving that requires more than diverse datasets. Women and marginalised communities must participate as researchers, engineers, entrepreneurs, and policymakers.

The writer is a civil servant posted in the Ministry of Women and Child Development, Government of India. Views are personal

The Big Picture

WEDNESDAY, AUGUST 19, 2026

13

THE TATA SUCCESSION BATTLE

OVER TO NOEL

For years, Noel Tata, Ratan Tata's half-brother, 20 years his junior, was the 'other Tata', self-effacing and reserved. Now, as a corporate battle in the 158-year-old group takes a new turn, **GEORGE MATHEW** on the man whose influence will determine who gets to head Tata Sons

IT WAS set to be a done deal. Had it been put to vote, Natarajan Chandrasekaran would have sailed through, securing another term as chairman of Tata Sons, the holding company of the 158-year-old Tata Group. After all, four of the six board members were in his favour. But that day, February 24, 2026, the boardroom was tense. One man on the board, Noel Tata, had tough questions — about losses made by several companies in the \$180 billion group, about its possible public listing, and what justified another term for Chandrasekaran as chairman. It was clear that Noel Tata was in no mood to give Chandrasekaran a walkover.

At the end of the meeting at Bombay House, the headquarters of the Tata Group, Chandrasekaran proposed that the decision be deferred until a consensus was reached. He didn't want the extension of his term to go through without the approval of Noel Tata, chairman of Tata Trusts, the family-run philanthropic arm that owns roughly two-thirds of Tata Sons.

It was a point, Tata watchers say, when Noel, for long the 'other Tata' in the room, came into his own. It would have been hard for anyone to step into the legendary Ratan Tata's shoes, possibly even harder to step out of them. That Noel — Ratan Tata's half-brother, two decades his junior — could have that day effectively vetoed Chandrasekaran, the man Ratan Tata had appointed to the post instead of his half-brother, was remarkable for a business house that has long prided itself on reaching key decisions by consensus.

On August 12, Chandrasekaran announced his decision to exit as Tata Sons chairman at the end of his term in February 2027, bringing to a close one of the most dramatic boardroom battles in recent times. With Noel likely to be on the five-member selection committee that will choose Chandrasekaran's successor, he could have a decisive say in who comes next.

"In a company, the owner has every right to hire and fire key persons. Tata Trusts and group companies own majority stakes in Tata Sons. He (Noel) has every right to make recommendations for the post as Tata Trusts' chairman, obviously with the backing of other trustees," a senior Tata Group official told *The Indian Express*.

Ratan and Noel

From the 1990s until his death in 2024, Ratan Tata had been the public face of the Tata Group, the man at the heart of an empire spanning steel, automobiles, aviation, software, power, hotels, consumer businesses and much else. While he stepped down as chairman of Tata Sons in December 2012, he continued to lead Tata Trusts and have a decisive influence over the group's governance, until his death in October 2024.

It was then that Noel emerged as the family's main representative. While Ratan Tata's ailing younger brother Jimmy Tata paid public homage to his departed sibling at Mumbai's National Centre for the Performing Arts on October 10, it was Noel who received VIP guests throughout the mourning period.

In his homage, Noel Tata said, "There is no greatness where there is no simplicity, goodness and truth, Leo Tolstoy said. Measure Ratan Tata by these characteristics, and there can be no doubting what he brought to the world he lived in and what we have lost with his passing."

For the longest time, however, the half-brothers had been distant, with their upbringing under different circumstances. After Ratan Tata's father Naval Hormusji Tata separated from their mother Soono Comissariat, Ratan and Jimmy Tata were largely brought up by their grandmother Navajbai Tata.

Naval went on to marry Swiss-born Simone Dunoyer, and by the time Noel was born to the couple in 1957, Ratan Tata was 20 years old.

In her 2021 book *The Tatas, Freddie Mercury & Other Bawas*, veteran journalist and *The Indian Express's* Contributing Edi-

ILLUSTRATION: SUVAJIT DEY

• Corporate Structure of Tata Group

TATA TRUSTS: Owns roughly two-thirds of Tata Sons, with the holdings primarily through various charitable trusts, including the Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT) and Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT)

• **Chairman:** Noel Tata

TATA SONS: Tata Sons is the principal investment holding company and promoter of the Tata Group, which comprises 31 companies, including 26 publicly listed companies. Sixty-six percent of the equity share capital of Tata Sons is held by philanthropic trusts, which support education, health, livelihood generation and art and culture.

• **Publicly listed businesses under Tata Sons:** TCS, Tata Motors, Tata Steel, and Titan

• **Private unlisted companies:** Air India, Tata Digital, Tata Electronics, Tata International

• **Chairman:** Natarajan Chandrasekaran

tor Coommi Kapoor writes that when Ratan Tata returned to India after graduating from Cornell University and staying back in the US for seven years, it was to a very different home. "...it is possible that Ratan may have felt ignored in the family home. His father had a new family, which included his half-brother — christened Noel, since he was born on Christmas Day. Noel was twenty years younger, and perhaps Ratan resented the newcomer's presence. The relationship between Ratan and his stepmother is believed to be rather distant."

Noel, Kapoor writes, was then "the indulged baby boy, twenty years younger than his half-brother. Ratan was generally not present at Noel's mother Simone's Christmas and New Year bashes, even though he lived next door".

The Noel family lives in Windermere building in downtown Mumbai's Cuffe Parade, not very far from the sea-facing Bakhtawar, also called Cabins and Halekai bungalow, Ratan Tata's home in Colaba.

Noel, now 69, is married to Aloo Mistry, the sister of former Tata Sons chairman Cyrus Mistry. In 2003, Noel, along with the entire Mistry family, acquired Irish citizenship after his father-in-law Pallonji Mistry's marriage to Dublin-based Patsy Perin.

Noel's mother Simone, who was the brain behind Lakme, the Tata group's popular cosmetic brand, died in December 2025. Trent, the group's retail arm that Noel turned around and is arguably his biggest achievement yet, was created in 1998 from the proceeds of sale of Lakme.

"I only know Noel Tata as an academically well-qualified, accomplished, low-

profile person. With his distinguished mother, he built a Rs 180,000-crore retail enterprise in India," says R Gopalakrishnan, former Director of Tata Sons.

Noel took over as Managing Director of Trent in 1999 after a Bachelor's from Sussex University (UK) and an International Executive Programme at France's INSEAD. Under Noel, Trent expanded dramatically across formats, eventually turning into the company behind household names such as Westside and Zudio. From one store in 1998, Westside grew to more than 1,200 stores across formats during his tenure.

In June this year, Noel announced at the Trent Annual General Meeting that he was stepping down as chairman in line with the Tata Group's governance guidelines, under which non-executive directors retire at 70.

Despite Noel's successful stint at Trent, Ratan Tata was, by all accounts, unwilling to promote his half-brother. As late as 2019, Noel was not even a trustee on any of the major Tata trusts.

Besides, he was overlooked for the post of chairman of Tata Sons at least twice. In 2012, when Ratan Tata decided to retire as Chairman of Tata Sons, most eyes turned towards the low-profile, reticent Noel. But the mantle ultimately went to Cyrus Mistry. Then, in 2016, when Mistry was dramatically ousted from the chairmanship, speculation again swirled around Noel. But then, too, he was overlooked, this time in favour of Chandrasekaran, then the MD and CEO of Tata Consultancy Services, the group's flagship technology company.

In his book *Ratan Tata: A Life*, author and former bureaucrat Thomas Mathew

quotes Ratan Tata as saying, "Perhaps, if Noel had the experience of handling difficult assignments, he could have established his credentials more forcefully."

Apart from that rare remark, both Ratan and Noel Tata spoke very little about each other in public. But people close to Noel say that Ratan was fond of his half-brother's children Leah, Maya and Neville. Neville is already a trustee in Tata Trusts and is involved in the retail business. Leah works with Indian Hotels and Maya with Tata Digital and Trent.

In February 2019, Noel was finally inducted as a trustee of the Sir Ratan Tata Trust, one of the two core, allied trusts that anchor the Tata Trusts network. Kapoor writes, "It was only when Ratan's long-time financial advisor, Noshir Soonawala, stepped down, at the age of eighty-four, and reportedly called on Ratan to induct Noel that Ratan's half-brother was appointed in his place."

The bond between the two half-siblings, Coommi Kapoor writes, became stronger after 2016, around which time, Noel says in an interview, they met regularly. In February 2022, he was finally inducted as a trustee of the Sir Dorab Tata Trust, too.

Noel comes into his own

People who know him say Noel, usually seen in button-down shirts in blue or white, is self-effacing and reserved. "When I met him at a simple Tata guest house in Mumbai when I was involved in writing the book, I realised he has amazing vision about various things," Mathew says.

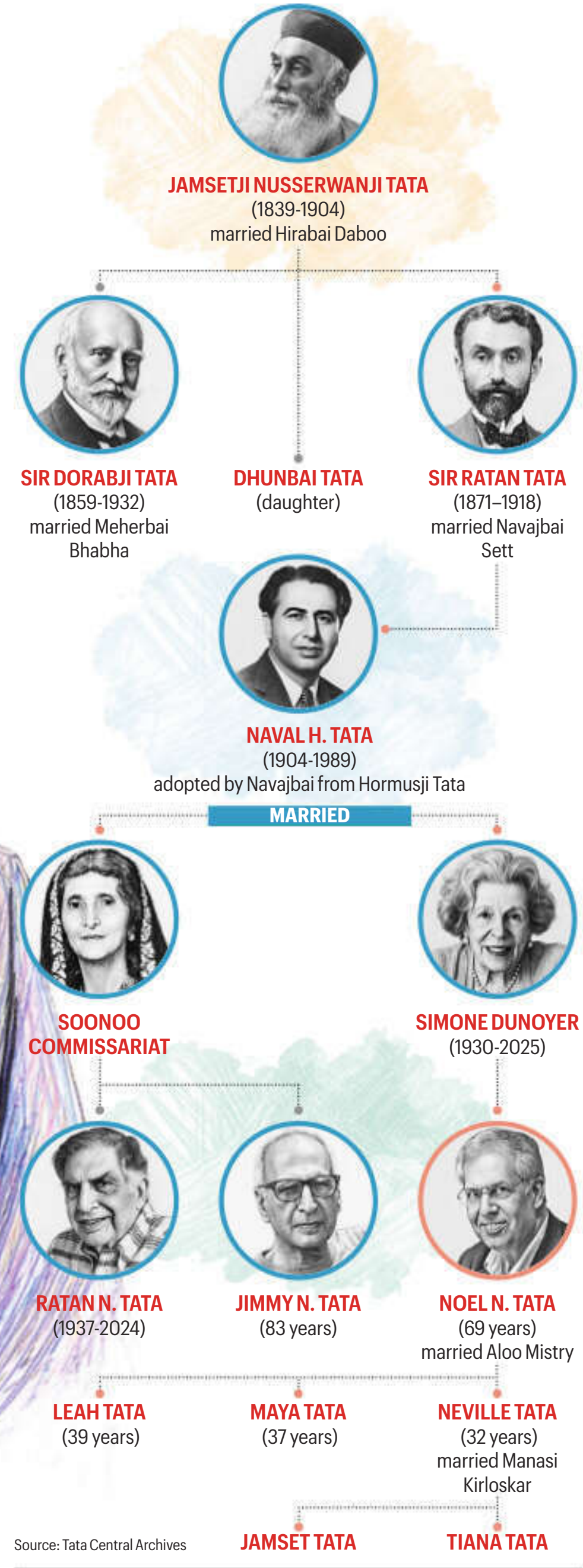
Others, however, see a different side. "As a business leader, he's untested so far," says a top source who is part of the Tata ecosystem. "He was not part of the core business of manufacturing in the group. He was the chairman of the loss-making Tata International."

A top source in the Tata Group says, "While Noel lacks the stature and standing of Ratan Tata in the Indian industrial landscape, he has proved his mettle by successfully running companies like Trent and Tata Investment Corporation... and he was on the boards of leading Tata companies like Tata Steel. His role will be that of a guide, guard and policy-maker for the group. He can always step in when Tata Sons or group companies make wrong decisions."

Yet, they all point to the February 2026 meeting, when he challenged Chandrasekaran on the latter's reappointment and the direction of the group, as evidence of a man increasingly willing to make his views heard and establish his authority — much as Ratan Tata had done decades earlier.

In 1991, when Ratan Tata took over as chairman of Tata Sons from Jehangir Ratanji Dadabhai (JRD) Tata, who stepped

• THE TATAS



Source: Tata Central Archives

• Upheavals since Noel Tata took charge

OCTOBER 2025: Mehli Mistry, a longtime trustee of the Sir Ratan Tata Trust and Sir Dorabji Tata Trust and a close confidant of Ratan Tata, is voted out after trustees decline to renew his tenure

FEBRUARY 2026: Ex-CEO of Citi India, Pramit Jhaveri, a supporter of Mistry, also does not opt for reappointment to the Trusts

MAY 2026: Noel Tata votes against reappointment of Ratan Tata's close aide, former Defence Secretary Vijay Singh, and TVS Motors' Venu Srinivasan as trustees of Tata Education and Development Trust

AUGUST 2026: Vijay Singh, who argued for listing of Tata Sons against Noel, does not opt for reappointment to Sir Ratan Tata Trust. He will exit all other Trusts by July 2027

• **Tata Sons Chairman N. Chandrasekaran has now opted to vacate his post**

down after leading the conglomerate for over 50 years, he eased out some of the most prominent faces — from Russi Mody of Tata Steel to Darbari Seth of Tata Chemicals and Ajit Kerkar of Indian Hotels — and replaced them with his men.

In Noel's case, it started with Mehli Mistry, his wife's cousin and Ratan Tata's close friend. Last year, Mehli was not renominated to the Tata Trusts. Another Tata Trusts member, former Citi India CEO Pramit Jhaveri, saw the writing on the wall and didn't opt for reappointment. Chandrasekaran, too, had earlier postponed the decision on his extension.

There had, for some time, been a sense within the group that Noel and Chandrasekaran had differing views on the direction of Tata Sons. Some of Noel's concerns were about the way the group was evolving under Chandrasekaran — including how far it should move into newer businesses, how those businesses were being managed and how the Tata Group's long-established culture should be preserved. The question of whether Tata Sons should remain private had become another point of difference, as had the losses being incurred by some of its newer and unlisted businesses.

The way ahead for Noel, Tatas

When the five-member selection committee, which may include Noel Tata, meets to decide on the new chairman of Tata Sons, there will be questions to confront. Will the new chairman be a Tata insider, someone promoted from the many Tata companies? A family member? A member of the Parsi community? Or will the Tatas look beyond as they scout for talent?

Those close to Noel say that his choice will reflect some of his concerns related to the Group.

While the market capitalisation of the Tata Group's listed companies has more than tripled over the past nine years, rising to around Rs 27 lakh crore, it has been accompanied by mounting losses at some of the group's major unlisted businesses, and these companies need to be returned to profitability.

The losses of eight unlisted Tata companies stood at Rs 33,538 crore in FY26. Air India accounted for the largest share of these losses, with its annual loss doubling to Rs 22,238 crore. Tata Digital, another key unlisted business that houses the group's digital ambitions, reported a loss of Rs 4,974 crore during the year.

As the group looks for a new direction and investment plan in the wake of changing technological advancements, Noel's every move, especially the selection of the new chairman of Tata Sons, will be keenly watched and scrutinised.



(From left) Naval Tata with sons Noel and Ratan. SOURCE: HORIZONS, TATA TRUSTS

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, GURMEET D/o MOHINDER SINGH W/o MALKIAT SINGH R/o H-3/49 LUXMI VIHAR APARTMENT, VIKAS PURI, DELHI, 110018 have changed my name to **GURMEET KAUR** for all purposes. 0071055181-1

I, Shyam Kumar, alias Shyam Kumar Bhardwaj, alias Shyam Bhardwaj, S/o Pillu Ram, R/o.162, Sarai Jullena, New Friends Colony, South, Delhi-110025, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Shyam-Kumar. 0040873075-10

I, Sonia, w/o Vishal Sharma, r/o, House no - 42/61 Third floor- Chowki no- 2 Sindhora, Kalan Ashok vihar Delhi -110052, have changed my name to Sonia Sharma 0040873080-5

I, Mohammad Zahid S/o Anisur Rehman R/o 1028, Gali Chabuk Sawar, Lal Kuan, Delhi-110006 have changed my name as **MOHD ZAHID** permanently. **MOHD ZAHID** and **MOHAMMAD ZAHID** both are same and one person. 0040872956-2

I, NITUN AGARWAL, W/O-VINEET KUMAR BAGARIA, R/O-82, POKKET-4A, SPRING VALLEY, SECTOR-23, ROHINI, DELHI-110085, have changed my name to **NUTAN AGARWAL** 0040873099-5

I, MANJU SINGH alias **MANJU CHANDEL W/o SANTOSH KUMAR SINGH**, Aged About 52 Years, R/o B-22, DDA Flats, Kalkaji, South Delhi, Delhi-110019, have changed my name to **MANJU SINGH** for all purposes. 0071055204-1

I, Umesh-Kumar, S/O. Lt. Shri Kartar Singh, R/o 19/35-A, Tilak Nagar, Delhi-110018, have changed name from **Umesh-Kumar-Makkar** to **Umesh Kumar**. My son **Udit Makkar** shall hereafter refer to me as **Umesh-Kumar** in all his official records. 0040873075-7

I, Faijan, S/O Samshad R/o H NO-491, D-Block, Gali No-13, Shri Ram Colony, Rajeev Nagar, Delhi-110094, Have Changed My Name To **FAIZAN** Permanently. 0040873093-2

I, Kamlesh Sarathe S/o Shri Mahesh Sarathe R/o Flat No-1705, Tower-D, Ace Platinum, Sector zeta-1, greater Noida G.B. Nagar, U. P. My daughter's correct name is Lavanya Sarathe, that my daughter's other name is Lavanya .Lavanya and Lavanya Sarathe are the same person. 0071055141-1

I, Leelawati Tewari w/o D N Tewari R/o Flat No 39A, Block-B-1A, Janak Puri New Delhi-110058 declare that in my CGHS card no 966479, family details in service documents of late **Shri D N Tewari** and bank documents my name has been mentioned as **Lilawati Tewari**. My name in Aadhar card and PAN card has been mentioned as **Leelawati Tewari**. I further declare that **Lilawati Tewari** and **Leelawati Tewari** both are the same and one person. Hereafter I shall be known as **Leelawati Tewari** for all future purposes. 0040873012-1

I, Harsh, S/O Narendar Singh, R/o New Basant Vihar, Badli-Road Bahadurgarh, Distt-Jhajjar (Haryana), declare that have changed my name from **Harsh to Harsh Beniwal**. 0040873075-12

I, MOHAMMAD ADIL AYYUB S/O MOHD AYYUB R/o Sohanchida Must, Saharanpur, U.P. have change my name to **MOHD ADIL AYYUB**. 0040873080-7

I, Saif Ali Khan S/o Seth Khan, R/o Ward No.1, ETA, Ganganagar, Rajasthan, present at New Delhi 110083 In Aadhar card record 's my name is written as **Asha Taterao Bhende** but my actual & correct name is **Saif Ali Khan**. 0040872955-1

I hitherto known as **Raja Bhai Chaudhry S/o Shashi Bhushan Singh** residing at **Rajeev Nagar, Ashiyana Road, Patna, PO- Ashiananagar, Distt-Patna, Bihar - 800025**, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as **Abhishek Kumar Singh**. 0071055220-1

I, Surbhi Aggarwal, W/o-Niket mittal R/o- 252-253, 2nd floor, Pocket -F-24, Sector -3, Rohini, Delhi-110085 have changed my name to **Surbhi Mittal** for all future purposes. 0040873077-2

I Rajni Chhabra W/O, Saurabh Dheer R/O F-188/3, g/f, gali No.5, Mangal Bazar, Laxmi Nagar, East Delhi, Delhi-110092 have changed my name to **Rajni Dheer** 0040872951-1

I, Reshma Naqvi, w/o Shri Sameer Hussain Naqvi, my Daughter Name is **Samreen Naqvi**, permanent address, B-4/BLOCK-B, NEW RAJNEETI-NAGAR, NEW DELHI, PATEL-NAGAR, CENTRAL-Delhi, PIN-110 008, declare that my name has been wrongly written as **Reshma Banu, W/O Md. Samir in** my daughter's name **Samreen**, aged 28 in her school educational documents. The actual name of mine is **Reshma Naqvi, W/O Sameer-Hussain Naqvi** & my Daughter Name is **Samreen-Naqvi, D/o Sameer-Hussain-naqvi** which may be amended accordingly. 0040873093-4

I, RAJ KUMAR GAUR, S/o Ram Kumar, R/o L-4, Hauj-Khas Enclave, Delhi-110016, have changed my name from **RAJ KUMAR GAUR** to **RAJ KUMAR** for all purposes. 0040873080-1

I Geetanjali D/o Vinay Kumar and W/o Jaspreet Singh R/o C-1/28, Sector-16 Rohini, Rohini Sector 15, North West Delhi, Delhi - 110089, have changed my name to **Geetanjali Thakarwal** 0071055146-1

I, Saloni Singh W/o Abhisek Singh R/o CM3-005, Supertech Capetown Sector-74, Noida (U.P.) have changed my name to **Saloni Mehra** for all future purposes. 0040872996-2

I, Sunita Devi Singh W/o Rajeev Kumar Singh R/o Kamjenpur, Azamgarh, Uttar Pradesh-276001, have changed my name to **Sunita Singh**. 0040873075-2

I Ram Singh Walia S/o Late Shri K.C. Ahluwalia, R/o T -510/A -3, Mandir Marg, Baljeet Nagar, Patel Nagar, S.O. Central Delhi, Delhi-110008 have changed my name to **Ram Singh Ahluwalia** for all purposes. 0040872953-2

I, AASHA wife of, ANAND S Presently residing in, Awantipora AF Stn, Dist -Pulwama, State -Jammu and Kashmir -192301, have changed my name from **AASHA to ASHA G**, vide Affidavit, date-18/08/2026 0040873080-9

I, Gunjan/Gunjan Bisht W/o Deepak Singh R/o-7/28, 2/1, S1, Krishna Apartment, Rajendra Nagar, Ghaziabad have changed my name to **Gunjan Gupta**. 0071055130-1

I, Manisha Sharma, W/O-Rajeev kumar, R/O-B-1024, Shastri Nagar, Delhi-110052, have change my name **Manisha to Manisha Sharma**, for all future purposes 0040873099-9

I, Kartikey Gupta, S/o Sh. Dharmender Gupta R/o RZ-59-C, Gali No.6, Tughlakabad Extension, Kalkaji, P.O. Kalkaji, District South Delhi, New Delhi-110019 declare that my name has been wrongly written as **Sunny Gupta** in my HDFC Bank A/c No.50100196033482. My correct name is **Kartikey Gupta** as mentioned in all my documents. 0071055228-1

I, PRADEEP TANWAR, S/O ROSHAN LAL, ADDRESS : C.D 70, FIRST FLOOR, MALIBU TOWN, SOHNA ROAD, SECTOR-47, GURGAON, HARYANA-122018 have changed my name to **PARDEEP KUMAR** 0040873080-2

I, AYODHYA PRASAD SAH S/o KHOPARI SAH R/O FLAT NO-148, SECOND FLOOR, BLOCK-B, POKCKET-3, BINDA PUR DWARKA, P.O: D.K MOHAN GARDEN, DELHI, 110059 have changed the name of my minor Son from **KANISHK to KANISHK RAJ** for all purposes. 0071055120-1

I, Anil S/o Jagdish R/o, 68-D, Ist-Floor, DDA Janta-Flats, Pandav Nagar, Patel Nagar, Delhi-110008, have changed my name to **Anil Bhatt**. 0040873099-2

I, VISHNU KUMAR S/o Mohan Kumar Kayat, 28 No. Dhobi Ghat, Mahavat Khan Road, Darya Ganj, Delhi-02 have changed my name to **VISHNU KUMAR KAYAT**. 0071055167-1

I, Sarmad Raza S/O: Md. Hasnain, Village-Arjibigha, Post-Nagwan Pathra, Thana Imamganj, Distt.-Gaya, Bihar-824210, have changed my name to **Sarmadar Raza** for future Purposes. 0071055183-1

I, VIKAS GOEL S/O K K GOEL R/o, TP-64, Pitam-Pura, North-West Delhi, Delhi-110088, have changed my -minor daughter's name **KRITI GOEL to KRITIKA GOYAL**. Aged-16 years. 0040873075-4

I, Srishti D/O Hari Lal R/O 8-C PKT-E GTB Enclave Delhi-110093, have changed my name to **Srishti Prasad vide -Affidavit**, dated 10/08/2026. 0050295631-1

I, Mohd Saquib alias Mohd Saquib Tariq alias Saquib S/o Mohd Yusuf R/O C-102, Flat No T-2 T/F, DDA Colony, New Zafabad, Shahdara, PO: Shahdara, Dist: North East Delhi-110032, have changed my name to **Mohd Saquib Tariq** 0071055133-1

I, Rohit Ambawata, S/o-Mahipal, R/o.100, Ladred Mohalla, Jonapur, South-Delhi, Delhi-110047, have changed my minor son's name from **Shivaay alias Shivay Ambawata** alias **Anant Krishna-Ambawata**, aged 08 years to **Anant Krishna Ambawata**, for all future purposes. 0040873075-9

I, HOOMERA, W/O MOHD YASIN, R/O 10103/2, RANI JHANSI ROAD, NAWAB GANJ, AZAD MARKET DELHI-110006, have changed my name to **HUMERA YASIN** for all future Purposes. 0040873080-4

I, Amit s/o Mahender Singh r/o H.No.-50, Old Chopal, Pana Kalyan, Tikri Kalan, Delhi-110041 have changed my name as **AMIT DRALL** permanently. **AMIT DRALL** and **AMIT** both are same and one person. 0040872956-1

I, VISHAKHA W/O HARSH GOEL R/O-74, PLOT no C-193, BLOCK-C, DEEP VIHAR, PANSALI, DELHI-110042, have changed my name to **VISHAKHA GOEL** 0040873099-4

I, hitherto known as **B-S-ASWAL**, Son of, Mr. Sher-Singh Aswal, R/O K-85/F, Near Ramu-Kachori Wala, Laxmi Nagar, Laxmi Nagar, PO Laxmi Nagar, Distt. East-Delhi, Delhi-110092, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as **VIRENDER SINGH ASWAL** 0040873075-8

I, MUBASHIRA, D/O MOHD YASIN, R/O 10103/2, RANI JHANSI ROAD, NAWAB GANJ, AZAD MARKET DELHI-110006, have changed my name to, **MUBASHIRA YASIN** for all future Purposes. 0040873080-3

I, SACHIN KUMAR S/o VIJAY BHADUR SINGH R/o C/5-24 SECOND FLOOR, VASANT KUNJ, PO: VASANT KUMJ, DIST: SOUTHWEST DELHI, DELHI-110070 have changed the name of my minor Daughter from **GUDDIA to ANANYA** for all purposes. 0071055172-1

I, SANTOSH KUMAR SINGH alias S K CHANDEL S/o Bahadur Singh, Aged About 56 Years, R/O B-22, DDA Flats, Kalkaji, South Delhi, Delhi-110019, have changed my name to **SANTOSH KUMAR SINGH** for all purposes. 0071055202-1

I Chandni D/O Darshan Kalra R/O A-97-A-Block, Ganesh Nagar, Tilak Nagar, New Delhi-110018 Have Changed my Name to **Chandni Kalra**. 0040873075-6

I, JAI PARKASH, S/O MOHAN LAL R/O HNO. B-5 2ND-FLOOR BLOCK-B PRASHANT VIHAR SECTOR-14 ROHINI DELHI-110085. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO **JAI PRAKASH**. 0040873093-1

I, Savitri Devi, W/o Babu Lal R/o 16/407 H block Bapa Nagar Hardhyan Singh Road Karol Bagh have changed my name from **Savitri Devi to Savitri** for all future purposes. Henceforth, I shall be known and addressed as **Savitri**. 0071055138-1

I Ajeet Kumar Yadav R/o Qtr No. 514, Block J1, Type 3, CPWD Qtr, Dev Nagar, Karol Bagh, Delhi-110005 have changed my minor son's name from **Abhiraj Yadav** to **Saksham Yadav** for all future purposes. 0040873016-1

I, MAMTA W/O-AMIT RANA, R/O-73, NANGLI POONA, DELHI-110036, have changed my name to **MAMTA RANA** 0040873099-7

I, Sunjay Kumar, s/o Chander Prakash, r/o G-21/357-358, sector-7 Rohini Delhi-110085, have changed my name to **SUNJAY SHARMA** for all future purposes. 0040873075-11

I, MOHAMMAD KAIF ADIL, S/O MOHD ADIL AYYUB, R/o S-8/8, Flat-No.303, Block-S, Jamia Nagar Ext., New Friends Colony, Delhi-110025, have change my name to **MOHD KAIF ADIL**. 0040873080-6

I, VINEET BAGARIA, S/O-SAJAN KUMAR BAGARIA, R/O-82, POKCKET-4A, SPRING VALLEY, SECTOR-23, ROHINI, DELHI-110085, have changed my name to **VINEET KUMAR BAGARIA** 0040873099-6

I, Mohamad Irfan S/o Mohammad Akabar R/o Kanoongoyan, Charchhawal Rural, Muzaffarnagar have changed my name to **Mohammad Irfan**. 0071055217-1

I, Neha verma, W/O Nitin-Sohal, Residing at, Qtr no.4D, WHA-Street, Hospital-Sector, Bhilai, Dist. Durg, CG-490009, hereby, declare, that, I have changed my name from **Neha-Verma**, (maiden name before marriage) to **Neha-Sohal**, (after marriage). Both, refer, to, the same person, before the Notary Public, Durg affidavit, Notary-No.90, dated; 28.07.2026. 0040873077-1

I, Rashmi Nagar, D/o Om Prakash Nagar, W/o Rakesh Kirar, R/o-A-13, Hari Vihar, Near-Metro Pillar-No.813, Kakrola, South-West Delhi, Delhi-110078, have changed my name to **Rashmi Kirar** after marriage, for all future purposes. 0040872949-4

I, Shamsha, S/O Maqsood, R/o H NO-491, D-Block, Gali No-13, Shri Ram Colony, Rajeev Nagar, Delhi-110094, Have Changed My Name To **SAMSHAD**. Permanently. 0040873093-3

I, Naman Bhardwaj, S/o Ajay Kumar Sharma, resident of D-1026, G1 Block, Phase-6, Aya Nagar, Arjunagar, South West Delhi, Delhi-110047, do hereby declare that my father's name recorded as "Ajay Kumar Sharma" and "Ajay Bhardwaj" in various documents belong to one and the same person and shall be treated as same individual for all legal and official purposes. vide Affidavit No. IN-DL77914348320654Y dated 18/08/2026, sworn before Notary Public, Delhi. 0071055143-1

I, Abhishek Singh S/o Krishna Pratap Singh R/o CM3-005, Supertech Capetown Sector-74, Noida (U.P.) have changed my name to **Abhisek Singh** for all future purposes. 0040872996-1

I, Shilpi Gupta, D/o Om Prakash Bansal, W/o Mr. Manoj Kumar Gupta, R/o CW-66, Malibu Towne, Sohna-Road, Gurgaon (Haryana)-122018, have changed, my name to **Shilpa Gupta**, for all future Purposes. 0040873075-1

I Raj Rani Walia, W/o Shri Ram Singh Ahluwalia, R/o T -510/A -3, Mandir Marg, Baljeet Nagar, Patel Nagar, S.O. Central Delhi, Delhi-110008 have changed my name to **Raj Rani Ahluwalia** for all purposes. 0040872953-1

I, Kajal D/o, Anil Kumar, Residing at, D-23, First Floor, East Jyoti Nagar, Delhi-110093 have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as **Kajal Tomar**. 0040873080-8

I Madhuri W/o Amit R/o G-15 Gali no 1 Molarband Extension Badarpur South East Delhi-110044 Delhi, declare that my husband's name earlier mentioned as **Amit** should henceforth be read as **Amit Kanooja**. 0130068183-1

I, ANSHUL SUREKA, S/O BANWARI LAL SUREKA, R/O FLAT-NO.P3 304, USHAY TOWERS SECTOR-61 RASOI(42) SONIPAT HARYANA-131029. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO **ANSHUL SUREKHA**. 0040873075-5

I, SUDHIR KUMAR, S/O-ASHOK KUMAR, R/O-7, 1st-FLOOR, BLOCK D-22, DEEP VIHAR, PANSALI, DELHI-110042, have changed my name to **SUDHIR ARORA** 0040873099-8

I, MOHAMMAD YAMIN HUSSAIN S/O Ahmed Hussain, L-2-776, Flat No-1, Sangam Vihar, Delhi-62, have changed my name to **MOHAMMAD YAMIN HUSSAIN**. 0071055164-1

It is for general information that **I, RIYA D/O INDRA SAIN R/O JB-24 FLOOR, GUPTA COLONY, KHIRKI EXTN. NEAR SELECT CITY WALK, MALVIYA NAGAR, DIST SOUTH DELHI-110017** declare that name of my father has been wrongly written as **INDRA SEN** in my 12th class educational documents. The actual name of my father is **INDRA SAIN** which may be amended accordingly. 0040872954-1

I, Ashish Sehdev S/o Manoj Verma R/o, Flat-No.245, Block-B1, Karampura, New-Delhi-110015, have changed my -minor son's name **Devansh to Devansh Sehdev**, aged-8 years. 0040873099-1

It is for general information that **I, PRAVEEN KUMAR S/O BL CHHABRA R/O 233/10, Chhittipuri-B, East of Kailash, PO: East of Kailash Phase-I, Dist: South Delhi, Delhi-110065**, declare that name of mine and my father have been wrongly written as **PRAVIN KUMAR and BRIJ LAL CHHABRA** in my 10th class educational document. The actual name of mine and my father are **PRAVEEN KUMAR and B L CHHABRA** respectively which may be amended accordingly. 0040873047-1

I, Mohd Aslam S/o Mohammad Hassan Saifi R/o-2246/UHF-2 New Ranjeet Nagar, Patel-Nagar, Delhi-110008, have changed my name to **Mohd Aslam Saifi**. 0040873075-3

I, Taran Pal Singh Nijher, S/o Sh. Jatinder Pal Singh Kniggar, R/o Flat no.116, Mahagun Maestro, Plot F-21A sector 50 Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-203101, have changed my minor daughter's name from **Anaisha Nijher** to **Anaisha Sharma Nijher** for all purposes 0040873087-1

I, Varnika D/o Deepak Singh R/o-7/28, 2/1, S1, Krishna Apartment, Rajendra Nagar, Ghaziabad have changed my name to **Varnika Bisht**. 0071055132-1

I, MAMTA W/O VERENDER KUMAR CHANDOLIA born on (13/12/1984) residing at 74/5548 REGAR PURA KAROL BAGH NEW DELHI -5, have changed my name to **MAMTA RAJAN** vide affidavit dated 12/08/206 notary Regn No.1468. 0050295634-1

I, Anju, W/o Shri Nikhil Dev, R/O-H.No.E-106, Princess-Park, (BPTP), Sector-86, Faridabad-121004, Haryana, have changed my name from **Anju Rani to Anju**, for all future purposes. 0040872969-1

I, VIMUSH DEVI W/O JITENDER KUMAR R/O 246, GROUND FLOOR, GALIB APARTMENT, PITAMPURA, DELHI-110034 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO **VIMLESH KUMARI** FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0071055124-1

I, KAVITA, D/o Sanjeev Vig, R/o D-120, First-Floor, Sector-11, Escorts-Mujesar, Faridabad, Haryana-121006, have changed my name to **KAVITA VIG** for all purposes. 0040873099-3

I, PUSHPA W/o Vishnu Kumar Kayat, 28 No. Dhobi Ghat, Mahavat Khan Road, Darya Ganj, Delhi-02 have changed my name to **PUSHPA KAYAT**. 0071055171-1

LOST & FOUND

I, Jaya Awana W/o Bhabhuti Singh Awana R/O House No. 1 Jhundpura Sector-11 Noida, G.B Nagar, I have lost My Original Allotment Letter Issued By GNIDA of Plot No. 124 Block-K Vill/ Sector-khanpur Allotment No. Kas01761 0071055222-1

I, Preeti Sharma, W/o Krishan Sharma, R/O E-27/53, JJ Colony, Indra Camp, Part-I, I.P. Extension, Delhi-110092, have lost the original documents pertaining to Property No. US-160, First Floor, Khasra No. 271, situated at the Abadi of Uttari School Block, Mandawali, Delhi. The lost documents include General Power of Attorney (GPA), Agreement to Sell, Receipt, Will, Affidavit, Possession Letter. The above documents were executed by **Rekha Sharma W/o Prince Sharma**. Finder contact mobile 8287303227. 0040872952-1

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known to the General Public that my Clients Mrs. Rajni Saini wife late Om Prakash Saini, resident of House No. 148-A, Hari Nagar, Ashram, Delhi-14 have severed all her relations with her son Tarun Saini presently residing at House No. 148-A, Hari Nagar, Ashram, Delhi-14 because of his misbehavior has been disinherited/debarred from all my movable and immovable properties. Any body dealing with the above persons shall do so at his/her own risk and responsibility.

HIMANSHU MATTA ADVOCATE (Enrl. No. D/4774/2019)

PUBLIC NOTICE

My client Mr. Anil Budhiraja, S/o Mr. Kesar Das Budhiraja R/O B-74 Sector-92, Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201305 have ceased relations with his son Mr. Siddharth Budhiraja and daughter in law Ms. Aastha Khaneja due to their misconduct. My client has also disowned them from immovable and movable property. Sd/-

Rita Satija (Advocate)
Ch. No. 817, Lawyers Block,
Saket Court Complex,
New Delhi-110017

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known to general public at large, under instructions from and on behalf of my clients **Sh. Kanwar Sain Goel S/o Late Sh. B.L. Goel & Smt. Saroj Goel W/o Sh. Kanwar Sain Goel** both R/o B-1/217, 1st Floor, Jankpuri, Delhi, hereby declare that my son **Pravay Goel** and his wife **Smt. Aditi** from all movable and immovable properties and severe all relation with him. My clients have no responsibility of the acts, deeds and things, if and person will make any dealing with him, he/she himself/ herself be responsible. Sd/-

Anil Kumar Garg Advocate
Ch. No. 58, Western Wing,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi-110054

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known to all, **Shiv Om Mittal S/o Channei Lal Mittal R/o KG-1/183, Vikas Puri, near UJ Nursing Home, New Delhi-110018**. Have applied for certified copies in DDA. The original documents i.e. Allotment/Demand Letter, DDA Possession Letter NOC for Water & Electricity Connection, and Site Possession Slip, Bank Chalan Etc. Of MIG Flat No.29 A, on Ground floor, in Block-F-G-8 area Rajouri Garden, Maya Puri, New Delhi-110054. Vide DDA File No. F-566 (197777/HBM1) issued by the DDA in the name of original Allottee **Shri P. Gupta On Prakash Gupta**, has been lost/misplaced. An FIR LR No. 546059/2026 dated 17/08/2026 to this effect has been lodged in P.S. Crime Branch, Delhi. Any person(s) claiming any right/interest, having my objection or found in possession of original documents, may write /contact with above named person at Address/Phone: 9818972184 within 15days from the date of publication of this notice. The person claiming any right/interest, objection with respect to this property, can personally inform or write to Deputy Director (Housing) MIGS, DDA, Vikas Sadan, New Delhi-110023.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the general public that my client **Sh. Kailash S/o Sh. Siva Ram, R/o. 2-11/51 Gf, Gali No-10, Jangli Vihar, Harli Vihar, Hapur, Distt. South Delhi-110043**, has severed all his relations with his son, namely **Sh. Manoj**, and his daughter-in-law, **Smt. Deepa**, and has disowned and declared them from all his movable and immovable properties on account of their acts of disobedience and misconduct. Accordingly, my client and his family shall not be responsible or liable for any act, omission, transaction, liability or consequence arising out of or in connection with the aforesaid persons. Anyone dealing with them shall do so at his own risk and cost. **BUOH ANKUR (ADVOCATE)** Chamber No. 503, Dwarka Court



UJJV LIMITED
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U040101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujjvn.com

TENDER INVITING NOTICE Date: 18/08/2026
Office of the Executive Engineer PCM Dhalipur, Dehradun invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of the tender is given below:
Tender No : 22/EE/PCM/Dhalipur/2026-27
Name of work : Cutting Down and disposal of 81 Nos trees located on the land of Asan Colony Dhalipur out of which 1 No tree is located in Bhimawala.
Minimum Bidding Amount: Rs. 5,60,000.00 (including GST)
Date & Time of availability of bid document on website : 18.08.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.
Last Date & Time for submission of tender: 09.09.2026 up to 13:00 Hrs
For fuller and further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "https

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Parveen Berry, R/o: 4/12, Ashok Nagar, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CC NI Act-28/2021, U/s: 138 NI ACT, PS: Patel Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Parveen Berry**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Parveen Berry**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Parveen Berry**, of **CC NI Act-28/2021, U/s: 138 NI ACT, PS: Patel Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **26.09.2026**.

By Order
Gaurav Singhal
Judicial Magistrate First Class
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.PC.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Om Prakash, S/o: Keshu Ram, R/o: H.No-38, Village Meghsar, Post Kolasar, D-Bikaner, Rajasthan** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CC No.: 12329/2017, U/s: 138 NI ACT, P.S. Karol Bagh, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Om Prakash** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Om Prakash** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Om Prakash of P.S. Karol Bagh, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **19.09.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Pranjal Gangwar
JMFC (NI Act)-03, Central Distt.,
Room No. 202, 2nd Floor, Building Annex.-ii
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/11555/CD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC/84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Dev @ Debu @ Ganja S/o Lt. Parkash, R/o D-3/172, Sec-20, Rohini, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 65/2020 U/S 457/380/411/34 IPC, PS Vijay Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Dev @ Debu @ Ganja** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Dev @ Debu @ Ganja** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Dev @ Debu @ Ganja of FIR No. 65/2020 U/S 457/380/411/34 IPC, PS Vijay Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **30.09.2026 at 10:00 am**.

By Order,
Ms. Shagun
Judicial Magistrate First Class
North-West District, Court No. 109, 1st Floor
DP/10984/RD/2026(Court Matter)

Rohini Court, Delhi

राजकीय केंद्रीय कर्मशाला, चण्डीगढ़ परिवहन विभाग, हरियाणा, निविदा आमन्त्रण।

राजकीय केन्द्रीय कर्मशाला, चण्डीगढ़ में वाहनों के टायरों (Bridgestone, MRF, Continental, Apollo, J.K., Good Year, Michelin Company) की अगले 06 माह तक के लिए खरीद की जाती है। इच्छुक सप्लायर नई निविदायें 27.08.2026 को शायं 4:00 बजे तक सील बंद कुटेशन डाक द्वारा बरिह यात्रिक अभियंता, राजकीय केन्द्रीय कर्मशाला, हरियाणा, प्लॉट नं० 20-21, औद्योगिक क्षेत्र, फेस II चण्डीगढ़ के नाम भेज सकते हैं। नए टायरों की निविदा स्वीकृत होने पर छः माह तक कीटेशन में दिए गए रेटों पर सप्लाय करनी होगी किसी भी प्रकार के रेटों में बढ़ोतरी मान्य नहीं होगी। टायरों की सूचि व अन्य शर्तों के लिये राजकीय केन्द्रीय कर्मशाला, चण्डीगढ़ में सम्पर्क कर सकते हैं यह सूचि परिवहन विभाग, हरियाणा की Website <https://harrtrans.gov.in> पर भी उपलब्ध होगी। अधिक जानकारी के लिए मोबाईल नं० 0172-4650299 पर सम्पर्क करें।

हस्ता/-
वरिह यात्रिक अभियंता,
राजकीय केन्द्रीय कर्मशाला,
हरियाणा-चण्डीगढ़

No. 48346/HRV

PUBLIC NOTICE
Mahila Samarth Sansthan Award Scheme 2026-27

The Women & Child Development Department, Haryana is introducing the "Mahila Samarth Sansthan Award Scheme" for the financial year 2026-27

The objective of the scheme is to identify, recognize and encourage institutions providing a safe, respectful, equal and supportive working environment for women employees in Haryana. Under the scheme applications are invited from all Government/Semi-Government/Non-Government offices/institutions/Government Universities, Private Universities, Deemed Universities and Central Universities. Interested institutions are required to submit their application online through department website www.wcdhry.gov.in under Mahila Samarth Sansthan Award.

Last date for submission of applications: 20 September 2026

Detailed guidelines, eligibility criteria, prescribed parameters and the application process are available on the Department's website www.wcdhry.gov.in.

Sd/-
Deputy Commissioner
Panchkula

No. 48348/HR

INVITING REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (R.F.P.) WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT GOVERNMENT OF JHARKHAND

NIT No. : WRD/JH/CE/DMPH/RFP/17/2026 National Competitive Bidding	
1. Name of the Work	Request for Proposal for Conducting Studies and Preparation of Detailed Investigation Reports on Comprehensive Dam Safety Evaluation/ Structural Health Assessment for Dam Rehabilitation/ Preparation of Emergency Action Plan, Operation and Maintenance Manual etc. of Katri Dam under Chief Engineer, WRD, Ranchi, Water Resources Department, Govt. of Jharkhand
2. Mode of Submission of Bids	Online through www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in
3. Tender fee (In INR)	Rs.10,000.00 (Ten thousand only) - (Non-refundable)
4. Bid Security (In INR)	Rs.1,00,000/- (One Lakh only)
5. Time of completion	150 days from the date of agreement
6. Date of availability of Bidding Document on Website	20/08/2026;16:00 HRS
7. Last Date and time of submission of pre-bid queries	31/08/2026;11:00 HRS
8. Date of Pre Bid Meeting	01/09/2026; 11:30HRS Chief Engineer, Design Master Planning And Hydrology, Room No. 203, Second Floor, Jal Bhawan, Doranda, Ranchi, Jharkhand-834002
9. Last Date of Submission of online Bids	10/09/2026;15:30HRS
10. Date & time of opening of Technical Bid	11/09/2026;16:30HRS Chief Engineer, Design Master Planning And Hydrology, Room No. 203, Second Floor, Jal Bhawan, Doranda, Ranchi, Jharkhand-834002 <i>Email: cedesign-wrd-jhr@nic.in</i>
11. Name of address of E - procurement officer	
12. Helpline no.	9162471847, 09787107524, 09599321224, 09304037930, 09110975717

Note:-Please see details on www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in

PR 387790 Water Resource(26-27)#D
Chief Engineer
Design, Master Planning & Hydrology,
Water Resources Department,
Government of Jharkhand

NORTHERN RAILWAY
(E-Auction Notice)

The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/G, Northern Railway, Delhi Division, New Delhi invites e-Auction through IREPS (<https://ireps.gov.in/>) for allotment of Misc contract of NFR at New Delhi railway station:

E-Catalogue No.	Type of Asset	Station	Date & Time for e-auction
Advst-Sept- 01-26	Waiting Area (AC)	New Delhi, First Floor (Ajmeri Gate Side)	Start: 02.09.2026 at 11:00 hrs.

Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen : <https://ireps.gov.in/> (E-Auction-Leasing)

No.: 7PUB/E-Auction/NIT-2026 Dated: 18.08.2026 2861/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA CORRIGENDUM

Sl.	NAME OF BOARD CORP./AUTH	OLD REFERENCE/NET NO.	NATURE OF CORRIGENDUM	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	MODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	THE NORTHEN CO OF WORK PROVIDERS UNION LTD. ROHTAK	2026_HRY_CD942_1	DATE EXTENDED UPTO 24.08.2026 AT 10:00 PM OPENING ON 25.08.2026 AT 11:30 AM	vrandata@gmail.com	098441186 vrandata@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 48312/HRV

HIMACHAL PRADESH PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT
INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

The Executive Engineer HP.PWD., Division Naudaun District Hamirpur H.P on behalf of Governor of H.P. invites the Percentage rate bids, in electronic tendering system from the eligible class for the works as detailed below on the table below:-

Sr. No.	Name of Work:	Estimated cost (Rs.)	Starting Date for downloading Bid	EMD (Rs.)	Deadline for Submission of Bid
1	Construction of Primary Health Centre Level-II Building at Kansai Tehsil Naudaun District Hamirpur (HP) (SH- C/O Building Portion i/c water supply and sanitary installation, septic tank, Rain water Harvesting Tank, & Site Development etc.) Time Limit:- One Month Cost of tender Form: 350/-	1,30,41,639/-	21-08-2026 from 10:30 AM)	2,60,900/-	28-08-2026 upto 10:30 AM

The bidders are advised to note other details of tenders from the department website.

HIM SUCHANA AVAM JAN SAMPARK

Executive Engineer, Naudaun Division, HP PWD, Naudaun. Pin Code 177033
Telephone No. 01972-298570 | e-mail: ee-pwdnda-hp@hp.gov.in
On behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh.

No. 2711/HP

KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD
(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
No.2, 2/1 & 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar, Bengaluru - 560009. Phone No. 080-22265383 website: www.kiadb.in

No.IADB/ENGG/ETND-DPR-02/603/2026-27 Date:18-08-2026

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER
(Through GOK KPPP Portal Only)

KIADB invites tender from reputed consultants/firms under two cover bid system having an office at Bengaluru with vast experience and proven record of similar nature of work for project mentioned below:-

Name of the work: Providing Consultancy Services for Preparation of Detailed Project Report (DPR) for the formation of new industrial areas including Economic Analysis, Surveying, Layout Plan Design, Preparation of Cost Estimates, Cost Structure etc., for the proposed Mulwada 4th & 5th Phase Industrial Area, Belagavi District. (Extent 487Acres 39 Guntas).

● Last Date for submission of bids is **07-09-2026 upto 4:00 pm**.

Applicants May download bidding documents from the Karnataka Public Procurement portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>

Sd/- Chief Engineer-2 KIADB
DIPR/CP/2222/CC/2026-27

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER BARIPADA IRRIGATION CIRCLE AT/PO:-TAKATPUR, BARIPADA, DIST:-MAYURBHANJ Mail Id. sebhcbp@gmail.com

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA "e" PROCUREMENT NOTICE
Notice No. ACEBIC/MBJ-01/2026-27

Sl. No.	Name of work	Bid identification No.	Estimated Cost	Bid Security/ E.M.D
1	Improvement to canal service road of Kalo main distributary from RD 16.00 km to 22.00 km of Kalo Irrigation project	1/26-27 of ACEBIC	2,49,69,076.00	2,49,700.00
2	Construction of Escape, D/S retaining wall with VRB at RD 7345m of Bisol Distributary near CR with resectioning of U/S and D/S of canal of Sumel Irrigation Project under NKSUSU Scheme for the year 2025-26.	2/26 - 27 of ACEBIC	1,61,09,430.00	1,61,100.00
3	Construction of CR cum VRB at RD 930m of Bisol Distributary and VRB at RD 264m of Kapitpada Distributary with re-sectioning of canal of Sumel Irrigation Project	3/26 - 27 of ACEBIC	1,56,20,349.00	1,56,300.00

General instructions for the work

1. Period of Completion	- 12 (Twelve) calendar Months
2. Class of Contractor	- "A" Class & "B" Class
3. Date & Time of availability of bid document in the portal	- 24.08.2026 at 10:00 AM
4. Last date/time for receipt of bid in the portal	- 07.09.2026 up to 5:00 PM
5. Date of opening of bid	- 08.09.2026 at 11:00 A.M.
6. Name & Address of the O.I.T	- Additional Chief Engineer, Baripada Irrigation Circle, AT/PO- Takatpur, Baripada, Dist-Mayurbhanj As Per Annexure

Further details can be seen from the e-Procurement Portal "<https://tendersodisha.gov.in/>".
OIPR-32001/32162/1/26-27/0001

Sd/-
Additional Chief Engineer, Baripada Irrigation Circle, Baripada

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER BARIPADA IRRIGATION CIRCLE AT/PO:-TAKATPUR, BARIPADA, DIST:-MAYURBHANJ Mail Id. sebhcbp@gmail.com

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA "e" PROCUREMENT NOTICE
Notice No. ACEBIC/MBJ-01/2026-27

Sl. No.	Name of work	Bid identification No.	Estimated Cost	Bid Security/ E.M.D
1	Improvement to canal service road of Kalo main distributary from RD 16.00 km to 22.00 km of Kalo Irrigation project	1/26-27 of ACEBIC	2,49,69,076.00	2,49,700.00
2	Construction of Escape, D/S retaining wall with VRB at RD 7345m of Bisol Distributary near CR with resectioning of U/S and D/S of canal of Sumel Irrigation Project under NKSUSU Scheme for the year 2025-26.	2/26 - 27 of ACEBIC	1,61,09,430.00	1,61,100.00
3	Construction of CR cum VRB at RD 930m of Bisol Distributary and VRB at RD 264m of Kapitpada Distributary with re-sectioning of canal of Sumel Irrigation Project	3/26 - 27 of ACEBIC	1,56,20,349.00	1,56,300.00

General instructions for the work

1. Period of Completion	- 12 (Twelve) calendar Months
2. Class of Contractor	- "A" Class & "B" Class
3. Date & Time of availability of bid document in the portal	- 24.08.2026 at 10:00 AM
4. Last date/time for receipt of bid in the portal	- 07.09.2026 up to 5:00 PM
5. Date of opening of bid	- 08.09.2026 at 11:00 A.M.
6. Name & Address of the O.I.T	- Additional Chief Engineer, Baripada Irrigation Circle, AT/PO- Takatpur, Baripada, Dist-Mayurbhanj As Per Annexure

Further details can be seen from the e-Procurement Portal "<https://tendersodisha.gov.in/>".
OIPR-32001/32162/1/26-27/0001

Sd/-
Additional Chief Engineer, Baripada Irrigation Circle, Baripada

UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR OFFICE THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD (R&B) DIVISION GANDHI NAGAR JAMMU

SHORT NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Short e-NIT No. DGN/60 of 2026-27 Dated 17-08-2026

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir e-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for each of the following works :-

S. No	Name of Work	Name of Division	Advertised cost (Rs. In lakh.)	Cost of Tender document (in Rs.)	Earnest Money (in Rs.)	Time Allowed for completion	Time and date of opening of tender	Class of Contractor
1	Construction of Canteen at Govt. Degree College Kunjwani, Jammu	PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar	14.41	600	28820 (2% of the Advertised Cost)	02 Months	(1200 Hrs) on or after 29-08-2026	"A", "B" "C" & "D" Class
2	Development of Playground at Govt. Degree College Kunjwani, Jammu	PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar	9.97	600	19940 (2% of the Advertised Cost)	02 Months	(1200 Hrs) on or after 29-08-2026	"A", "B" "C" & "D" Class

Position of AAA :- Accorded by Principal Govt. Degree College Kunjwani/Sainik Colony Jammu vide order No. 28 of 2026 dated 07-08-2026 amounting to 15.00 Lacs for item No. 1 and order No. 27 of 2026 dated 07-08-2026 amounting to 10.00 Lacs for item No. 2.
Project Authority :- Principal Govt. Degree College Kunjwani/Sainik Colony Jammu.

The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen/downloaded from the departmental website <http://jtenders.gov.jans> per below schedule:

1. Date of Issue of Tender Notice	17-08-2026
2. Period of downloading of bidding documents	From 17-08-2026 to 27-08-2026, 1800 Hrs
3. Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	21-08-2026 at 1300 Hrs. in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar Jammu
4. Bid submission Start Date	17-08-2026
5. Bid Submission End Date	27-08-2026 upto 1800 Hrs
6. Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	29-08-2026 on or after 1200 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar Jammu
7. Date & time of opening of Financial Bids (Online)	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

DIP NO: DIP/J-4323/26 DATE: 18.08.2026

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

Open Tender Notice No.- SrDEE-TRD-BSB-2026-27-T21 Date :- 14.08.2026, Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/ TRD, North Eastern Railway, Varanasi for and on behalf of the President of India invites sealed "OPEN" E-Tender for the following work : Name of work : 25 KV Electrification work in connection with Provision of Ramp for FOB at various station of under jurisdiction of Sr. DEN-II/BSB (CI. DWDI, DHE, GOGP, MHC, YFP (total -06 station), BSB Division of N.E. Railway., Tender reference no : SrDEE-TRD-BSB- 2026-27-T21. Approx. Cost (in Rs.) :- ₹ 9219227.89, Earnest money (in Rs.) :- ₹ 184400/-, Cost of tender documents (in Rs.) :- Nil, E-Tender closing date and Time : 07.09.2026 up to 14:45 Hrs., Completion period : 9 Months. ● Open E-Tender Online will be submitted upto 14:45 Hrs. on date : 07.09.2026 ● For full details and submission of bid kindly visit the Official website of Indian railways i.e. www.ireps.gov.in
Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/ CPRO/EL-148 TRD/Varanasi
"Never travel on roof and foot boards"

झारखण्ड सरकार, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, कम्पाईण्ड बिल्डिंग, प्रथम तल्ला, एल०सी० रोड, धनबाद

ई- निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना
दिनांक :- 08.08.2026

ई-निविदा संख्या :- 08/RWD/DHANBAD/26-27

कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमण्डल, धनबाद द्वारा निम्न विवरण के अनुसार e-procurement पद्धति से निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।

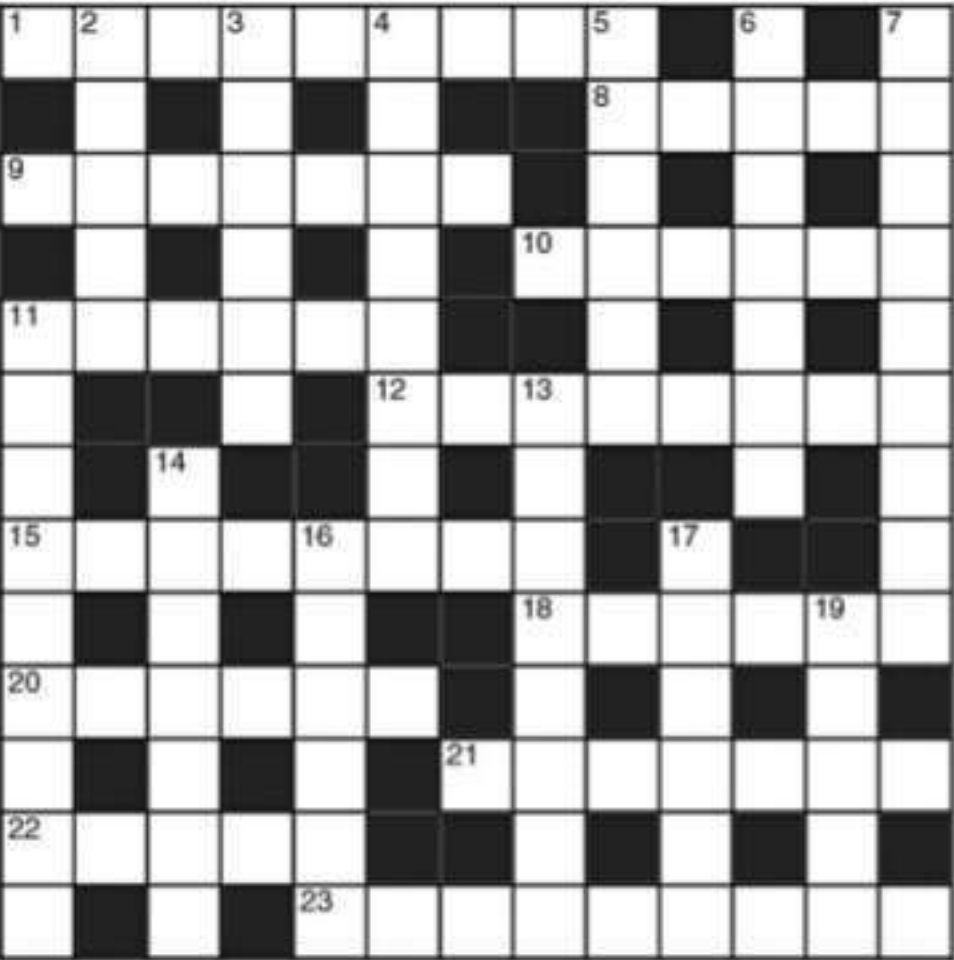
क्र० सं०	आईई-टी फ़िकेशन संख्या/पैकेज संख्या	प्रखण्ड	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (लाख में)		कार्य सामापि की अवधि	टेण्डर कॉल संख्या
				अंक में	अक्षर में		
1	DMFT 22/26-27	गोविन्दपुर	गूलनडीह से कबलाडीह तक पथ निर्माण	162.652	एक करोड़ बासठ लाख पैंसठ हजार दो सौ	12 माह	प्रथम
2	DMFT 23/26-27	गोविन्दपुर	आण्डोआँठ रोड से आदिवासी टोला गोपीनाथडीह तक पथ निर्माण	172.48	एक करोड़ बहतर लाख अड़सालिह हजार	12 माह	प्रथम
3	DMFT 24/26-27	कलियासोल	आननसिया से जेतोटंड तक पी०सी०पी० पथ निर्माण	161.869	एक करोड़ एकसठ लाख छियासिह हजार नौ सौ	12 माह	प्रथम
4	DMFT 25/26-27	गोविन्दपुर	सिंह टोला बजरंगबली मंदिर मुख्य पथ से श्री सैलेश के घर होते हुए नंदलाल गोप के घर तक पथ	164.187	एक करोड़ बीसठ लाख अठारह हजार सात सौ	12 माह	प्रथम
5	DMFT 26/26-27	गोविन्दपुर	पी०एम०जीएस०आई० पानी टीकी से सिडुआटींड तक पथ निर्माण	185.194	एक करोड़ पचासी लाख उनीस हजार चार सौ	12 माह	प्रथम
6	DMFT 27/26-27	टुण्डी	टुण्डी ब्लॉक रोड से परसाटींड तक पथ निर्माण	87.162	सत्तासी लाख बीसठ लाख हजार दो सौ	06 माह	प्रथम
7	DMFT 28/26-27	धनबाद	बगुला बस्ती के बेंगनाथ हाजार के घर से जयंत जाकुर के घर होते हुए एनी शंकर के घर तक पी०सी०पी० पथ निर्माण	78.368	अठहतर लाख छत्तीस हजार आठ सौ	06 माह	प्रथम
8	DMFT 29/26-27	एयारकुण्ड	गतकखाली रेलवे कांठक तक पी०सी०पी० पथ निर्माण	99.756	निनानवे लाख पचहतर हजार आठ सौ	06 माह	प्रथम
9	DMFT 30/26-27	बाघमारा	एल०एच० 32 से छाताटींड नौक भाया लालबाडी दुर्गा मंदिर तक पी०सी०पी० पथ निर्माण	81.003	एकसी लाख तीन सौ	06 माह	प्रथम
10	DMFT 31/26-27	तोपचांची	आण्डोआँठ रोड से जामुनटींड तक पथ मुदुडीकरण कार्य एवं जामुनटींड में कलमट का निर्माण	162.087	एक करोड़ बासठ लाख आठ हजार सात सौ	12 माह	प्रथम
11	DMFT 32/26-27	बाघमारा	बीआकसा उत्तर पंचायत के नारायण विहार कोलोनो के सामी खिनाबली खुलू में पथ का निर्माण	177.141	एक करोड़ सतहतर लाख चौदह हजार एक सौ	12 माह	प्रथम
12	DMFT 33/26-27	तोपचांची	मुसुसा चित्तरी टावर कोम से बकटींड बुटुबीस बोरडड तक पथ निर्माण	150.496	एक करोड़ पचास लाख उनचास हजार छह सौ	09 माह	प्रथम
13	DMFT 34/26-27	बाघमारा	बागदाहा पंचायत अन्तर्गत विन्दु बाबा से पिपरा टोला हरिहरिह होते हुए सहारा मैदान होते हुए पचल पत्थर तक पी०सी०पी० पथ निर्माण एवं गार्डवाल का निर्माण	296.439	दो करोड़ छियानवे लाख तैतालिस हजार नौ सौ	15 माह	प्रथम
14	DMFT 35/26-27	तोपचांची	कोरकोट्टा पंचायत अन्तर्गत जय भारत लख विद्यालय से देवु मन्दटाबाय के घर तक पथ का जीर्णीकरण	156.078	एक करोड़ छपन लाख सात हजार आठ सौ	12 माह	प्रथम
15	DMFT 36/26-27	गोविन्दपुर	सी०टी० रोड बिजली ऑफिस से हाजरा टोला होते हुए मुसुडीह-मुख्य पथ तक पथ का निर्माण	144.185	एक करोड़ बीचालिस लाख अठारह हजार बीस सौ	09 माह	प्रथम
16	DMFT 37/26-27	गोविन्दपुर	मुर्गाबनी पंचायत से अखना बरदोही तक पथ का निर्माण	333.255	तीन करोड़ तैतीस लाख पचीस हजार पचा सौ	15 माह	प्रथम
17	DMFT 38/26-27	गोविन्दपुर	तवाजोरी हरिहरपुर मेन रोड से बेहराडीह होते हुए डिग्री तक पथ निर्माण	210.676	दो करोड़ दस लाख सठसठ हजार छह सौ	12 माह	प्रथम
18	DMFT 39/26-27	टुण्डी	जाताखुटी पंचायत के बुन्की रोड से सागर नौड तक पथ बुलिया एवं गार्डवाल का निर्माण	150.192	एक करोड़ पचास लाख उनीस हजार दो सौ	09 माह	प्रथम
19	DMFT 40/26-27	गोविन्दपुर	बेहिया हरी मंदिर से आदिवासी टोला तक पथ निर्माण	61.118	एकसठ लाख प्यारह हजार आठ सौ	06 माह	प्रथम
20	DMFT 41/26-27	कलियासोल	उरमा से लेदाहडिया तक पी०सी०पी० पथ निर्माण	157.405	एक करोड़ सनानन लाख बातीस हजार पचा सौ	12 माह	प्रथम
21	DMFT 42/26-27	कलियासोल	आदिवासी टोला से कुलबोना भाया कुसुबेया तक पी०सी०पी० पथ निर्माण	80.513	अस्सी लाख एकानन हजार तीन सौ	06 माह	प्रथम

वेबसाईट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि— **17.08.2026**
ई-निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय— **08.09.2026** अपराह्न 5.00 बजे तक।
निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय— **10.09.2026** अपराह्न 3.30 बजे।
निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता— कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमण्डल, धनबाद, गिन— 826001
ई-निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष नं०— 0326—3554757
विरतुल ज्ञानकारी के लिए वेबसाईट jharkhandtenders.gov.in में देखा जा सकता है।
PR 387769 Rural Work Department (26-27)_D

कार्यपालक अभियंता
ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग,
कार्य प्रमण्डल, धनबाद

उद्यान निदेशालय, झारखण्ड, राँची।
कुशि मवन, कॉक रोड,

CROSSWORD



- ACROSS
- 1 Rush to get on the panel (9)
- 8 Character of those who are different (5)
- 9 Chopped sausage to relieve hunger (7)
- 10 Turn meant to amuse perhaps (6)
- 11 Specify how a token may be regarded? (6)
- 12 Press for a reduction? (8)
- 15 Acrobats in glasses (8)
- 18 They're up for approval (6)
- 20 Make a second charge for killing? (6)
- 21 Supply foodstuffs (7)
- 22 A Belgian city is the subject (5)
- 23 Italian girl in disorderly style on arising (9)
- DOWN
- 2 Almost rate as fools (5)
- 3 Is under the spell of nymphs (6)
- 4 I'd turn up in a sort of orange fabric (8)
- 5 He refuses a measure of silk (6)
- 6 He's involved with a cheat and is naturally spotted (7)
- 7 Hot lines upset Rose Smith (9)
- 11 Planned a Yule rest with no frills (9)
- 13 Sort of alibi that's been forged? (4-4)
- 14 Insinuates one politician isn't truthful (7)
- 16 Abandons having days off work (6)
- 17 An unnatural ending (6)
- 19 The ghost of Shakespeare some say (5)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6070 ACROSS: 1 Sober up, 4 Muses, 7 Rank, 8 Stickers, 10 Pedestrian, 12 Secure, 13 Signed, 15 Invocation, 18 Basement, 19 Beat, 20 Riser, 21 Editors DOWN: 1 Scrap, 2 Benedict, 3 Petard, 4 Mechanical, 5 Sees, 6 Suspend, 9 Astronomer, 11 Anti-hero, 12 Slumber, 14 Pounce, 16 Notes, 17 Uses

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

_____ is that which, when you stop believing in it, doesn't go away.

- Philip K. Dick (7)

EHVAE

ADEMLT

ERTIR

BDNOOY

ANSWER: Reality is that which, when you stop believing in it, doesn't go away. - Philip K. Dick

SOLUTIONS: Heaven, Trier, Melted, Nobody

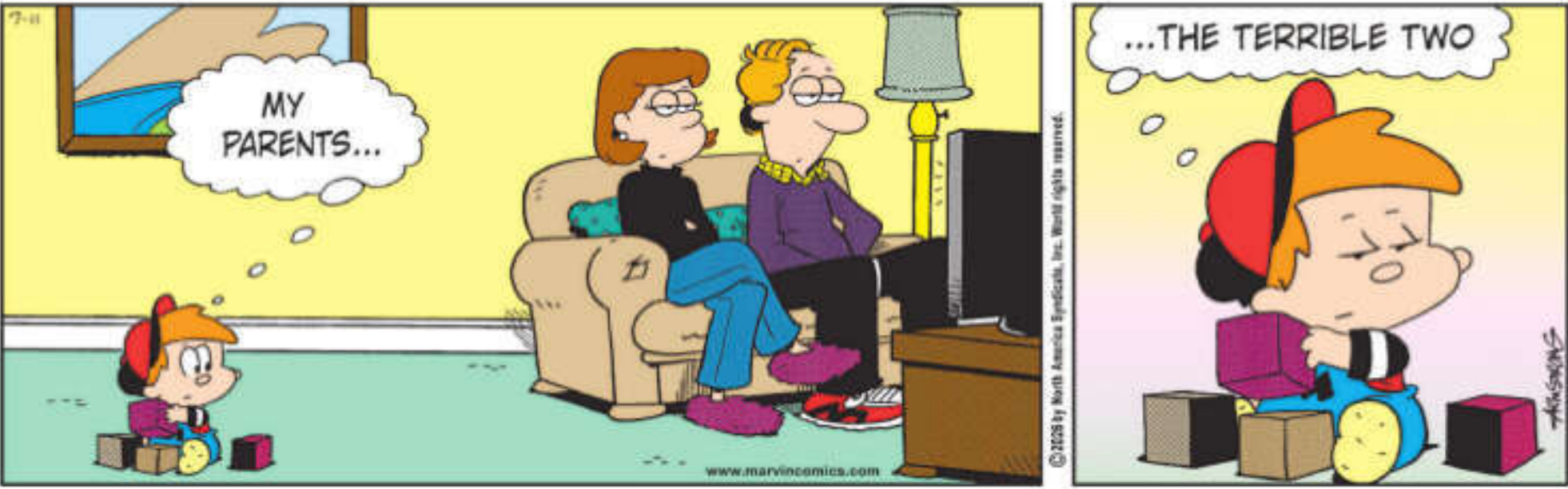
OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 2s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6415

2			6			5
7	2	4		8		
5				1		
8	2	5	1	6		7
9						1
3	5	6	9	2		8
	2				6	
3	4	5		7		
5		9				3

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6414

9	2	7	4	1	6	8	3	5
1	5	6	3	7	8	4	2	9
3	8	4	5	9	2	6	7	1
7	3	9	2	8	1	5	6	4
2	4	5	9	6	3	1	8	7
8	6	1	7	4	5	2	9	3
5	9	3	6	2	4	7	1	8
6	7	8	1	5	9	3	4	2
4	1	2	8	3	7	9	5	6

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Jasveer Bawa S/o Sushil Baba R/o A-21, 1st Floor, Block A Extn., Mohan Garden, Uttam Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No.392/2025 U/S 318(4)/336(3)/340(2)/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, PS Janakpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Jasveer Bawa** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Jasveer Bawa** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Jasveer Bawa** of **FIR No.392/2025 U/S 318(4)/336(3)/340(2)/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, PS Janakpuri, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the date of **29.09.2026**.

By Order,
Sh. Harjot Singh Aujla
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11
South-West District, Court No.05
Dwarka Court, Delhi

DP/11443/WD/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Rashi Jain @ Riya D/o Varun Jain R/o E-12, Om Vihar, Phase-5, 40 Foota Road, Navada, Dwarka, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 332/2018 U/S 419/120B, PS GTB Enclave, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Rashi Jain @ Riya** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rashi Jain @ Riya** of **FIR No. 332/2018 U/S 419/120B, PS GTB Enclave, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the date of **28.10.2026**.

By Order,
Ms. Sanghamitra
Judicial Magistrate First Class- 01
Room No. 54, Second Floor, Shahdara District
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/8840/SHD/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Mohd. Abdul Tariq S/o Tahir Khan R/o H. No.-8, Gali No.4C, Aram Park, Shastri Park, Geeta Colony, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 17436/22 U/S 379/411/34 IPC, PS Farsh Bazar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Mohd. Abdul Tariq** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Mohd. Abdul Tariq** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Mohd. Abdul Tariq** of **FIR No. 17436/22 U/S 379/411/34 IPC, PS Farsh Bazar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the date of **25.09.2026**.

By Order,
Sh. Akhil Malik
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02
Room No.38, Ground Floor, Shahdara District
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/11211/SHD/2026(Court Matter)

NORTHERN RAILWAY CORRIGENDUM

Ref: Tender Notice No. - 16/2026-2027 Dated - 27.05.2026 Sr. no. 06
(i) Tender No. - 15235293A due on 15.09.2026

1. In reference to above tender, the due date has been extended from 20.08.2026 to 15.09.2026. All other terms & conditions remain unchanged.

The corrigendum has been published on website www.ireps.gov.in.

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 2855/26

Government of Rajasthan Office of Commissioner Industries and Commerce & Corporate Social Responsibilities (CSR) Udyog Bhawan, Tilak Marg, Jaipur-302005

No.: F.1(1) UPS/IND/Haata Construction/PPP Model/2026 Date: 06.08.2026

Notice Inviting Bid Bid No. 01/2026-27

Online e-bids are invited for Selection of PPP Partner for Design Development, Construction, Financing, Operations and Management of Haat Infrastructure under PPP Model in Rajasthan. Detailed terms & conditions of bids can be viewed and downloaded from www.eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in, sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in, industries.rajjasthan.gov.in.

The last date of bid submission is 09.09.26 up to 01:00 p.m.

Sd/- Commissioner, Industries & Commerce and Chairman and Managing Director, Udhyan Protsahan Sansthan

UBIN: DSI2627SLOB00043 DIPRC/14691/2026

उत्तराखण्ड लोक सेवा आयोग हरिद्वार पिन कोड-249004

संख्या: 43/01/E-4/FOREST (DR)/2024-25 दिनांक: 18 अगस्त, 2026

विज्ञापित 'सहायक वन संरक्षक, लौगिंग अधिकारी एवं वनक्षेत्राधिकारी संयुक्त परीक्षा-2025'

एतद्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि सहायक वन संरक्षक, लौगिंग अधिकारी एवं वनक्षेत्राधिकारी संयुक्त परीक्षा-2025 के अन्तर्गत आयोजित मुख्य (लिखित) परीक्षा दिनांक: 24 नवम्बर, 2025 से 28 नवम्बर, 2025 के परीक्षा परिणाम दिनांक: 17 अगस्त, 2026 में औपबन्धिक रूप से सकल अभ्यर्थियों के अभिलेखों का सत्यापन दिनांक 07 सितम्बर, 2026 से 09 सितम्बर, 2026 तक परीक्षा भवन, उत्तराखण्ड लोक सेवा आयोग, हरिद्वार में किया जाएगा। अभ्यर्थियों के लिए विस्तृत अभिलेख सत्यापन कार्यक्रम एवं अन्य निर्देश आयोग की वेबसाइट psc.uk.gov.in पर प्रसारित किये गये हैं। अभ्यर्थी अभिलेख सत्यापन कार्यक्रम के अनुसार निर्धारित तिथि एवं समय पर अभिलेखों के सत्यापन हेतु उपस्थित होना सुनिश्चित करें।

(अशोक कुमार पाण्डेय) सचिव

Department of Water Resources, Government of Odisha

32001/707/2627 "e" Procurement Notice No. ACECD-BBSR-05/2026-27

- Name of the Works: Total 03 (Three) Nos. Drainage work.
- Estimated Cost: Rs. 99.89 lakh to Rs. 403.06 lakh
- Period of Completion: 11 (Eleven) months
- Date and time of availability of bid document in the portal: From 11.00 hours of Dt. 20.08.2026 to 18.00 hours of Dt. 03.09.2026.
- Last date/time for receipt of bids in the portal: 18.00 hours of Dt. 03.09.2026.
- Date of Opening of Technical Bid: 05.09.2026 at 11.00 hours
- Name and address of the Officer inviting Bid: Additional Chief Engineer, Drainage Circle, Unit-8, Bhubaneswar-751012. e-mail Id:- sedrainagebbsr12@gmail.com.
- The update notification will be intimated to the participated bidders to their registered e-mail & to their registered mobile number through an autogenerated text message by e-procurement system. On such intimation, individual bidder needs to log in to their ID through DSC to know the uploaded summary, i.e. details of opening of financial bid, lottery date time, venue, acceptance of bid etc.

Further details can be seen from the e-Procurement portal of Odisha Government <https://tendersodisha.gov.in>. All information, notices, addendum, corrigendum cancellation notice etc. if required, will be published in this portal.

Sd/- Additional Chief Engineer Drainage-Circle, Bhubaneswar OIPR- 32001/32409/1/26-27/0005

RAJASTHAN RAJYA VIDYUT PRASARAN NIGAM LIMITED NOTICE INVITING BIDS NO. 10 (2026-27) & NOTICE INVITING BIDS NO. 11 (2026-27)

RVPN invites competitive BIDS for following Civil works from experienced, reputed contractors registered in appropriate class with RRVPNL & A or AA class in Central/ State Government Department and their undertakings and registered in GST department. The Tender/bid shall only be submitted through online tendering system of <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in>. The interested bidders shall have to be enrolled/ registered with portal of <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> for participating in the bidding process. S. No. 01 to 09 (NIB No. 0 (2026-27) & 01 to 15 (NIB No. 11 (2026-27). UBN No. (VNP2627WSOB01235) to (VNP2627WSOB01237), (VNP2627WSOB01239) to (VNP2627WSOB01240), (VNP2627WSOB01242) to (VNP2627WSOB01244), (VNP2627WSOB01246) to (VNP2627WSOB01248), (VNP2627WSOB01264) to (VNP2627WSOB01266), (VNP2627WSOB01269) to (VNP2627WSOB01274), (VNP2627WSOB01288) to (VNP2627WSOB01291)

Superintending Engineer (Civil), Jodhpur

Raj.Samwad/C/26/10197 RRVPN/TR/760/2026

भरतपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, भरतपुर

क्रमांक :- सेवा/अ.वि.प्रा./2026-27/12174 - 87 दिनांक - 14/08/2026

ऑनलाईन निविदा सूचना सं. 44/2026-27

राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से भरतपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, में उपयुक्त श्रेणी एवं शिबिन् विभागों में ए एवं एए श्रेणी में पंजीकृत संवेदकों से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ई-प्रोक्वोरमेंट प्रक्रिया से कुल 01 कार्य हेतु ऑनलाईन निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती हैं।

उक्त कार्यो का विस्तृत विवरण, निविदा शर्तें, अनुमानित लागत राशि, निविदा बेचने, प्राप्त करने एवं खोलने की दिनांक आदि सम्पूर्ण विवरण वेबसाइट <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in>, www.urban.rajjasthan.gov.in/uitbharatpur एवं <http://sppp.raj.nic.in> portal पर देखा जा सकता है।

निविदा से संबंधित किसी भी प्रकार का संशोधन <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> एवं <http://sppp.raj.nic.in> portal का अवलोकन करें।

UBN No.: WAQ2627WLOB00115

अतिरिक्त अतिरिक्त भरतपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, भरतपुर

राज.संवाद/सी/26/10205

Office of the Executive Engineer, Watershed Development & Soil Conservation Bikaner

S.N.: 519-25 Date: 07.08.2026

NOTICE INVITING BID NIB No. WSC2627A0958

On the behalf of Governor of Rajasthan, bids for the execution of Construction of Works under MJSA Projects of estimated value INR 299.19 Lakh as mentioned below are invited from interested bidders up to 20-08-2026, 06.00 PM. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (<https://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> or <https://sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in>) of the state, and <http://www.watershed.rajjasthan.gov.in> departmental website.

Bid No.	Block	Estimated Cost, (Rs. in lakhs)	UBN No.
1	Panchoo	107.90	WSC2627WSOB01739
2	Panchoo	109.60	WSC2627WSOB01740
3	Panchoo	81.69	WSC2627WSOB01741

Sd/- Executive Engineer WDSC, Bikaner

DIPRC/14831/2026

KARNATAKA POWER CORPORATION LIMITED

CIN : U85110KA1970SGC001919

E-Tender No.: KPCL-2026-27/SE0375 Date: 18.08.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

(Short-term Two Cover System) (Through Karnataka Public Procurement Portal only) Tenders are invited from reputed companies/persons having adequate knowledge, expertise and funds mobilization capacity for the work of "Liaisoning, Coal Lifting, Road Transportation, Railway Coordination, Loading Supervision, Movement, Handling and Delivery of Domestic Coal up to 10.00 lakh MT from Naini Mines of Singareni Collieries Company Limited (SCCL), Odisha to Raichur Thermal Power Station (RTPS), Raichur & Bellary Thermal Power Station (BTPS), Bellary, Karnataka by Road Cum Rail Mode for a period of 8 months". The last date for receipt of the completed bids in KPPP is 17.00 hrs. on 02.09.2026. The tender document can be downloaded from the website <https://www.kppp.karnataka.gov.in> Further details can be had from the Office of the Chief Engineer (Mines), KPCL, No. 82, Shakti Bhavan, 3rd Floor, Race Course Road, Bengaluru-560001. Mobile: 9141607989, Telefax: 080-22203894, E-mail: ceminkepkl@karnataka.gov.in website: <https://kpcl.karnataka.gov.in> KPP (e-portal) Helpdesk of GoK: +91-8046010000; +91-8068948777, E-mail: support@eprocelpdesk.com

ROYAL STARS

- ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Although mild quarrels might arise about how to share the expense of something, don't let this rankle you. Instead, focus on socialising, the arts, sports and fun activities with kids. This is a great day to chat. Tonight: Check banking details.
- TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Tread carefully when talking to family members, spouses, partners and close friends, because things are tense today. Pull in your reins a bit. Keep things light. Tonight: Be cooperative.
- GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): There are two options available to you today. You can get caught up in squabbles with siblings, relatives, neighbours and work colleagues — or you can play hooky and have fun doing whatever you want. Tonight: Focus on your health.
- CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Romantic partners must be patient with each other. Likewise, parents must be patient with their kids. It's the perfect day to redecorate and tweak your digs. You might even entertain. Get some physical exercise. Tonight: Socialise.
- LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Today the Moon is at odds with your Sun, triggering domestic arguments and tension with people at home. Fortunately, fair Venus, will smooth your words. Dish out the sweetness. Tonight: Relax at home.
- VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Something going on behind the scenes today might make you feel disgruntled. This mood might affect how you speak to others. Throw your energy into interacting with friends, groups and organisations. You also might buy something beautiful today. Tonight: An interesting conversation.
- LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): This continues to be a great time for you to buy wardrobe items, which is not a bad idea, because you like to look your best. Avoid money squabbles today. Tonight: Maintain your possessions.
- SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Today you should avoid quarrels and power struggles with bosses, parents, teachers, VIPs and the police. Dabble in secret love affairs, or explore avenues in travel, medicine, the law and publishing. Stay out of trouble. Tonight: Define future goals.
- SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Steer clear of controversial subjects today, because they will irk you. Instead, decide to have fun with a friend or a group. Explore new ideas. It's also a passionate day. Tonight: Privacy.

- CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Avoid squabbles with a friend today. Likewise, don't get caught up fighting a member of a group. Partners and close friends might annoy you. Instead, focus on goals, your career and earning some brownie points with bosses, parents and authority figures. Tonight: Be friendly.
- AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): There's a high probability that you might have a public argument with someone today. You might be at odds with a boss, parent, teacher, VIP or the police. The upside is not favourable. Work hard and get organised. Tonight: Be modest.
- PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Don't get bogged down in arguments, which is easy to do. Focus on socialising with others and expressing your creative talents. Great choice. Tonight: Explore!

Central Coalfields Limited "A Miniratna Company" (A Subsidiary of Coal India Limited) NOTICE

"All the tenders issued by CIL and its Subsidiaries for procurement of Goods, Works and Services are available on website of Coal India Ltd. www.coalindia.in/ respective Subsidiary Company (CCL, www.centralcoalfields.in), CIL e-procurement portal <https://coalindiatenders.nic.in> and Central Public Procurement Portal <https://eprocure.gov.in>. In addition, procurement is also done through GeM portal <https://gem.gov.in/>."

Rajasthan Medical Services Corporation Ltd. D-Block, Swasthya Bhawan, C-Scheme, Jaipur - 302005 Ph. No. 0141-2223887, Fax No. 0141-2228065, E-Mail-edepmmssc-rj@nic.in

Ref. No.: F.B(1) RMSC/EPM/I-M/18/390/2025-26/691 Dated: 13/08/2026

Corrigendum / Addendum

Interested item WASTE BIN RED, BLACK & YELLOW (15 & 25 Ltr.) are invited from interested bidders up to Date : 08/09/2026 : 06:00 PM. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on Procurement portal website <https://sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in> or www.dipronline.org or <https://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> or website <http://rmsc.health.rajjasthan.gov.in>.

UBN No.: MSC2526GLOB00054

Raj.Samwad/C/26/10240 Director (P) Rajasthan Medical Services Corporation

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता जन स्वास्थ्य अभियांत्रिकी विभाग वृत्त टोक

Email: sephedontok@gmail.com

क्रमांक वृत्त टोक/निविदा/2026-27/ 3265-71 दिनांक 11.08.2026

ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या 03 से 05/2026-27

राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से निम्नलिखित निर्माण/आपूर्ति कार्य हेतु सक्षम श्रेणी में मान्यता प्राप्त पंजीकृत संवेदकों से निविदा संख्या 03-05/2026-27 हेतु दिनांक 11.08.2026 सत्र 06.00 बजे से दिनांक 21.08.2026 सत्र 11.00 बजे तक ऑनलाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। बिड से संबंधित समस्त जानकारी प्रोक्वोरमेंट पोर्टल <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> एवं <http://sppp.raj.nic.in> पर देखा जा सकता है।

NIB No. PHE2627A2125

NIT No.	UBN No.	NIT No.	UBN No.
03/2026-27	PHE2627WSRC04210	04/2026-27	PHE2627WSRC04212
05/2026-27	PHE2627WSRC04214		

हस्ता/- अधीक्षण अभियन्ता जन स्वास्थ्य अभियांत्रिकी विभाग वृत्त टोक।

DIPRC/14767/2026

OFFICE OF SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, WATER RESOURCES CIRCLE UDAIPUR

Near Akashvani, Chetak Circle, Udaipur (Rajasthan) 313001 Phone no.: 0294-2144794 | Email:- sewrcudr@gmail.com

No.- SE/Actt./Udaipur/F/2026-27/5221 Dated:- 07/08/2026

S. No.	Name of Work	Estimated Cost of Work	Bids for the following work are invited from interested bidders upto
1	Construction of Hawa Ki Anicut Village Sarupal PS Girwa District Udaipur UBN:- WRD2627WSOB00558	(Rs) 275.66 Lac	(16-08-2026 to 30-08-2026 at 6.00 PM
2	Construction of Marchi Janai Anicut Village Theor GP Theor Tehsil Badgaon District Udaipur UBN:- WRD2627WJ000561	116.52 Lac	

Other particulars of bid may be visited on the Procurement portal <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in>, www.dipr.rajjasthan.gov.in & www.water.rajjasthan.gov.in/wrd

Sd/- Superintending Engineer Water Resources Circle Udaipur

DIPRC/14806/2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY Tender Notice Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement System

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001 for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

Sr. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	07260323	One Coach Set of Air Spring Assembly	542 Set	15.09.2026
02	16260391	Vertical Damper 400 KG	2202 Nos	16.09.2026
03	07261825	Face Plate, for Buffer Plunger	6352 Nos	16.09.2026
04	08261252A	Track Feed Battery Charger	2270 Nos	21.09.2026
05	07261086	Helical Spring For Axle Box Guide Arrangement	852 Nos	13.10.2026
06	07261496	Water Tank Assembly	273 Nos	21.10.2026

Note: 1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. 2. No manual offer will be entertained.

Tender Notice No. 36/2026-2027 Dated: 18.08.2026 2854/2026

Serving Customers With A Smile

No Khel Ratna for 1st time since 2014; 17 Arjuna awardees

Express News Service
Mumbai, August 18

BACK IN December, India's hockey vice-captain Hardik Singh was recommended for the Khel Ratna. On Tuesday, when the sports ministry officially released the names of the winners after a revaluation of the selection process, the midfielder's name no longer features on the list.

In fact, for the first time since 2014 – and only the third time since the Khel Ratna was instituted in 1991-92 – no athlete will be honoured with India's highest sporting honour. Not just Hardik. His teammates Lalit Upadhyay, a veteran of three World Cups and close to 200 internationals, Mandeep Singh and Vivek Sagar Prasad – all of whom played a crucial role in India's return to the Olympic podium – would have hoped to be nominated for the Khel Ratna. A Ministry official said the final list was declared after a 'thorough study of all applications, in a manner that the integrity of the awards remained intact.' The Khel Ratna carries a cash prize of Rs 25 lakh, a medallion and a citation.

Last year, four sportspersons were named Khel Ratna recipients. Chess world champion Gukesh Dommaraju, India's men's hockey team captain Harmanpreet Singh, para-athlete Praveen Kumar and Olympic medallist Manu Bhaker.

The awards were announced based on the recommendations of a selection committee chaired by the former SC judge Justice (Retd.) Arun Kumar Mishra.

While there were no Khel Ratna winners, 17 athletes were conferred with the Arjuna Awards. Among them will be high jumper Tejaswin Shankar, sprinters Muhammed Ajmal V and Priyanka Goswami, badminton players Treasa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand, chess players Vidit Gujrathi and Divya Deshmukh, hockey players Lalremisiami and Rajkumar Pal, and shooter Akhil Sheoran.

Three coaches were selected for the Dronacharya Award in the regular category - athletics coach Parveer Singh, boxing coach Chhote Lal Yadav and shooting coach Neha Nandkumar Chavan.

GALLE TEST, DAY 4

India set 372 as Pant's 66 papers over a middle-order collapse

4 wickets fell between overs 15 and 31, before southpaw took the game away from SL

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, August 18

INDIA ARE within touching distance of taking the series lead in Galle. If weather permits, they should get the remaining six Sri Lanka wickets and head to Colombo with a 1-0 lead. The forecast looks encouraging on the final day too, with showers expected only early in the morning, and even in the worst case of a delayed start on Wednesday, India have every reason to believe they can wrap up the Test.

The task won't be easy, though. Going by the signs late on Tuesday, they will have to work hard for it. Despite 14 wickets falling on the day, the pitch hasn't worn as much as expected. There is a good degree of turn on offer, which Galle is known for, but the bounce remains on the lower side. Batsmen who get their eye in can defend off the back foot without much trouble.

That India removed short leg and silly point when the spinners operated, as early as the 21st over, once the ball had gone soft, showed the challenge they are up against. Instead, alongside a traditional slip, they kept a second slip, kneeling to make sure half-chances didn't go to waste. It was one such effort from Dhruv Jurel that gave India their fourth wicket. They would have had a fifth, that of Dhananjaya de Silva, only for Ravindra Jadeja to overstep after KL Rahul had pouched it at first slip. Instead, Sri Lanka ended Day 4 on 84 for 4. Fighting out a draw is possible, but they will have to bat out of their skins to do it.

Having set a target for the win, India knew they had to be patient and disciplined with the ball. The low bounce means batsmen have the option of disrupting the spinners with the sweep, so the pitch hasn't evolved into one where the spinners can simply land in the



Mohammed Siraj took the wicket of Nishan Fernando in the seventh over to get India off the mark. CREIMAS

There is a good degree of turn on offer, which Galle is known for, but the bounce remains on the lower side. Batsmen who get their eye in can defend off the back foot without much trouble.

right areas and let the surface do the rest. That India didn't turn to Kuldeep Yadav till the 29th over said everything about their reading of the conditions. As the slowest of their three spinners, he gives batsmen more chances to survive.

With the new ball, wickets were key, and India were right on the mark. Mohammed Siraj's surprise bouncer brought the first wicket, of Nishan Madushka, while Manav Suthar's straighter delivery trapped concussion substitute Pasindu Sooriyabandara, in for Dinesh Chandimal, first ball. Kamindu Mendis couldn't resist chasing a wide delivery off Prasidh

Krishna, Rahul taking a sharp catch at slip, before Lahiru Udara fell to Suthar. Despite that opening burst, once the ball softened, the same bite went missing, something India will need to find again on the final day.

Safe target set

When play began on Day 4, with India leading by 178 runs, the question was at what point they would feel safe from losing the Test. At Galle, teams chasing targets under 150 have succeeded every time they've tried. But for targets of 150 and above, successful chases have been rare, including Pakistan's 342 in 2022. This surface, under covers for a long period and baked under the sun over the last couple of days, hadn't deteriorated as much as expected. So India's approach followed predictable lines. With the pitch not wearing much, and rain a possibility, India knew they had to give their bowlers time to take 10 wickets, and came out looking to score quickly in the second innings.

But as had been the case through the Test, India tried to be aggressive while the ball retained its hardness, and it meant they lost wickets more

often than they would have liked. After Yashasvi Jaiswal was dismissed for nought off the third ball of the innings, KL Rahul and Devdutt Padikkal started briskly. But between the 15th and 31st overs, exactly when they would have wanted to press on, they lost four wickets, leaving the responsibility to Rishabh Pant. By then the ball had gone soft, but the turn remained as sharp as ever, setting up a riveting contest.

The Sri Lankans fancied their chances against Pant, with fielders in attacking positions. He sensed the opportunity to score, provided he was brave, and he was, taking the right risks without being reckless. His shot selection was calculated; by now he knew what worked and what didn't. Unlike the top order, he preferred to play on either side of the square, not just the safer option but the more effective one against spin. His 66 off 69 balls stretched the lead beyond Sri Lanka's reach.

Take away Pant's innings, Padikkal's 44 and Rahul's 35, and the rest of the order managed only 42 between them, as India finished on 193. Their approach was questionable, but

Scorecard

SRI LANKA vs INDIA

GALLE

TOSS: India won, chose to bat

India 1st innings- 462

Sri Lanka 1st innings- 284

India 2nd innings- 193

Yashasvi Jaiswal c Dickwella b Fernando 0 (3b)

KL Rahul c sub (Rathnayaka) b Jayasuriya 35 (47b, 2x4, 2x6)

Devidutt Padikkal lbw b Nuwantha 44 (75b, 6x4)

Shubman Gill lbw b Jayasuriya 8 (20b, 1x4)

Rishabh Pant c Dickwella b Kumara 66 (69b, 8x4, 2x6)

Dhruv Jurel c Dickwella b Fernando 7 (15b, 1x4)

Ravindra Jadeja c sub (Sooriyabandara) b Kumara 9 (19b)

Manav Suthar c Dickwella b Fernando 9 (25b, 1x4)

Kuldeep Yadav c de Silva b Jayasuriya 5 (10b)

Mohammed Siraj not out 2 (6b)

Prasidh Krishna c Kumara b Fernando 2 (7b)

EXTRAS (lb 1, nb 3, w 2) 6

TOTAL (48.5 Overs) 193 all out

FoW: 1-0 (Yashasvi Jaiswal, 0.3 ov), 2-65 (KL Rahul, 14.4 ov), 3-81 (Shubman Gill, 20.5 ov), 4-111 (Devidutt Padikkal, 27.2 ov), 5-120 (Dhruv Jurel, 30.3 ov), 6-174 (Rishabh Pant, 40.3 ov), 7-179 (Ravindra Jadeja, 42.3 ov), 8-188 (Manav Suthar, 46.2 ov), 9-190 (Kuldeep Yadav, 47.1 ov), 10-193 (Prasidh Krishna, 48.5 ov)

BOWLING: Asitha Fernando 8.5-0-31-4; Keshara Nuwantha 23-3-86-1; Prabath Jayasuriya 11-0-43-3; Dhananjaya de Silva 1-0-4-0; Lahiru Kumara 5-0-28-2

Sri Lanka 2nd innings

Nishan Fernando c Krishna b Siraj 6 (27b)

Lahiru Udara c Jurel b Suthar 16 (58b, 1x4)

Pasindu Sooriyabandara lbw b Suthar 0 (1b)

Kamindu Mendis c Rahul b Krishna 2 (12b)

Dhananjaya de Silva not out 31 (73b, 3x4)

Sonal Dinusha not out 25 (36b, 4x4)

EXTRAS (lb 1, nb 3) 4

TOTAL (34 Overs) 84/4

FoW: 1-13 (Nishan Madushka Fernando, 6.6 ov), 2-14 (Pasindu Sooriyabandara, 7.2 ov), 3-21 (Kamindu Mendis, 10.4 ov), 4-47 (Lahiru Udara lgalagamage, 21.4 ov)

BOWLING: Mohammed Siraj 5-11-11; Manav Suthar 11-0-30-2; Prasidh Krishna 8-2-13-1; Ravindra Jadeja 6-0-16-0; Kuldeep Yadav 3-0-8-0; Devdutt Padikkal 1-0-5-0

given they were pushing for a win with rain a threat, that's a conversation for another day. They finished the job. A target of 372 looked safe.

Adventurous Rishabh retains offence while keeping team first

Sandip G
New Delhi, August 18

THERE ARE glorious Test careers that pass with nominal numbers in the six column. Australia opener David Boon, at odds with the machismo of his bristling moustache and piercing eyes, struck only two sixes in 18,116 balls. English opener Mike Atherton, no less obdurate, managed only four off the 20,609 deliveries he soaked up in Test cricket. VVS Laxman, disinclined to the savage pleasure of hitting sixes, brush-stroked only five balls beyond the fence.

Unlike in the shorter formats, it isn't a handicap or an anomaly there, but a number largely irrelevant to the game. Ben Stokes, the leading six-hitter in the long form, is remembered for his nerveless heists; the six-hitting prowess is merely an embellishment. Even Viv Richards, prophet of the most brutal swipes, is deified less for his sixes than for his swaggering aura. The six is not a requisite. It is, largely, dispensable.

The premise of the six in this format is what makes Rishabh Pant's feat, a century of sixes, the quickest ever, but the more striking. He has built a career out of a Test batsman's most dispensable run-scoring option. He needed only 4,934 balls for his hundred sixes, one every 49 balls. Stokes's 138, a record now at the mercy of Pant, came at one every 90 balls. Second on the list is Brendon McCullum, whose 107 arrived at one every 93rd ball. Adam Gilchrist, the first to reach a hundred, completes the quartet. It's a curiously absorbing list: Jacques Kallis, cricket's perceived stonewaller, has hit more sixes (97) than Brian Lara (88), Sachin Tendulkar (69), AB de Villiers (64) and Ricky Ponting (73).

The achievement won't be romanticised the way Don Bradman's 99.94 is, or Brian Lara's 400, or Sachin Tendulkar's 51 hundreds. Nor will it stand as a metaphor for T20 cricket's pull on the Test game (even after the Bazball boom, a six still arrives only once every 155 balls), or suddenly make the six the strongest currency in the sport. It exists instead as an exotic outlier, worth fishing up to celebrate the quirks that make Pant such an unputdownable watch.

A six is his method. It's his



Rishabh Pant scored 66 off 69 balls for India on Day 4. CREIMAS

madness too. He plays perfectly crisp strokes along the ground; he unfurls scything cuts, drills bullet cover-drives, whips through flicks. That's often his intention, until the bowler bristles in his run-up and the blood rushes in Pant's veins. That's when instinct overrides instructed wisdom, unbothered by the situation, his own form, or the sniff of a milestone.

It's as natural to him as a cover drive was to Virat Kohli, or a flick to Mohammed Azharuddin, or the front-foot defence, ripped straight off the stylesheet, was to Rahul Dravid. It's an expression of his joy, of the way he plays the game and feels it too. The record may well be a byproduct of his aggression rather than something he ever set out to chase. But the six is his métier. It isn't merely a tool to disrupt a bowler's length, a ploy to deny him rhythm. It's the stream his runs flow through. Sixes account for 600 of his 3,557 runs.

A Pant six is riveting theatre. It's unpredictable: he might hit the first ball of an innings for six, even if the situation screams for caution. It subverts logic: he takes on the fiercest bowlers, reverse-sweeping James Anderson among them. It borders on absurd: one-handed, upper body flailing, knees buckled, his whole frame tumbling in the follow-through. It finds corners captains struggle to set a field for.

The technique itself fascinates: the balance, the stillness even in motion, the free-flowing swing, the extraordinary reach for a man of his height, the loose bottom hand. The six carries his ambition and his desire. But more than either, it carries the free-spiritedness that defines the way he plays. It's his method, and his madness.

{ HOCKEY WORLD CUP }

India-Pak rivalry: Once thrilling, now one-sided

Mihir Vasavda
Mumbai, August 18

LAST SATURDAY, play in the middle of a World Cup match had to be stopped because Pakistan's players had forgotten their kitbag, which contained protective gear, in the changing room. A few months earlier, during the Pro League tour in Australia, they were scrambling for money to pay for their hotel stay. In another era, both incidents would have been unthinkable.

Pakistan were once hockey's trendsetters. They won four World Cups, three Olympic gold medals and produced artists who changed how the game was played. They weren't merely India's greatest rivals; for long periods, the Green Shirts were India's tormentors.

On Wednesday, when the neighbours meet in a do-or-die Pool Stage finale for both, the contest will still carry all the familiar emotions. But the balance of power has shifted so dramatically that the fixture now feels less like the renewal of a rivalry and more like a reminder of what has been lost.

The numbers tell the story. Before 2000, India and Pakistan played 92 matches. Pakistan won exactly half of them, 46, India won only 30, while 16 ended in draws, according to The Hockey Museum.

Since January 1, 2000, they have played 93 times. India have won 43, including a 7-1 hammering most recently in June. Pakistan have won 38. Twelve have been draws. The transformation becomes even starker when viewed through the prism of recent history. In-



India have beaten Pakistan 17 times in their last 20 meetings. HII

dia's longest winless run against Pakistan lasted eight matches between 1988 and 1989. Pakistan haven't beaten India consistently for a decade. Their current winless streak against their neighbours stands at 20 matches and counting, a run dating back to April 2016.

The overall head-to-head record still favours Pakistan — 84 wins to India's 73, with 28 draws. But the gap is shrinking rapidly.

And the reasons have little to do with talent.

There was a time when Pakistan showed a willingness to stay ahead of the curve. At the 2004 Athens Olympics, as then coach Roelant Oltmans experienced, their all-foreign coaching staff included a video analyst, something that wasn't commonplace in international hockey, especially in Asia. There was money, there was expertise and there was an understanding that the game was

changing.

Signs of disconnect

Somewhere along the way, that momentum disappeared.

The financial troubles are well documented, but reducing Pakistan's decline to a lack of funds would be simplistic. The bigger problem has been their inability to keep pace with a sport that has transformed dramatically over the last two decades.

The signs of that disconnect have surfaced in the unlikelyst of places. Training sessions have been affected by something as basic as a shortage of match-quality balls, as former Japan coach Siegfried Aikman experienced during his stint there. That might sound insignificant, but modern hockey is built on repetition and intensity. Coaches want multiple balls in circulation so that drills can continue without interruption. If players spend half

CATCHING UP

India vs Pakistan head-to-head BEFORE 2000

PLAYED: 92; India won: 30; Pakistan won: 46; Draws: 16

SINCE 1 JANUARY 2000

PLAYED: 91; India won: 41; Pakistan won: 38; Draws: 12

10 Number of years since India have lost to Pakistan. The two teams have played 20 times since the team's last defeat to the neighbours – at South Asian Games in February 2016 – India have won 17 times, drawn twice while one was abandoned due to rain.

SOURCE: THE HOCKEY MUSEUM

the session collecting stray balls, the quality of training inevitably suffers. The same story plays out elsewhere.

Sports science, once considered an added advantage, is now a necessity. GPS trackers that monitor workload and recovery have become standard equipment across top teams. Video analysis has evolved from being an optional extra to an indispensable tool. Conditioning methods have become more sophisticated. Nutrition, recovery and data analysis are no longer supporting elements; they are central to performance.

Pakistan, however, have often appeared stuck between two eras. Perhaps nowhere is that more evident than in their style of play. The breathtaking attacking instincts that once defined Pakistani hockey have

n't disappeared. Their players can still dribble out of tight spaces and produce moments of improvisation that few teams can replicate.

But modern hockey has become less forgiving of individualism. Ironically, many of these criticisms could once have been directed at India, too. A little over a decade ago, Indian hockey was battling administrative chaos, financial uncertainty and questions over governance. But while India modernised, professionalised and embraced new ideas, Pakistan struggled to make the same transition.

And that divergence is now reflected in everything, from infrastructure and results to the most telling statistic of all: the rivalry itself. Wednesday's contest will still be labelled an India-Pakistan clash. It will still be marketed as one of hockey's great rivalries. And there will still be enough history between the two nations to ensure that the match matters.

But every India-Pakistan fixture now carries a lingering sense of melancholy. Because what was once a battle between equals has become a reminder of how one country adapted to the demands of modern hockey while the other slowly lost touch with them.

Yet, Harmanpreet Singh & Co. would be careful. India, one of the contenders to reach the World Cup semifinals, have everything to lose if they do not win. For Pakistan, the stakes aren't as high. Which is when they can be the most unpredictable and dangerous, the decline and history notwithstanding. **INDIA VS PAKISTAN, 6.30pm**, Live on Star Sports and JioHotstar

India women settle old score with South Africa, win 6-1

Tushar Bhaduri
New Delhi, August 18

FOLLOWERS OF hockey of a certain vintage would remember that it was South Africa who denied Indian women their first visit to an Olympics in 32 years. In the qualifying tournament in Delhi, they beat the home team 3-1 in a winner-takes-all clash in 2012. South Africa weren't considered one of the fancied teams in women's hockey even then.

That the group match between the two teams at the 2026 FIH World Cup was seen mainly as a chance for India to boost their goal difference says everything about the contrasting paths the two teams have taken over the last decade and a half. In that sense, the 6-1 win for Sjoerd Marjine's side was on expected lines, and India now have to avoid defeat against England on Thursday to make the next round.

After failing to qualify for London 2012, India reached Rio 2016. South Africa fell short of that one, though India returned from it winless, finishing last among 12 teams. Tokyo was a different story, a memorable campaign that took them to the semi-finals and had them threatening a medal.

India were always favourites going into Tuesday's contest in Amsterdam, especially after holding China to a 2-2 draw in their first game, while South Africa were thrashed 4-0 by England.

They took a quarter to find their rhythm, but after breaking the deadlock through a



The win against South Africa was India's biggest in the history of The Women's World Cup. HOCKEY INDIA

scrappy Sunelita Toppo goal in the 11th minute, they quickly put daylight between themselves and their opponents. The South Africans were often their own worst enemies, with sloppy turnovers in midfield and a failure to clear the ball from their defensive circle at the first opportunity.

They have players who catch the eye with pace and skill, Onthatile Zulu and Bianco Wood among them, but the fact that they couldn't trap the ball cleanly at the top of the circle on two of their three penalty corners pointed to the gulf in class between the sides.

Six different Indians scored on the day, which will please the team management, but Navneet was the standout again. It was she who settled any anxiety within the team when she doubled India's lead from a penalty corner, choosing not to take a direct shot at

goal but instead moving the ball to her side, creating space and drilling a low finish past Marlise van Tonder in the South African goal.

Sushila Chanu made the game safe, a 3-0 lead at half-time taking the pressure off India, who could then focus on pushing their goal difference above England's, after England had lost 4-2 to China earlier in the day. Three more goals, all reverse hits, from Deepika, Lalremisiami and Sakshi Rana, put five clear goals between the sides. Kayla de Waal got South Africa's first goal of the campaign with five minutes left, but it was little more than a consolation.

There was a moment of concern in the final minute when de Waal's trailing stick, at the edge of the Indian circle, struck Ishika Chaudhary, who left the field with blood running from her head.

BWF WORLD CHAMPIONSHIPS

Lakshya stutters, soars to conquer opening hurdle

Overcomes drift, his opponent's height and crowd pressure to advance to Rd 2

Prithish Raj
New Delhi, August 18

THERE WAS drift, there was a crowd and there was a tall opponent on the other side for Lakshya Sen. The 2021 World Championships medallist first negotiated the drift, then enthralled the crowd and at last, dominated Austrian shuttler Collins Valentine Filimon in three games to win 16-21, 21-8, 21-4 in the first round of the Badminton World Championships.

Welcomed by a roaring crowd, Lakshya entered the tie as the favourite but took his own sweet time (the first game) to understand the drift and the tricky conditions in the arena.

He started well with two strong pushes to the back court but the towering Austrian responded with straight smashes. Filimon used the overhead smash, in particular, to good use and took the lead at the mid-game break.

He built on it as Lakshya started erring at the net. Lakshya's errors gave Filimon a decisive lead of 19-14. The Indian tried to make a comeback but failed as Filimon won the first game 21-19. "There was drift in the stadium and my net shots were not travelling. I was apprehensive about the power to put on the shot. But I changed it in the second game, got my opponent engaged in rallies and started dominating," Lakshya explained.

The 25-year-old couldn't generate the power required



Lakshya Sen beat Collins Valentine Filimon of Austria 16-21, 21-8, 21-4. AP

while tackling the drift and struggled against the smashes of Filimon. "Whenever I played it short, he had an advantage. He would either drive or smash it, which resulted in the loss of the first game," he said.

This is not the first time Lakshya has faced issues against a tall opponent; during the India Open is year, Lin Chun-yi also smashed his lifts easily.

Tactical shift

However, as the sides changed, Lakshya figured out how to deal with the drift and his opponent's height also. He changed his tactics and decided not to give any more shots at attacking length to his opponent.

Once in the groove, Lakshya started mixing his deceptive drops with down-the-line smashes which resulted in Filimon making multiple errors.

"In the second game, I was aware that my side was the faster one and I started gener-

ating the power to trouble my opponent," said Lakshya.

Filimon held fort for some time but Lakshya started dominating after the mid-game interval of 11-8, and didn't let his opponent take any more points in the game.

It was a mix of errors from Filimon as the crowd pressure grew and Lakshya getting better with his strokes.

"The crowd definitely helps. It gets easier, knowing that they are backing us," Lakshya said.

The third and final game was an exhibition of attacking badminton and deception from Lakshya as he won it 21-4, completely dismantling the challenge of Filimon. "Once my game plan started working, I became more free and my body language started changing," the star Indian shuttler said.

The changing body language was visible as he started enjoying his shots and having fun on the court. He started

with a down-the-line smash, then went on to deceive Filimon on the net and eventually use his drops to kill the points.

There was an exchange at the net where Lakshya hit to the right, moved left, and then dropped the shuttle on the opposite side of Filimon, almost mirroring a well-executed body feint on the football field.

To work on his understanding of drift, he trained at the big hall at the National Centre for Excellence in Guwahati. "The goal was to get used to conditions because we had a bit of time after our last tournament to prepare," he said.

Lakshya will take confidence from his win today, even as his draw got trickier with fifth seed Christo Popov getting knocked out in the opener by Kenta Nishimoto.

The 'Superstar' — as described by the crowd — does not have an easy road ahead but he has the support, the preparation and a win now.

Evolution of the women's jump smash, and where Treesa's stacks up

Shivani Naik
New Delhi, August 18

THERE IS speed that's the length of a blink of the eye - like what Gayatri Gopichand has at the net. While the footwork and explosive stomp to the net are visible, Gayatri and Treesa Jolly's 21-15, 21-12 win over Americans Lauren Lam and Allison Lee also included the computer-processor-paced thinking of Gayatri, which proved the difference in the Round 2 win over opponents with the same ditto style as them, but smarter, swifter executions.

Then there is the altitude 3D pace that Treesa Jolly gets when she leaps high for jump smashes. "Treesa's smash is amazing. When I'm playing from the front, I can hear her smash," Gayatri said of the whoosh that streaks past her ear.

Since 2005-06, the gazelle-like elegant style of women's badminton started soaring into the vertical plane.

Not only did the smash gain power, but it also boasted altitude. The women's jump smash has some outstanding poster girls now - in India, the finest at the elite level is Treesa.

Newly bestowed with the Arjuna Award declared on Tuesday, the duo calmly completed a start-to-finish victory, and logged court time over back-to-back matches to reach the Round of 16.

Returning from injury sustained on the eve of her Uber Cup departure, Treesa had taken her time to ease back into tournament play, winning in the Philippines.

But it was the familiar sight of Gayatri rushing to the front and, importantly, Treesa rushing to the back and taking off with her head bobbing on the Court 1 horizon that signalled the duo was back.

That sort of powerplay is not merely a preference now. With Chinese World No 1s in women's doubles, Liu-Tan



Treesa Jolly hits a jump smash as Gayatri Gopichand waits for the return in their match against USA's Lauren Lam and Allison Lee. PTI

making the plyo-power game the bedrock of their aggressive style, the women's game has transcended into a both-feet airborne full-blooded smash. In the Treesa-Gayatri match, American Lauren Lam mirrored the Treesa smash, albeit from the left side.

Perhaps the most effortless jump smasher among women is 3-time World Champion in singles, Akane Yamaguchi. "It just naturally came to me," she said after her first-round win. The 5-ft-1 naturally needed the yo-yo power with her frame

and her arching smash, where she drags the shuttle from well behind her head, is iconic now. A feat in agility, the underrated element is how she lands from a leap and carries on in long rallies. Her inspiration? "Arisa Higashino" - the former mixed doubles Olympic medallist with her men's partner Yuta Watanabe, whose explosive pop smash she matched.

The OG of women's jump smashing was in Delhi too. Scottish Kirsty Gilmour, who might've lost to Han Yue, but not before making life difficult

for the Chinese. She would name former World No 2, Julianne Schenk, as her inspiration. The jump-smashers cohort now has Thai Supanida Katethong along with Yamaguchi, while the likes of Chen Yufei, Wang Zhi Yi and PV Sindhu are more the hop smashers, reaching the shuttle on the bounce of toes.

The jump smash evolution, though, is sweeping through women's badminton - and Treesa-Gayatri are firmly on board now. "Treesa has the big jump smash, but I know I need to get better at the back court," Gayatri, who relies on angles and timing for her smashes, said.

IMPORTANT RESULTS:

MEN'S SINGLES: 14- Lakshya Sen (IND) bt Collins Filimon (AUT) 16-21, 21-8, 21-4; Kenta Nishimoto (JPN) bt 5- Christo Popov (FRA) 21-17, 21-19; 3- Jonatan Christie (INA) bt Matthias Kicklitz (GER) 21-15, 21-14
WOMEN'S SINGLES: Unnati Hooda (IND) bt Thet Htar Thuzar (MYA) 22-20, 21-16; 4- Chen Yufei (CHN) bt Lo Sin Yan Happy (HKG) 18-21, 21-8, 21-11; 11- Nozomi Okuhara (JPN) bt Ozge Bayrak (TUR) 18-21, 21-16, 21-9
MEN'S DOUBLES: 4- Aaron Chia/Soh Wooi Yik (MAS) bt Peeratchai Sukphun/Pak-kapon Teeraratsakul (THA) 15-21, 21-11, 21-18
WOMEN'S DOUBLES: Treesa Jolly/Gayatri Gopichand (IND) bt Lauren Lam/Allison Lee (USA) 21-15, 21-12; Gabriela Stoeva/Stefani Stoeva (BUL) bt Kavipriya Selvam/Simran Singh (IND) 21-7, 21-14

MIXED DOUBLES: Jonathan Lai/Crystal Lai (CAN) bt Rohan Kapoor/Ruthvika Shivani Gadde (IND) 20-22, 21-19, 21-17, Emre Sonmez/Yasemen Bektas (TUR) bt Ashith Surya/Amrutha Pramuthesh (IND) 16-21, 30-29, 24-22.



नरेन्द्र मोदी
प्रधानमंत्री



राज्यपाल जयते
दिल्ली सरकार



दिल्ली परिवहन निगम
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